

INTERNATIONAL BEST PRACTICE IN EVENT MANAGEMENT

based on
The APIEM Certified Event Manager

DAVID W. G. HIND | MARIA ARLENE T. DIZON-ALCAZAR | KAREN FERNANDEZ
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United Kingdom Event Industry Academy Ltd.

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BY:

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This book is dedicated to

All event professionals who

Aspire to **learn**

International events management
Best practice standards

To

Achieve

Careers in the
Global events industry



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Preface

The Asia Pacific Institute for Events Management (www.theapiem.com) has been established to contribute to the professionalisation of the events and MICE industry in the Asia Pacific region. APIEM does this in many ways by:

- accrediting as APIEM Centres of Excellence those universities, polytechnics and colleges in the Asia Pacific region that have been audited to demonstrate that they provide an events/MICE curriculum of an international standard
- contributing to the events/MICE academic body of knowledge by publishing the scientific, international journal – the Asia Pacific International Events Management Journal
- bringing together events/MICE academics and practitioners at international conferences organised by APIEM Events Management Services (www.apiem-ems.com)
- supporting the development of an international standard curriculum in events/MICE education through consultancy services to universities, polytechnics and colleges
- organising continuing professional development programs for faculty lecturers who teach events/MICE subjects.

This book, *International Best Practice in Event Management*, is APIEM's latest contribution to the professionalisation of the events/MICE industry in the Asia Pacific.

It is essential in today's globalised world that events/MICE professionals who work in this great industry are able to meet international standards of performance and behaviour in their work. One way of ensuring that this occurs is by accrediting events/MICE professionals who can demonstrate that they know, understand, and can implement international standards

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of performance when working in the events/MICE industry. Achieving international certified status signifies to a client that the event manager is educated and trained to an international standard in the preparation, planning, organisation and management of an event so that it not only provides a tremendous participant experience but also takes place in an environment that is safe and secure for all stakeholders involved with the event.

National occupation standards are produced by government agencies, professional bodies, industry associations, and stakeholders who are involved in regulating an industry. They are published to set the standards that workers in an industry have to meet to show that they are competent in their work. The contents of this book have been aligned to the national occupational standards for the United Kingdom's events industry. The United Kingdom has a long history of organising successful events. There have been many publications from events industry associations in the United Kingdom to develop the standards that events/MICE practitioners have to follow in order to meet the myriad of legislation that regulates the United Kingdom's events/MICE industry.

This book has been written as a practical book on events management with a writing style that is as reader-friendly as possible. The reader's viewpoint has been firmly considered – what type of book does the event manager need to help her or him develop their events management expertise to an international standard. The assumption that has been made is that event managers need a text that:

- is straight-to-the-point
- is written in a non-academic way
- provides a series of checklists that can be referred to time and again to indicate what is best practice with each of the tasks and functions of an event manager
- covers the key management tasks that an event manager needs to be competent at in order to prepare, plan, organise, manage and evaluate an event that is of an international standard.

Thus, the prime purpose of this book is to act as the event manager's

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reference text that can be read whenever guidance is needed on performing the many responsibilities that the event manager faces. If the event manager wishes to investigate the theoretical aspects that underpin events management, there are many scholarly, referenced books available. However, if the reader wishes to find out how to perform the tasks of an event manager in practice, then this book will be of value. Who should read this book? This book has been written for:

- event professionals who wish to develop further their expertise in performing the tasks and functions of an event manager to an international standard
- faculty lecturers and researchers who wish to understand how international standards of event management can be applied in practice
- individuals who are studying for the APIEM Certified Event Manager qualification awarded by the United Kingdom Event Industry Academy (UKEIA)
- students at universities, polytechnics, or colleges who are studying a program in events management and want to gain practical knowledge and understanding of the responsibilities of being an event manager.

The contents of this book have been produced by identifying the relevant United Kingdom National Occupational Standards for the Events Industry (UKNOSEI) and then by inviting leading international experts in events management to write content to demonstrate how the UKNOSEI can be attained. By so doing, the readers of this book, who implement the contents of the various chapters, will have a knowledge and understanding of events management that is of an international standard.

The authors acknowledge that much of what is written in this book is not new but accepted norms of knowledge and behaviours for an event manager. What is novel, however, is aligning the content of this book to the UKNOSEI in a highly practical way. This book is also distinctive in that it provides an opportunity for readers of this book to gain an APIEM Certified Event Manager Qualification – Chapter One explains how this can be achieved.

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Chapters Two to Eight then provide the essential ingredients of successful events management:

Chapter Two - An Introduction to Event Management
Chapter Three - Preparing for the Event
Chapter Four - Planning the Event
Chapter Five - Organising the Event
Chapter Six - Managing Health, Safety, Security and Emergencies at the Event
Chapter Seven - Managing People at the Event
Chapter Eight - Evaluating the Event

We hope you enjoy reading our book.

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The Authors

Professor David W G Hind
In the United Kingdom, David was Head of the School of Events, Tourism and Hospitality at Leeds Beckett University, 2011–2016 (the UK Centre for Events Management) and now holds executive positions with the UK Event Industry Academy Ltd and the Travel Industry Academy Ltd.

He is a Distinguished Professor at Chung Hua University, Taiwan; Professor at the Palembang Polytechnic of Tourism, Indonesia; and Visiting Professor at the Bali Institute of Tourism and Bandung Institute of Tourism, both in Indonesia.

David is currently President of the Asia Pacific Institute for Events Management (APIEM); Editor in Chief of the Asia Pacific International Events Management Journal; Chief Executive of the United Kingdom Event Industry Academy; Chairman of APIEM Events Management Services; and a tourism consultant for London Metropolitan University, United Kingdom.

The books authored by David include *Transferable Personal Skills a Students Guide*; *Transferable Personal Skills a Tutor's Guide*; *Core Skills for GNVQ*; and *Employability Skills*. He has contributed chapters to a number of books on tourism.

David is frequently invited to give keynote presentations at conferences throughout Asia and has undertaken tourism and events consultancy work in the UK, the EU, Russia, Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan and Indonesia.

Maria Arlene T. Disimulacion
Maria is an educator, consultant, entrepreneur, and author. She has over 30 years of experience in event management, marketing and communications, training, and strategic management. She has extensive exposure to the events, tourism, education, entertainment, broadcasting, publishing, outsourcing and consulting industries. She was a consultant to the Cultural Centre of the Philippines, Philippine Retirement Authority, Technology and Livelihood and Resource Centre and the

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Philippine Convention and Visitors Corporation, among other notable organizations. She has managed large-scale events and trade missions for the agriculture, aquaculture, livestock, construction, pharmaceutical, performing arts, food, education, and information technology sectors for which she received international awards for her seamless execution of innovative concepts.

She is an Associate Professor at the Far Eastern University (FEU) Manila currently working in the Office of the Senior Vice President for Academic Affairs. Previously, Maria was a senior academic in FEU's Institute of Tourism and Hotel Management. She graduated with a degree in Bachelor of Science in Business Administration (BSBA) from the University of the Philippines (UP) Diliman. Maria was a faculty scholar at FEU Makati, where she completed her Master in Business Administration (MBA) with High Distinction. She also completed courses in virtual education from the University of California Irvine with Distinction. She has been consistently involved in committee work for faculty development, mentorship, and curriculum review. Maria facilitated faculty training for FEU's Digital Learning, Effective Communication, and Critical Thinking (DLECCT) engagement and is currently the Project Lead for the General Education unit of the Academic Affairs Office.

Maria has presented research papers in local and international conferences focusing on meetings, incentives, conventions and exhibitions (MICE) and special events, information and communications technologies (ICT), co-creation of visitor experiences, and creative tourism. She is also a regular peer reviewer for SCOPUS journals as well as an editor for tourism, hospitality, and business books. She has also written textbooks on tourism and event management currently being used in tertiary academic institutions. Moreover, she is a Professional Fellow of the Asia Pacific Institute for Events Management.

Dr Karen Fernandez

Karen is the Vice President for Research and International Affairs and Dean of the College of Hospitality and Tourism Management of Imus Institute of Science and Technology, Philippines. She is also the Vice President for Education and Accreditation of the Asia Pacific Institute

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for Events Management and President of APIEM Events Management Services.

She has been appointed as a Visiting Professor in the following universities: Management and Science University; Universiti Teknologi MARA (UiTM), and Olympia College in Malaysia; Universitas Prasetiya Mulya, Sahid Tourism Institute of Surakarta, and Bandung Institute of Tourism in Indonesia; National Institute of Development Administration (NIDA), Maha Sarakham University, Naresuan University, North Bangkok University, and Burapha University in Thailand; and Chung Hua University and Ming Chuan University in Taiwan.

Karen was a postdoctoral scholar in the School of Events, Tourism and Hospitality at Leeds Beckett University, United Kingdom. She holds a doctoral degree in Business Management specialized in Hospitality Management and a Master's Degree in Business Administration majoring in Hotel and Restaurant Management both earned at Philippine Women's University, Manila.

Her research interests include events management, sustainable tourism, and hospitality management. She has participated and presented research papers in a number of international academic conferences held in Taiwan, Dubai, USA, Hong Kong, Vietnam, South Korea, Japan, Malaysia, New Zealand, and the United Kingdom. Karen has served as a keynote speaker and session chair in international conferences. She is a member of scientific and editorial review boards of international journals in business, management, hospitality, and tourism.

Karen is the book author of *Guide to Event Management's Best Practices* and Editor-in-Chief of the International Journal of Sustainable Tourism and Hospitality Management.

Dr Kuan-Wen Eric Lin

Kuan-Wen Eric Lin serves as Vice President of the Asia Pacific Institute for Events Management responsible for Industry Relations. He is Secretary General of the Taiwan Convention and Exhibition Association responsible for promoting and developing Taiwan as a MICE destination. Previously,

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he taught in the Department of Tourism and MICE Management at Chung Hua University, Taiwan and served as the university's Chief Executive Officer for International Cooperation. Kuan-Wen Eric Lin also holds adjunct Assistant Professorships at the Graduate School of Arts Management & Cultural Policy, National Taiwan University of Arts and at the Assumption University of Thailand. As a current member of the Supervisory Board of Taiwan Convention & Exhibition Association and Secretary-General of Taiwan Association of Cultural Policy Studies, he actively helps governments and industries to build their strategies and body of knowledge on MICE and festival & event management. Kuan-Wen Eric Lin received his Ph.D. (Event Management) and MBA in Cultural Management at Queen Margaret University, Edinburgh, United Kingdom under the supervision of two world-renowned scholars, Professor Joe Goldblatt and Professor Andrew Frew.

Dr Anukrati Sharma

Anukrati is an Associate Professor in the Department of Commerce and Management, University of Kota, Kota, Rajasthan, India. In 2015, she received a Research Award from the University Grants Commission (UGC), New Delhi, for her project "Analysis of the Status of Tourism in Hadoti and Shekhawati Region/Circuit (Rajasthan): Opportunities, Challenges, and Future Prospects." Her doctorate is from the University of Rajasthan in Tourism Marketing, and she completed her dissertation research on the topic of 'Tourism in Rajasthan–Progress & Prospects'. Anukrati has two postgraduate degree specialities, one in International Business (Master of International Business) and the other in Business Administration (Master of Commerce). Her interest areas are events, tourism, tourism marketing, strategic management, and international business management. She has edited books on *Tourism-Opportunities and Ventures*, on *Maximizing Business Performance and Efficiency through Intelligent Systems*, under IGI Global; *Tourism Sustainable Tourism Development Futuristic Approaches* under Apple Academic Press (CRC Press a Taylor and Francis Group), USA, under the series Advances in Hospitality and Tourism and a book titled *Tourism Events in Asia Marketing and Development*, Routledge, USA, under Advances in Events Research Series. She has an authored book on *Event Management and Marketing Theory, Practical Approaches and Planning*. Anukrati has edited a book on *Sustainable Destination Branding*

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and Marketing: Strategies for Tourism Development published in 2019 by CABI, United Kingdom.

She is a member of 17 professional bodies and has attended many national and international conferences and presented 45 papers. Anukrati has been invited to participate in talks, lectures and panel discussions in Sri Lanka, Nepal, and Turkey. She handles training sessions at the Rajasthan Police Academy, Jaipur, on such topics as change management, communication skills, gender discrimination, and personality development.

Peni Zulandari Suroto

Peni is an educator in events management and tourism. She is the manager for the undergraduate events management S1 degree program in the School of Business and Economics, Universitas Prasetiya Mulya, Indonesia. The program is the first Bachelor's Degree program in Indonesia specialising in events management. Her subjects of teaching are Event Production, Risk & Crisis Management, and Audience Analysis. She connects all the subjects with local wisdom, as she believes that events can 'heal' the audience. Her research interests are in cultural festivals, risk management, and wellbeing tourism.

Her passion for events started when she was a high school student contributing to the organisation of a number of events whilst at school. Peni's professional career was also related to organising events. As a business school graduate, she tried to exercise her entrepreneurial skill by setting up a 'below the line company'. With her team, she served well known local and multinational companies by executing many events as brand activation programs. She also ran a small business in floristry and wedding decoration.

The Asia Pacific Institute for Events Management (APIEM) recognized Peni as the first APIEM Certified Event Tutor in Indonesia, for her competence in educating MICE and events management students to an international standard. She has been awarded the Certificate in Event Venue Management by the Indonesia MICE Profession Association – a government body. Peni is also a Certified Hospitality Educator (CHE) awarded by the American Hotel & Lodging Association.

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chapter 1

the APIEM certified event awards

After reading this chapter, you will be able to:

- explain the contribution that the Asia Pacific Institute for Events Management (APIEM) makes to the professionalisation of the events industry
- understand the importance of national occupation standards in the design of the curriculum for an events qualification
- explain the content of the APIEM Certified Event Management qualifications
- explain how to become an APIEM Certified Event Manager

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1 The United Kingdom Event Industry Academy

The United Kingdom Event Industry Academy (UKEIA) is a United Kingdom registered company that provides educational support services to the events industry – see www.eventsindustryacademy.com.

UKEIA's principal activities include:

- offering continuing professional development programs for faculty lecturers in events, hospitality and tourism
- providing a certification program for events/MICE professionals who wish to gain international recognition of their expertise
- providing an accreditation program for those educational establishments that offer an events/MICE curriculum of an international standard and wish to be recognised as a Centre of Excellence
- undertaking consultancy work in events for private and public sector clients.

The overarching aim of UKEIA is to contribute to the professionalisation of the global events industry through its

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services and activities by encouraging the development of international standards in events/MICE management workplace practice and educational courses.

For events/MICE professionals (or those people who want to develop their career in the events/MICE industry), UKEIA provides several Certified Events Management qualifications that have been developed to an international standard. Through these programs, events/MICE professionals can be confident that they have developed knowledge and experience of the events/MICE industry that is benchmarked to the United Kingdom National Occupational Standards for the Events Industry.

Asia Pacific Institute for Events Management

The UKEIA licences the Asia Pacific Institute for Events Management (APIEM) to provide a certification program for events/MICE professionals who wish to gain international recognition for their knowledge and skills in organising events

Did you know?

- Which countries are classified as being within the Asia Pacific region? Depending on the context, the Asia Pacific region typically includes countries in East and North-East Asia (China, Republic of Korea, Hong Kong, Japan, Mongolia), South-East Asia (Brunei Darussalam, Cambodia, Indonesia, Lao PDR, Malaysia, Philippines, Singapore, Thailand), South and South-West Asia (Afghanistan, India, Pakistan, Sri Lanka, Turkey), North and Central Asia (Armenia, Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan, Russian Federation, Uzbekistan) and the Pacific region (Australia, Fiji, New Zealand, Papua New Guinea).
- Some contexts for classifying Asia Pacific countries include characteristics such as economic and commerce, politics, health, and socio-cultural factors. The Asia Pacific region has a large total economic value and impact as 60% of the global population live in Asia with China, India, and Indonesia being within the top five most populous nations in the world.

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to an international standard. UKEIA licences APIEM to develop its certification program utilising United Kingdom National Occupational Standards for the event industry.

Certification

Events/MICE professionals all over the world are now required to demonstrate their competence in events management by undertaking a program of study that leads to international certification. The achievement of an international certificate in events management confirms that the events/MICE professionals can work to international standards when undertaking their work.

UKEIA provides an international certification scheme that is based on the United Kingdom National Occupational Standards for the Events Industry. APIEM has been authorised by UKEIA to offer this certificate under the name of APIEM.

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2 United Kingdom National Occupation Standards for the Events Industry

National occupation standards are precisely worded statements that specify the standards of knowledge, understanding, skills, behaviour and performance that individuals working in an industry have to attain when carrying out their tasks and functions in the workplace. In the United Kingdom, national occupation standards are produced through a consultation process that includes a variety of stakeholders – government agencies, professional bodies, industry associations, employers, education and training experts.

When the national occupation standards for an industry have been produced, they enable training and education providers to develop programs of study that will assist students to reach a competent standard of performance that can lead to a certificate being awarded.

UKEIA has reviewed the United Kingdom National Occupation Standards for the Events Industry and has developed a Certified Event Manager qualification that can be awarded to people who are able to demonstrate that they meet the knowledge and

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understanding criteria specified by this certificate program. The APIEM Certified Event Manager program comprises four modules which are aligned with the United Kingdom National Occupation Standards for the Events Industry.

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3 The Apiem Certified Event Manager Qualification

There are four modules in this qualification:

Module One: Preparing for the Event
Research and Agree the Scope of the Event
Develop a Business Plan for the Event
Plan and Implement a Critical Path for the Event
Research and Select the Venue for the Event
Manage Contracts for the Event

Module Two: Planning the Event
Design and Develop the Concept for the Event
Use Technology in the Event
Provide Access for People with Special Needs
Develop and Write Policies and Procedures for the Event

Module Three: Organising the Event
Organise the Set-up and Break-down of the Event
Organise and Co-ordinate Events

- Before the Event
- At the Event
- After the Event

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Manage the Running of the Event
Co-ordinate the Stewards at the Event

Module Four: Managing the Event
Manage Effective Relationships with External Stakeholders
Oversee Health, Safety, and Security at the Event
Respond to Emergencies during the Event
Allocate Work to Team Members
Quality Assure Work in the Team
Manage Conflict in the Workplace
Provide Leadership
Evaluate and Report on the Success of the Event

To be awarded the APIEM Certified Event Manager qualification all four modules have to be completed. However, two additional 'contained' qualifications are also available:

Did you know?

- By 2015, Associations of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN) established the ASEAN Economic Community (AEC) as a major milestone in the regional economic integration agenda in the area. ASEAN member states are Brunei Darussalam, Cambodia, Indonesia, Lao PDR, Malaysia, Myanmar, Philippines, Singapore, Thailand, and Vietnam. The impact of the AEC establishment is a complementation of foreign and local manpower. Moreover, the possibilities of hiring a qualified workforce will be higher.

- The cross-border flow of workers with specific skills, for example doctors, lawyers, accountants, and event managers is now possible. Managerial skills, knowledge and experiences can now be transferred between ASEAN member nations with fewer visa restrictions.

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- APIEM Certified Event Planner: awarded to students who complete successfully modules one and two
- APIEM Certified Event Organiser: awarded to students who complete successfully modules one, two and three

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4 Studying for the APIEM Certified Event Manager Qualification

The APIEM Certified Event Manager qualification comprises of four modules. This book has been written so that each chapter provides the content that is needed to complete the modules.

The subject content in each chapter of this book is complete in itself. That means the student does not need to gain information from any other source material in order to be able to take the assessments that each module requires to demonstrate that the module learning outcomes have been attained.

The APIEM Certified Event Manager qualification is competency-based and is assessed through a portfolio of evidence and a reflective report that each student produces to demonstrate their practical experience of managing events successfully. The portfolio of evidence and the reflective report will confirm that the student has attained the module and course learning outcomes.

To gain the APIEM Certified Event Manager Qualification, each of the four modules is taken in sequence, either by studying at an

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APIEM Approved Centre of Learning or through distance learning. The APIEM Approved Centre of Learning will normally be an accredited APIEM Centre of Excellence – see www.theapiem.com. For those students who are unable to travel to an APIEM Centre of Excellence then distance learning is available. Distance learning enables the student to study at a time and in a place that is convenient for themselves. Registered distance learning students for the APIEM Certified Event Manager award will benefit from:

- a structured program of learning that includes tasks to complete each week
- the support of a qualified events management mentor to provide feedback on progress
- access to dedicated social media for APIEM Certified Event Manager students

At the end of Chapters Two, Three, Four, Five, Six, Seven, and Eight the material that has to be included in the portfolio of evidence for the APIEM Certified Event Manager qualification is explained.

Did you know?

- The three countries with the largest populations in the world are located in the Asia Pacific region: China (more than 1.4 billion people), India (more than 1.3 billion people), and Indonesia (more than 270 million people).
- A country with a large population is good for business. It means there is greater demand and supply in all industry sectors, including the events/MICE industry.

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chapter 2

an introduction to event management

After reading this chapter, you will be able to:

- define what an event is
- understand the important role that the event manager plays in the events industry
- identify the many different types of event that comprise the events industry
- explain the importance of the events industry to a destination that is hosting an event

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5 What is an Event?

Events, as will be seen later in this chapter, take many different forms. No matter the type of event, all events have similar characteristics. Events tend to be:

- infrequently occurring activities that the participants look forward to attending
- outside of the participants' normal daily activities and as such they have to create truly memorable experiences for their participants.

To ensure that the participants of the event have their expectations met and have an enjoyable and memorable event experience, the event manager has to design the event so that it creates an amazing and unforgettable experience for the participants. If the event manager can achieve this, then her or his event company will have created a competitive advantage that will encourage its existing clients to become loyal and will also help to attract new clients.

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There are many reasons why events are organised and include:

- to educate
- to motivate
- to entertain
- to celebrate achievements
- to communicate information
- to achieve corporate objectives
- to change the behaviour of the participants

Events are organised for commercial, economic, political and social reasons. As such events are universal; every village, town, city, province and nation will organise and host events. The event organizer can be a private individual, a qualified and certificated event manager, a specialist event design company, a private-sector corporation or a public sector governmental organisation.

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6 Event Managers

The event manager is responsible for the administration, operations, marketing, communications, safety and security, risk management, documentation, and evaluation of an event. As a lead executive, they work across many different phases of the management of an event from preparing, planning, organising, supervising, controlling, to evaluating the success of an event. All of these management domains have specific tasks, activities and deliverables that require managing for their successful implementation.

Aside from multitasking, the event manager is expected to have skills and expertise in strategic thinking, critical thinking, creativity, flexibility, financial literacy, marketing acumen, ethical behaviour, social skills and time management. They also need to have an eye for detail and meticulous planning and the ability to solve problems whilst remaining calm. Furthermore, the event manager must be able to operate under extreme pressure, meet deadlines and work within budget constraints. The chapters in this book will help to develop many of the skills and attributes of a successful event manager.

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Once qualified as an APIEM Certified Event Manager, career opportunities are global. The event manager might decide to form their own event organizing company, seek employment with a private or public sector corporation, or might wish to specialise in a particular aspect of successful events management. Specialist event managers can become experts in:

- digital technology
- event production
- event fabrication (staging & rigging)
- risk, health & safety management

Or, the event manager might decide to become a specialist in organising a particular type of event. The opportunities for internationally qualified event managers to develop their careers within the global events industry are varied, see Figure 1.

Did you know?

- You may need a 'traditional' Master of Ceremony (MC) to run a traditional style of an event such as a wedding, baby shower, or other cultural-based events. This type of MC will provide the equipment needed for all rituals involved in the event. The MC will ensure that all of the appropriate traditions and rituals of the ceremony will be implemented to create a memorable experience for all the participants.

- A 'modern' MC will more specialize in organising contemporary style events, like twenty-first-century family celebrations (weddings) andcorporate events such as product launches, seminars, conferences, workshops and meetings. The modern MC will be skilled at incorporating digital technology into the event as well as the traditional event rituals and traditions.

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Figure 1: Different Types of Events and Different Employment Opportunities in Events

Different Types of Events	Different Employment Opportunities in Events
Art Shows	Advertising Agency
Auctions	Audio Technicians
Arrival Honors	Bakeshops
Award Ceremonies	Banquet Operations
Band Competitions	Booth Contractor
Banquets	Cake Decorators
Beauty Contests	Catering
Birthdays	Communications
Board Meetings	Content Design
Children's Parties	Consulting
Civic Meetings	Décor
Cluster Meetings	Entertainment
Community Events	Event Assessment
Concerts	Exhibition Service Contractors
Congress	Fabrication
Conventions	Floral Design
Corporate Training	Food Styling
Cruise Ship Entertainment	Fundraising
Destination Events	Graphic Design
Economic Forum	Hosting
Educational Tours	Illustration
Exhibitions	Interior Design
Fairs	Lights
Farm Tours	Logistics
Fandom Conventions	Marketing
Fashion Shows	Merchandising
Fiestas	Mobile Application Designer
Festivals	Packaging
Fraternity Meetings	Patisserie
Gala Nights	Photography
Groundbreaking Ceremonies	Printing
Hospitality Events	Production
Incentive Tours	Program Design
Mall Shows	Public Relations
Medical Missions	Research
Military Ceremonies	Rigging
Movie Premieres	Safety Equipment
Office Meetings	Same-day Editing
Official Visits	Social Media Specialist
Parades	Sommelier
Pilgrimages	Speakers' Bureau
Political Campaigns	Sponsorships
Press Conferences	Staging
Processions	Stylists
Product Launches	Systems Design
Rallies	Technology
Religious Celebrations	Training
Research Colloquium	Ushering
Reunions	Videography

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Seminars Sports Contests State Dinners State Visits Student Competitions Test Drives Teambuilding Trade Shows Training University Activities Virtual Meetings Webinars Weddings Workshops	Volunteer Management Website Designer Website Developer

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7 Typology of Events

The above section has indicated the very broad range and diversity of events that comprise the events industry. These events can be classified further based on their size, content, purpose, and platform.

Events based on size

Mega events

Mega events tend to be large scale international events that occur fairly infrequently, for example, every four years. Mega events are defined in terms of the magnitude of the number of participants, the investment required to create the infrastructure, and the marketing expenditure to promote the event to an international audience. The mega event is not only organised for the primary purpose of the event (for example an international sports competition) but also to contribute to the economic, environmental or social rejuvenation and transformation of the location where it held.

Historically, the Great Exhibition of 1851, held at the Crystal Palace in London, can be considered as one of the first international

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mega events. It highlighted 100,000 inventions and works of art; 14,000 exhibitors and was seen by more than six million local and international visitors. Before the turn of the nineteenth century, there were two other noteworthy exhibitions, namely, the Paris Exposition of 1889 and the World's Fair in Chicago in 1893.

Today, the Olympic Games, the Asian Games and the FIFA World Cup count among the world's mega events. The socio-economic impact of these events can be felt before, during, and after the games as they are considered to have a transformational effect helping to regenerate an area or locality that is experiencing a decline in its economy or an area of social deprivation and exclusion. The local environment in which the mega event is held is also expected to benefit, for example, by improved traffic infrastructure or sanitation for the residents. On the other hand, for cities like Tokyo and Vancouver, mega events contribute to an increase in investment, tourist traffic as well as enhanced destination branding.

Hallmark events

Hallmark events highlight specific destinations and their cultural traditions. This type of event tends to focus on the heritage, culture, and traditions of a community. Although they can begin as small-scale events, there are possibilities that they can attract bigger audiences. They are often held annually and are designed

Did you know?

- The Dubai World Expo 2020 is expecting to attract a total of 25 million visitors with 70% of the visitors coming from outside the United Arab Emirates (UAE).
- Japan will attract 20 million tourists in 2020 by hosting the Olympic and Paralympic Games in Tokyo.

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to attract international tourists interested in a unique display of traditional culture and festivals.

Hallmark events can be hosted by a community, province, region, or a nation. Community hallmark events provide a sense of pride and belonging for the residents and strengthen the bond among them, as well as creating economic opportunities for local businesses. Hallmark events organised on a provincial, regional or national scale require more investment from the government, especially in infrastructure, risk management, and marketing. They also require inter-agency collaboration as well as private sector support. Some examples of national large-scale hallmark events include the Royal Edinburgh Military Tattoo in Scotland; Rose Parade in the USA; Carnival in Brazil; and the Oktoberfest in Germany.

Did you know?

- Holi celebration, popularly known as the Festival of Colours, is celebrated by Hindus across the world. It is a celebration of spring and the beginning of the spring harvest season. After some rituals, the Ragwali Holi is where people smear each other with many different colours. Everyone with different backgrounds, gender, age, will gather in open streets, parks and outside temples. This wonderful colourful festival takes place every March in the Indian subcontinent, Malaysia, South Africa, Singapore and Nepal.

- In Thailand, people gather every April in a big celebration of the Thai New Year. During the hottest season, what better way to celebrate Thai New Year than by getting soaking wet in the water on the streets? People arm themselves with water guns, hoses, buckets, or water bags. Sometimes, chalk or menthol is added to create a paste that people smear on each other's faces, which is believed to bring good fortune. The menthol is simply added for its refreshing effect. For Thai people, sprinkling water symbolizes blessing, purging, and new beginnings. Songkran is derived from the Sanskrit word for "astronomical passage", and is a three-day water fight no one can escape. You cannot walk out of the house without getting wet.

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Events based on content

Cultural events

Arts festivals, dance and music performances, religious fiestas, and historical celebrations are examples of cultural events. These events celebrate the life and traditions that strengthen the bonds within a community as they bring both residents, domestic and international tourists to participate in the event. Creative tourism events, a fast-growing sector of the events industry, emphasize the authenticity of the tourist experiences that focus on active participation and experiential interactions with arts, heritage, rituals, traditions as well as engagement with the members of the local community or destination.

Marketing events

Marketing events are organised by both private and public sector organisations. They can be used for many different purposes. Some common objectives are to inform target markets about new products, to gauge the reaction of the media and/or potential customers towards the new product or as promotional publicity campaigns to communicate a specific message to the target audience. There are also industry-specific marketing events focusing on a particular sector such as fashion, agriculture, medicine, and real estate, among others.

Marketing events have a clear purpose to achieve specific strategic, marketing and/or financial objectives and need to be designed so that they will change the behaviour of the participants.

MICE

Meetings, Incentives, Conventions, and Exhibitions (MICE), also called business events, are a significant part of the events industry. Many nations around the world have built, and are building, specialist facilities to host MICE events, for example, Singapore, Thailand, Malaysia, Indonesia and the Philippines.

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New conventions, conference and exhibition halls are being constructed to host large scale MICE events. New high quality international standard hotels are being opened adjacent to these MICE facilities to cater for the many thousands of international business people who attend the MICE events. These types of event generate multiple benefits for the host destination as they tend to attract high-value spending delegates, exhibitors, host organizations, and sponsors who can make a significant financial contribution to the local economy.

A meeting takes place when two or more people come together with a common agenda. People attend meetings for many different reasons: education, training, decision-making, research, sales, information exchange, networking, strategic planning, teambuilding and problem-solving. There are different categories of meetings such as a conference, congress, lecture, symposium, workshop, panel, forum, retreat, seminar, and clinic. A symposium is a formal presentation where there is limited interaction between presenters and the audience. A lecture is an individual presentation, often by one expert where the audience can ask questions after the discussion. In a panel presentation, two or more resource persons offer their opinions on a specific topic. Workshops require hands-on activities to facilitate learning which deal with specific problems, issues or assignments. A forum is an interactive discussion led by invited speakers. A panel, workshop, and forum require the presence of a moderator or facilitator to manage the discussions. Seminars provide opportunities for much interaction between participants and resource speakers with considerable sharing of knowledge and experience from all parties. A clinic refers to training activities, for example, sports activities, where drills and instructions are given to hone specific skills. While retreats are generally spiritual, are usually conducted in a location away from a city and are used for bonding, planning sessions or relaxation and meditation.

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Incentive travel is normally a reward to employees for their hard work and commitment to their employer. Organisations use incentive travel to motivate their employees and to encourage them to achieve business goals such as a sales quota set by a company. Incentive travel can include an enjoyable vacation to a tourist destination where a variety of activities are provided for the participants – sports (golf, ballooning), leisure (casino games, shopping), well-being (spa and massage treatments), and entry to special events (music concerts).As part of the incentive travel experience, the participants will also take part in formal business-oriented sessions that will help them to improve their job-related skills and experience. An example of an incentive travel destination product is Experience Korea in which the marketing strategy aims to showcase Korea's culture, health facilities, sports activities, and festivals. The Experience Korea product includes Temple Stay, *Dado* (tea ceremony), *hanbang* (Korean natural and holistic medicine); *gukgung* (Korean archery); and a visit to a rural folk village.

A convention can be defined as a large event where many participants come together for a pre-determined period in a specific place to share and discuss issues, topics and themes of mutual interest. A defining aspect of a convention is that it is large-scale and will require a purpose-built convention centre to host the event. Political parties hold annual conventions for their members as do industry associations. Conventions tend to combine several different events within the program– conference speeches, smaller-scale meetings, and exhibitions of products or services.

An exhibition is a showcase of products and services with a highly-targeted visitor market. Consumer shows are open to the public and may charge a small entrance fee. Trade shows, on the other hand, are positioned as business-to-business events. These

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events target corporate visitors and volume buyers interested in generating leads and sales revenues, product demonstrations, and networking, among other objectives. It is possible to schedule exclusive days for business organizations first before opening the exhibition to the public. Exhibitions can be categorized by industry, host country, and by organizing group. An exposition refers to a large-scale industrial, regional exhibition scheduled for a longer time, often for several weeks in the same venue.

Niche events

These refer to specialized events highlighting a distinctive offering such as nature, retail, gastronomic, or literature. Examples of nature and natural phenomenon which have been created into event experiences include the Northern Lights (Canada, Scandinavia); Butanding Festival (Philippines); Cherry Blossom (Japan); and the Wildebeest Migration (Kenya). Other examples of niche events are the Calgary Stampede (Canada); and the Lumberjack World Championship (USA).

Philanthropic and advocacy events

Fundraising, medical-dental missions, fun runs, and auctions are among the most common types of philanthropic events. These are designed to raise monies for a specific organization as well as providing free specialist services for the marginalized sectors of

Did you know?

- In Asia, wedding events are 'big business' and contribute significantly to an event company's product portfolio. Most Asian families spend a lot of money on wedding rituals and celebrations for their children. Thousands of people can be invited to a wedding. The size of the wedding shows your social status. A movie named Crazy Rich Asians illustrates very clearly this phenomenon.

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the community. Advocacy events focus on a specific cause or issue such as art scholarships, children's literacy, and community-based crafts. There are events which include these activities within the overall program. Decision-makers may likewise reserve a share of the proceeds of the event as their contribution to their preferred charity. The event manager must be sensitive to the vision, mission, and core values of the philanthropic organization when organising an event on their behalf.

Social events

Social events generally include life-cycle celebrations such as weddings, anniversaries, birthdays, and reunions. These focus on personal achievements and milestones, usually attended by friends and family. Another type of social event is those designed exclusively for an elite group, association, or club. Gala nights, auctions, and award ceremonies are examples of these. Fandom, on the other hand, is fast becoming the most anticipated event for fans and aficionados of a specific genre of pop culture. Some of these are the Star Trek convention, Comicon, Korean pop (Kpop), cosplay, and anime events. What differentiates these from other events is the level of engagement of the participants. Not only are they interested in meeting their idols, but they also attend to showcase their costumes, meet like-minded individuals, as well as buy or trade memorabilia.

Sports events

Sports events can either focus on one sport, such as boxing, or simultaneous and multiple sports events like those presented in the Olympic Games. Multiple bodies, such as government and private sports organizations, agree on internationally-accepted rules and policies which are used in managing the games. These rules of engagement include guidelines on attire, venues for the games, contest guidelines, and criteria for judging.

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There are three categories of sports: traditional, hybrid, and niche. Basketball, badminton, volleyball, and football are examples of traditional sports where there is almost no variation in the way the games are played and scored. There are traditional games that are held only in a defined area such as sumo wrestling in Japan and Muay Thai kick-boxing. However, a growing number of enthusiasts have begun hosting similar games in other countries. An example of this is the rodeo, which is common in the United States but is being hosted in the Philippines as well.

Hybrid sports, on the other hand, modify some parts of traditional games. For example, basketball is played with only three players on each side; dunes are used for skiing, and a beach is a venue for volleyball. Niche sports are innovations designed for unique audiences and participants. Some examples include the triathlon which combines running, cycling, and swimming; motocross which is cross-country racing; and the Paralympics which are geared for persons with physical disabilities.

Aside from these, recreational sports have become increasingly popular, even leading to the creation of their respective governing associations. Although originally designed for fun and relaxation, some of these have turned into competitive sports. These include skateboarding, fishing, sailing, surfing, horseback-riding, and rock climbing. There are games designed for exhibition matches where the concept of winning and losing is not the main goal, but instead, goodwill, image building, and training are the key.

Aside from these games, Massively Multiplayer Role-Playing Games (MMORPG) have generated international interest and large audiences. This refers to three-dimensional, highly immersive, computer-based games where players interact by competing against other teams in real-time. Originally played at home or internet stations, these are now hosted in large stadiums enabling participants to see the action in person.

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Irrespective of the type of sports event they all have one thing in common – they have to be professionally organised. This is because large numbers of participants take part in the sports (athletes, spectators and a variety of different suppliers and stakeholders) and as such the sports event organiser is responsible for the health and safety of all concerned as well as delivering an enjoyable event experience for everybody.

Events based on purpose

The event manager must always align the design of the event very firmly with the objectives of their client. Generally, events can be categorized based on two main objectives: business and recreation. However, a combination of these can be designed as well. Business events emphasize strategic goals. Leisure events, on the other hand, might be organised for the enjoyment, health, pleasure, relaxation and well-being of the participants. These include, but are not limited, to attending cultural events, visual and performing arts presentations.

Business and leisure activities are combined in MICE since incentive tours become part of the conference program or are events designed for the partner, spouse, or guest of the principal meeting delegates.

Events based on platform

Events can be offered through three main platforms: live, virtual, and hybrid. A large majority of events are presented live, onsite. The design, planning, and management of live events follow the traditional method of event organisation. A growing number of events are being conducted online, such as webinars and teleconferences. The live streaming of events over the internet and through social media is now commonplace, including business events, sports events, life-cycle events and live music entertainment events. Live streaming can be accessed

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through pay-per-view channels or free-of-charge via social media networks, such as Facebook. Hybrid events combine the elements of live and virtual presentations. For example, live concerts can be enhanced with holographic images.

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8 The Importance of the Events Industry

The events industry is a strong contributor to an economy whether that be at a national, regional or local level. Events:

- create jobs (full time, part-time, temporary and seasonal)
- attract inward investment to a locality
- generate foreign exchange when international events are organised
- can promote favourable impressions about a destination

In addition, the multiplier effect results in further income being generated within an economy as the initial spending by the event organizer and the event participants is re-circulated to the various suppliers and sub-contractors to the event who then re-circulate the income that they receive in further expenditure in the economy.

To illustrate, an event organizer uses the services of exhibit contractors. The monies paid to them for their services will, in turn, be used to pay suppliers who will provide them with the

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materials to prepare booth systems. In another example, an event participant might spend monies in the locality where the event is being staged on lodging, food and beverage, shopping and transportation. The monies spent by the event participant will be used by the owners of these facilities to pay for salaries, commissions, and operating expenses.

Events also have socio-cultural impacts. For example, events can be strong drivers of social progress and change. When event participants come together for celebratory events such as family gatherings, they will experience a sense of joy and well-being. In turn, this will enhance their sense of belonging and loyalty to their family and friends. When sports events are organised, the spectators will probably be motivated to take part in some aspect of physical activity related to the sports event. This physical activity will have an impact on the individual's health and well-being. Attending a live music event may help the participants to relax and immerse themselves fully in the event experience, which will contribute to their emotional calming.

Having introduced event management Chapter Three will explain the steps that have to be followed to prepare for the event.

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Case Study:

The Importance of Events – Mega Sports Events

Sports events take place all over the world and are one of the fastest-growing segments of the event industry. No matter the type, size or scale of the sports event, they all are very important for the stakeholders involved with them – the athletes, spectators, suppliers and the communities in which they are staged. The largest type of sports event to be organised is known as a mega event. Mega events are extremely large in scale, have a dramatic character, appeal to a global audience and have great national significances because of their economic, social and environmental impacts. Examples of mega sports events are the FIFA World Cup, the Olympic Games and the Asian Games.

Nations have to submit a formal bid to be selected as the host of a mega sports event. The bid has to demonstrate how the host nation and host city will benefit from staging the sports event. Mega sports events deliver more than just sport, they are catalysts for change, progress and development. Typical benefits of hosting a mega sports event include: regenerating an area of economic decline; showcasing the host city and the host nation as a tourist destination; boosting the confidence of the host city for staging similar events in the future; and transforming the physical environment of the host city to make it a better place for people to live and a better place for tourists to visit through improved leisure facilities and physical infrastructure. The local population will also benefit from the mega sports event as a result of increased social, cultural and employment opportunities.

The Asian Games, held every four years, are an example of a mega sports event involving multiple sports with competitors from

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throughout Asia. The most recent Asian Games took place in 2018 hosted in Indonesia by the two cities of Jakarta and Palembang. Both cities benefited considerably from hosting the games but Palembang, in particular, saw the most sports facilities and general infrastructural developments:

- The Jakabaring Sports City was developed further to provide international standard sports facilities that will enable Palembang to host major international sports events in the future: a new rowing centre and rowing lake; beach volleyball courts; a multi-purpose athletics stadium; new and improved tennis courts and stadium; shooting ranges; and a ten-pin bowling centre;
- The Bukit Assam Convention Hall was constructed to enable Palembang to hold large scale, international MICE events;
- The transport infrastructure in Palembang was developed further to include: a light rail overhead transit system to link the international airport with Palembang city centre and the Jakabaring Sports city; a fourth road bridge was constructed across the Musi River to relieve traffic congestion in Palembang; a new toll road was opened between Palembang and Indralaya to provide high-speed access to Palembang from locations in South Sumatra; and
- Supporting infrastructure investments were made to enable Palembang to host the 2018 Asian Games: water treatment and water purification technology; solid waste treatment facilities; solar power generators installed; new public toilets; and hydrogen fuel supplies introduced to enable public bus transport to run on hydrogen fuel.

A considerable financial investment was made by the national and regional governments of Indonesia to host the 2018 Asian Games and the expectation is that Palembang, in particular, will continue to bid for, and host, major sporting events in the future

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bringing further economic prosperity to the city. The population of Palembang will also benefit not only from improved infrastructural developments in their city and a cleaner, less congested environment but also from new employment opportunities. The new international standard sports facilities will also motivate members of the public in Palembang to engage in more active lifestyles which will improve their health and well-being.

So, mega sports events are not just about sports – they can have far-reaching benefits that last for many years into the future.

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chapter 3
preparing for the event

After reading this chapter, you will be able to:

- research and agree the scope of the event
- develop a business plan for an event
- plan and implement a critical path for the event
- research and select the venue for the event
- manage contracts for the event

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9 Research and Agree the Scope of an Event

When tasked with preparing an event, the first thing the event manager needs to do is to meet the client to understand fully why the event is being organised and what the expectations of the client are in terms of the scale and scope of the event. With this information, the event manager can then progress to all of the other stages in preparing for the event. The questions that the event manager needs to ask the client regarding the event include:

- concept and themes, importantly, the story that the event is to tell
- intended market, who is to be attracted to the event
- the number of people who will participate in the event
- financial goals of the event, for example, is the event to generate a profit for the client
- timing, the date(s) on which the event is to take place
- location of the event, where the event is to be held
- what approvals, licences, and permissions will be needed to hold the event?
- any special requirements that the client might have for staging the event

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- available resources that the client might have for staging the event, for example, technology
- what are the risks that could affect the safe running of the event?

A useful way of collecting the above information is for the event manager to design a questionnaire that can be used at each initial meeting that she or he has with every client. Spending time in researching and understanding precisely the scope of an event is essential and is a task that should be thoroughly undertaken by the event manager.

The next step that needs to be implemented by the event manager is to develop a business plan for the event.

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10 Develop a Business Plan for an Event

All events should have a business plan. This important document provides an overview of the event in terms of its management from a business perspective – how the event will be resourced and managed to meet the objectives that have been set for it. The main components of the event's business plan are the:

- mission statement
- aims and objectives
- critical success factors
- financial planning
- administration
- logistics and operations
- marketing and sales
- people and resources
- event evaluation
- leadership and management
- planning cycle and critical path/deadlines
- policies and procedures
- sponsorship or other revenue
- sustainability and ethical considerations

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Each of these components of the event business plan will now be looked at in turn.

The mission statement

A mission statement indicates the purpose and the reason why the event is being organised. Mission statements tend to be relatively concise, no more than three sentences and are written in a general way. A mission statement for a conference might be: 'To bring together event industry professionals to receive and share information about the role of digital technology in the creation of memorable business events. The participants in the conference will be event planners, organisers or managers who work with public sector clients'.

This mission statement will guide the event manager in planning the event, helping to keep all aspects of the decision-making process aligned to the purpose of the event.

Aims and objectives

The aims and the objectives of the event evolve from the mission statement. Aims are the general strategic direction and intent of the event whilst objectives are the specific targets that have to be met by holding the event.

The aims of the conference mentioned in the previous section could be:

> 'To increase awareness of the participants to the conference on the different types of digital technology that can be used by event managers to create memorable experiences at conferences that are organised for governmental departments. The overall aim of the conference is to ensure that event managers can utilise digital technology in the conferences that they organise'.

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Once the overall aims of the event have been agreed, the specific targets that have to be reached (the objectives) can then be set.

Setting objectives

Stakeholders of the event will invest the financial resources to make the event a success and will expect a return on the investment that they make. To ensure that the event stakeholders achieve their desired return on investment, the event manager has to set objectives (targets) that the event must attain.

Objectives must be SMART: specific, measurable, attainable, realistic, and time-bound. The objectives that are set by the event manager need to be quantifiable to enable them to be written in a SMART format. For example, continuing to use the example of the digital technology conference mentioned above, this conference might have the following objectives to:

- attract 200 attendees to the conference
- ensure that the attendees comprise at least 70% of event planners, event organisers and event managers who work with governmental clients

With SMART objectives set, the event manager and the event stakeholders have a target to achieve in advance and also a measure to use after the event to assess the success of the conference. Therefore, the event manager must understand the client's expectations for the event that is being organised.

Event managers have to define clearly the event objectives to ensure that they are not broad, abstract, or intangible. To illustrate, Figure 2 presents two more examples of SMART objectives for events.

No matter the type of objective that is set, one characteristic that each objective has to have is that it can be written in the SMART format.

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Figure 2: Sample SMART Objectives

General Objective	SMART Objective
Increase sales	Increase sales of textbooks on sustainable event practices to European distributors by 40%.
Increase sponsorship revenues	Recruit 10 new sponsors to generate an additional sponsorship income of US$1,200,000

Once the aims and objectives of the event have been set, the next part of the business plan is to identify the critical success factors of the event.

Critical success factors

Critical success factors (CSFs) are those activities and their organisation that are needed for the event to be a success. When preparing for the event, these are the activities that the event manager should identify and then concentrate on to ensure that the event will be successful. A limited number of CSFs should be identified, as the purpose of identifying CSFs is to identify those activities that are fundamental to the overall success of the event. The CSFs will vary from one event to another, depending on the type of event, its location, and its target market. For the example that has been used previously in this section, that of the digital technology conference, the CSFs may be:

- identifying correctly and precisely the target audience for the conference so that the main attendees are event planners, event organisers, and event managers
- developing a database of the accurate contact details of the potential conference participants so that personal invitations can be sent to each potential participant

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- staging the conference in a venue that will enable a variety of different digital technologies to be demonstrated to the participants

Identifying CSFs is essential as they allow the event manager to focus on ensuring that they are being met through the preparation and planning process of the event. If CSFs are not set, there could well be a strategic drift away from those activities and factors that are essential for the event to be successful.

Financial planning

All events have to be financially sustainable. If an event manager is unable to prepare, plan and organise an event that generates sufficient income to cover its costs and, hopefully, to make a surplus, then the event manager will probably be unable to continue working in the events industry.

All events have to have a financial plan. The components of the financial plan are the expenses (costs) that will be incurred in organising and staging the event and the income that will be generated by the event. The difference between the expenses and the income will either result in a financial loss being made for the event or a financial surplus.

There are two types of expenses: fixed and variable expenses. Fixed expenses are those that will need to be paid by the event manager irrespective of the number of participants attending the event. For example, the office rent will have to be paid whether tickets to an event have been sold out or not. On the other hand, variable expenses are costs that change based on the number of participants attending the event. For example, catering costs will increase when the number of participants increases. Figure 3 provides some examples of fixed and variable expenses for an event.

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Figure 3: Sample Lists of Expenses

Fixed Expenses	Variable Expenses Based on the Number of Participants Attending the Event
Artists, entertainers, performers & speakers fees	Food and beverage costs
Audio-visual equipment	Hire costs of tables and chairs
Decorations & banners	Souvenirs for the participants
Design costs	Temporary labour costs
Equipment maintenance	Water costs
Erection of stands and displays	Accommodation costs
Insurance	Transportation costs
Licenses	Costs related to volunteers and interns
Marketing and social media	
Marquees	
Office rent and equipment	
Permits	
Salaries and wages of permanent employees	
Security	
Signage	
Staging & rigging	
Technical equipment	
Venue rental	
Waste disposal	
Web Design/web administrator	

The exact costs that will be incurred in organising an event will depend on the type of event. Once all the costs in staging the event have been identified and calculated, it is normal to add a further 10% of these costs onto the overall expenditure of the event as a contingency fund. This fund is to provide a margin of error if

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some of the costs increase during the preparation and planning phase of the event or an unforeseen item of expenditure arises.

The income for the event will come from a number of sources which will be determined by the actual event being staged:

- advertising income
- bar takings
- booth rentals
- broadcasting rights
- concessionaire rental fees
- donations
- entrance fees
- franchising
- licensing fees
- merchandising income
- pledges of money from benefactors
- programme sales
- public funds – grants of money
- raffles
- registration fees
- sponsorships
- stall-holders fees
- ticket sales.

Careful financial planning is essential for all events. A budget has to be prepared at the early planning stages of the event to determine whether it will meet its financial objectives or not. If it is discovered that it will not, the event manager has to decide whether, or not, to continue with the preparations and planning for the event.

An Excel spreadsheet should be used for specifying and calculating the financial budget for the event. The spreadsheet should include

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financial projections of the income that will be generated by ticket sales and other sources and the expenditures that will be incurred in organising and staging the event. The financial projections require appropriate forecasting techniques for the costs of labour, supplies, rent, and other pertinent expenses. These can be based on historical data from organising previous events, current market rates, and possible increases in costs due to inflation.

If the event is an international one, the event manager must understand the implications of receiving and making payments in foreign currencies and should try to anticipate any fluctuations in foreign currency exchange rates which might affect the budget for the event. Foreign currency exchange rates usually fluctuate over time; the event manager needs to be aware of this.

The event manager must include a spreadsheet in the business plan that indicates the anticipated income, expenses, and profit that the event is anticipated to make. An example of a financial plan for an event is provided in Figure 4.

Did you know?

- The event manager needs to know the local culture and unwritten rules in the surrounding locality of the venue where the event is being staged. In some Asian countries, an extra budget has to be allocated for 'illegal' police who ask for extra money to 'secure' the event and to make sure that the event runs without undue interference.
- In some regions, the event manager might be offered the services of a 'rain man' – someone who is felt to have special powers that enable the weather to be controlled. The belief is that the rain man can prevent rainfall or can move the rain clouds into another locality.

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Figure 4: Sample Pro-Forma Income and Expenses Statement for a Meeting, Exhibit, and/or Conference
(Three Scenarios: Best, Normal, and Worst)

ITEM	20XX	20XX	20XX
	Best	Normal	Worst
SERVICE INCOME			
Exhibitor Participation Fees			
Seminar Fees			
Delegate Registration Fees			
Sponsorship Revenues			
Subtotal, SERVICE INCOME			
Less: COSTS AND EXPENSES			
Costs of Services			
Materials & Supplies			
Venue Rental			
Security			
Housekeeping			
Certificates			
Identification Cards			
Souvenir Programs/Catalogues			
Gifts/Tokens			
Plaques of Appreciation			
Subtotal			
Salaries & Wages			
Employees' Benefits			
Cash Advances			
Marketing and Communications			
Use of Technologies			
Subtotal			
Other Expenses			
Office Rental			
Representation Allowances			
Depreciation			
Utilities			

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Taxes and Licenses			
Gasoline and Fuel			
Transportation and Travel			
Repairs and Maintenance			
Office Supplies			
Miscellaneous			
Subtotal			
TOTAL COSTS & EXPENSES			
Service Income before Taxes			
Provision for Income Tax			
Service Income after Taxes			
NET INCOME (Service Income after Tax minus Costs & Expenses)			

Administration

The administrative structure and team of people that are put in place to prepare, plan, organise and manage the event will depend on the size and scale of the event. A small-scale event, such as a meeting for 20 people, can be administered by a single event manager with one or two assistants. In contrast, a large conference that attracts 2,000 people will need to have a formal administrative structure to ensure that the event is successful. For a large-scale event, the event manager will need to establish several task-related committees to prepare, plan, organise, and manage specific elements of the event. Examples of the different committees for a large-scale event include the:

- Accommodation Committee – arranging special room tariffs for event participants at the hotels that are used for the event,

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making reservations at hotels for the event participants

- Finance Committee – to establish the budget for the event and to manage all the income and expenditure
- Health & Safety Committee – responsible for undertaking the risk assessment for the event and the implementation of the security, health & safety strategy
- Logistics Committee – organising all aspects of transportation that is needed for the event, liaising with all of the sub-contractors who might be involved in setting up the rigging, staging, lighting and audio technology for the event
- Marketing Committee – tasked with designing the marketing strategy to be implemented to ensure that the participant registrations meet the objectives that have been set
- Program Committee – responsible for designing and managing the content for the event and for liaising with the speakers, artists and performers
- Secretariat – the committee that develops the strategy for the event and oversees the work of all the other committees
- Technical Committee – responsible for the actual organisation and management of all the audio, visual and multi-media technology that is required to make the event a success

Each of the committees will comprise a team of people who will be managed by a team leader whose title might be 'Head of the Finance Committee'. The 'Heads' of each committee will then report directly to the event manager who will lead the work of each committee, making sure that the committee is undertaking its work on time and to the correct quality standard.

The event manager will need to organise regular meetings at which all the heads of the committee are present. These meetings will be essential for the sharing of information and solving problems that have arisen and need to be resolved prior to the commencement of the event.

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Logistics and operations

The business plan needs to include information on the logistical and operational management of the event. The type and scale of the event will determine what is included in this section of the business plan. Depending on the type of event being staged, the following information might need to be included in the business plan:

- the program for the event to include the main activities such as opening ceremonies, keynote speakers, break-out sessions, gala dinners and the awards ceremony
- entertainment activities such as games, performances, and parties designed to engage the participants
- the food and beverage provision – the menus for the event, kitchens, food preparation & storage areas, the serving stations and the seating arrangements for the participants
- transportation – how will all the equipment and resources needed for the event be transported to the event venue, what is the delivery schedule for the equipment and resources to ensure that they arrive on the correct date and time
- warehousing and storage – will special secure facilities be needed to store the equipment and resources
- the event set-up – who is responsible for setting-up the different physical resources for the event (staging, rigging, seating, audio-visual technology etc)
- the management of operations during the event (stage managers, event production team, stewarding, first aiders etc)
- the break-down of the event – who is responsible for de-constructing the event site, the facilities, and equipment
- traffic management and car parking arrangements
- safety & security – who will provide security for the event and what is the health & safety strategy to include emergency procedures

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Marketing and sales

The event will not be successful unless it attracts the target number of participants to make the event a financial success. To attract participants, a detailed marketing and sales strategy needs to be designed and implemented. The components of this strategy will normally comprise the following elements:

- marketing objectives – these need to be written in the SMART format and will typically relate to the number of participants to be attracted to the event, or creating awareness of the products or services being featured in the event, or relating to the impact of the event's social media marketing strategy on the behaviour of the participants at the event
- market segmentation – who are the different groups of event participants that could be interested in attending the event and the demographic profile of the market segments?
- target marketing – which specific market segments will be targeted to achieve the sales objective for the event?
- creation of a differential advantage – how will the event 'position itself' in the perceptions of the target markets in order to be distinctive from other similar events that might be organised by competing event companies?
- design of the communication strategy – the event website, social media communication strategy, advertising, publicity
- distribution strategy – how will tickets for the event be advertised and sold?
- pricing strategy – what will be the prices that participants pay and will any discounted prices be offered?
- sales strategy – is there a need for salespeople to be recruited to promote the event to key clients within the target market through face-to-face selling?

Designing an effective marketing and sales strategy is a very skilful process. For large events, this function may be sub-contracted to a professional marketing consultancy.

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Figure 5: A Sample List of Marketing Communication Tools

Billboard advertising
Celebrity endorsements
Co-branding with sponsors and partners
Direct mail campaigns
Ebooks
Email distribution
Flyers
Gifts and tokens
Influencers on social media
Inserts
Jingles
Merchandising
Newsletter advertising
Printed media advertising
Personal selling
Press conferences and publicity
Public relations campaigns
Radio advertisements
Sales promotion techniques
Social media advertising
Special events
Sponsorships
Taste tests
Television advertising
Trade journal advertising
Vouchers

Did you know?

- Halal food (contain no pork and no lards) and vegan foods will be needed in business events if the participants are Muslim. The food vendors and suppliers should have a halal certificate to produce halal food.

- Some events are organised to include food and beverages from 'sustainable food chain' sources and suppliers. This is felt to be ethically responsible where the populations of the world are increasingly becoming aware of the need for increased consciousness about healthy and ecological living.

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People and resources

The event manager always works with a team of people. In writing this section of the business plan, the event manager will need to understand the labour regulations as well as the culture of the country where the event will be held.

This section of the business plan provides information on the staffing requirements for the event, job descriptions, rates of pay for hourly-paid employees, hours of work, and lines of authority for the events team. It also recommends best staffing combinations as the people working at the event will fall into different categories:

- full-time employees
- part-time employees
- supplier and contractor employees
- volunteers

The job titles should reflect the responsibilities that they will perform, for example, registration administrator, artist liaison officer, event production manager, stage manager, or banqueting manager.

Delegating to the right people is important. The event manager must oversee all elements of the event coming together and leave specific tasks to experts, volunteers, or staff. Each person must be aware of the importance of their role and the contribution that they are making to the success of the event. The event manager should hold regular meetings and provide updates to all the event staff to reduce friction within the team, address any gaps in knowledge, and rectify variances from performance standards. Problems must be addressed before they escalate into serious difficulties that could affect the success of the event. The event manager should troubleshoot any issues to avoid problems.

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Depending on the type of event that is being staged, the resources that the employees require to do their jobs will fall into certain categories:

- office equipment – desks, chairs, mobile phones, laptops, tablets, printers, stationary
- logistical equipment – tractors, trailers, mechanical hoists, scaffolding
- clothing – high visibility jackets, protective goggles, hard hats, or boots
- communication technologies – laptops, mobile phones, personal two-way radios, tablets

The business plan for the event should provide not only the job functions that the event requires but also the name and contact details of the person fulfilling that role and the resources that they will need – see Figure 6.

Leadership and management

The business plan needs to include a section that provides information on who will lead and manage the event. This section will be quite concise if the event is relatively small-scale as it is likely that the leadership and management team will be fairly small. However, for major and mega events, there will likely be a complex leadership team as large-scale events need to be

Figure 6: Job Functions and Resources

Job Title	Name	Mobile	Resources
Artist Liaison Officer	Judith Jones	0778845312	Tablet, two-way radio
Stage Manager	Alice Evans	0798564321	Laptop, desk & chair

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managed by many people who will be representing different stakeholder organisations. In the case of a major or mega sports event, the leadership and management team will be composed, for example, of senior executives from the events organising company, the sports federations, local and national government, emergency services, and the security services.

Irrespective of the size of the leadership and management team, the names of the people within it have to be recorded in the business plan for the event, see Figure 7.

Figure 7: The Leadership and Management Team of the Event

Name	Contact details	Responsibility
Event Manager: Josephine Hermes	Mobile phone number: 07920550671 Radio channel: Number 1	Event team leader Lead and co-ordinate the whole event management team Media contact (unless a media spokesperson has been appointed)
Floor Manager: John Thompson	Mobile phone number: 07684321546 Radio channel: Number 2	Co-ordinating contractors within the venue. Managing all activities on the stage
Venue Manager: Rita Smith	Mobile phone number: 07769342158 Radio channel: Number 3	Co-ordinating all venue departments
Health, Safety & Emergency Planning Manager: Elaine Evans	Mobile phone number: 07854378999 Radio channel: Number 4	Managing all aspects of health & safety. Co-ordinating police, fire and ambulance services.

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Event evaluation

All events have to be evaluated to determine if they have been successful. There are various ways of assessing the success of an event:

- determining if the objectives have been met
- measuring the satisfaction of the participants
- assessing the success with the stakeholders: the client, sponsors, and other people who have had an involvement with the event
- evaluating the impact of the event on the economy, environment, and socio-cultural population

To receive accurate feedback on the event's success, a rigorous and thorough method of collecting the data should be used, which will include a variety of different techniques. These research methods include questionnaire surveys that can be implemented through face-to-face interviews conducted at the event itself or via technology such as chatbots or through post-event surveys using social media.

The design of the event evaluation research should be part of the preparations that the event manager undertakes and the metrics that are used in the evaluation process should be agreed in advance by all the event stakeholders.

Planning cycle and critical path/deadlines

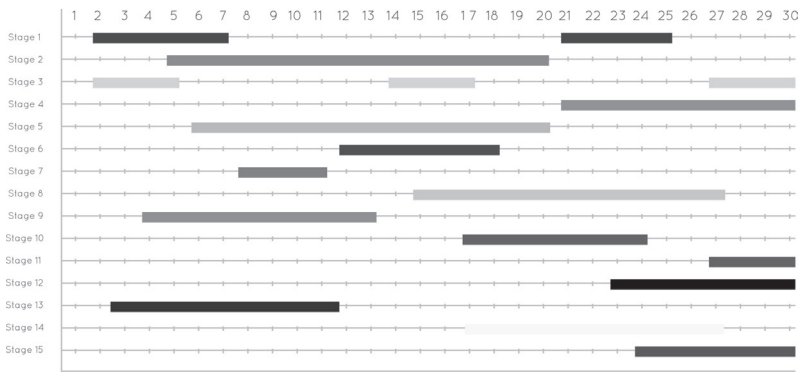
At the preparation stage of the event, it will be crucial to understand precisely what is to be completed by specific dates in preparing for and planning the event. This part of the business plan can also be called 'project management'. Project management identifies the activities that must be completed by specific dates for the project (the event) to take place. Each activity will be identified and an estimate will be given for how long it will take to complete this activity. The time that is given

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to complete each activity should be as accurate as possible and allow 'slippage time' for any unforeseen factors that might delay the activity being completed on schedule.

Some tools that can be used for project management are Network diagrams and Gantt charts. These tools help the event manager to plan the time that each activity will take to complete and enables the overall time to prepare and plan for the event to be calculated. Within a project, objectives can run in a sequence or parallel to other activities. Those activities that run-in sequence are reliant on a previous activity having already been completed. Those activities that can run in parallel with other activities are ones that are not reliant on another activity having been completed and so they can be undertaken at the same time as another activity.

Figure 8: An Example of a Gantt Chart



Every event should have a project management plan - this is an extremely useful tool for the event manager to use to evaluate the progress that is being made in preparing and planning for the event. If it is identified that some activities are behind schedule, the event manager can work with his or her team to identify

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ways of overcoming the difficulties and returning the project to its expected time-schedule.

Policies and procedures

Policies are principles that guide the overall direction of a particular functional area of an organisation whilst procedures are more detailed step-by-step process-orientated instructions that have to be followed and implemented to ensure compliance with the policies. Policies and procedures specify the standards of performance and behaviour that employees have to meet and how they are to conduct the business of the organisation to meet all relevant laws and regulations. Well written policies and procedures contribute to the culture of the organisation and how it is perceived by its employees and stakeholders.

Some events that the event manager is responsible for might be quite straightforward from an organisational perspective and as such no policies or procedures are required. However, some events might be quite complex and involve multiple-stakeholders and as a consequence will require policies and procedures to ensure that all event personnel are working to the agreed standards.

It is the event manager's responsibility to consider very carefully the nature and scope of the event and to decide if there is a need for policies and procedures to be in place. If required, policies and procedures should be specified in the business plan for the event. Policies and procedures could include:

- caring for event participants with special needs
- employing event personnel
- environmental policy
- handling hazardous materials
- handling cash and the secure control of cash

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- health, safety and evacuation procedures
- staff code of conduct
- the preparation, storage, and serving of food and beverages
- traffic management
- using special effects, such as pyrotechnics

Sponsorship and other revenues

Most events require a diverse range of income streams to make them financially viable. Sponsorship funding is often an important component of the financial budget and the event manager will also seek other income streams which may arise from merchandising, the sales of concessionary stands for exhibitors and funds from media companies for the broadcasting rights of the event. All of these sources of funding should be detailed in the event business plan.

Sustainability

Events involve large numbers of people coming together in a specific venue. The logistical setting-up of the event, the running of the event and the taking-down of the event can all harm the environment, for example through traffic congestion and pollution, the generation of waste items during the event and the leaving of garbage in the venue when the event has finished. It is the event manager's responsibility to develop an environmental strategy to ensure that the negative impacts of the event on the environment are reduced and the positive impacts of the event on the environment are accentuated.

The business plan should indicate where sustainable event practices can be implemented. Sustainable practices are those aspects that can be designed to reduce the negative impact of the event on the environment. The following is a list of sustainable initiatives that can be used at events:

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Contractors and Suppliers:

- are contractors and suppliers of materials and equipment near the venue
- require contractors and suppliers to implement proper garbage disposal measures
- require contractors and suppliers to use recyclable materials

Food and Beverage:

- locally source the food and beverage for the event
- only produce enough food and beverages for the number of participants expected
- reusable tableware
- use of paper instead of plastic cutlery, cups and plates
- offer waste food for recycling to local farms

Marketing:

- use alternative electronic payment options
- use digital gifts and souvenirs
- use mobile applications to reduce the need for paper and printing
- use online technologies for invitations, registration, documentation, identification cards
- use online technologies for surveys, collaborative work, discussion groups
- use recycled paper if paper documents have to be produced

Transportation:

- offer shared transport services (Grab and Uber)
- organise shuttle bus services from car parks to the event venue
- provide public transport options for the participants to travel to the venue

Venues:

- accessible to public transport links

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- available function rooms within one venue
- carbon offset measures
- energy-saving measures
- reduced use of bottles and plastics
- use of recyclable water supply
- use of renewable sources of energy
- with available local suppliers and contractors

Ethics

Ethics are moral principles that affect human behaviour. As an event manager, there will be many situations in which the manager has to decide if it is ethically (morally) correct to pursue a particular course of action. Sometimes, the ethical decision is enforced in law in which case the event manager has to abide by the law. In other circumstances, the event manager might face a 'moral dilemma' and will have to decide on which course of action or line of behaviour to adopt. Whilst it will not be possible to include all ethical decisions that the event manager might face in the business plan, there could be a requirement to include those ethical requirements that might arise because of the culture and customs of the country within which the event is taking place. This is particularly important when the event is taking place in a culture that is different from the event manager's own country.

Did you know?

Some societies, associations and government organisations have strict principals and regulations that affect the staging of events. In some cases, the event manager has to cancel the event, for example, a live music gig, because the musicians' clothes, dance routines, or tattoos do not conform to the beliefs and cultural norms of the locality in which the concert is taking place.

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Some of the ethical concerns that relate to working in countries other than our own include:

- attitudes towards alcohol
- attitudes towards gambling
- bribes
- dress
- non-verbal behaviour
- verbal communication

It will be essential for the event manager to include in the business plan those norms of behaviour (ethical requirements) that have to be respected in the country where the event is taking place.

Preparing a business plan for an event is an important part of the preparation stage for organising an event. As indicated in the previous sections, a detailed and thorough business plan will assist the event manager in taking forward the concept into the actual real event. The business plan also helps to communicate what the event is and how it will be organised to all the stakeholders who have an interest in the success of the event.

The main sections of a business plan are as follows:

Cover page
This front page of the business plan for the event will include the logo of the event manager's company, the name/title of the event, the dates when the event will take place, and the location of the event.

Table of Contents
The section number and title of each section with the page number.

Confidentiality Agreement
This refers to the confidentiality of the contents of the business

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plan and could include a non-disclosure agreement between the event manager and the event stakeholders who will receive a copy of the business plan. A non-disclosure agreement prevents anyone who receives a copy of the business plan from sharing it or informing other people about the contents of the business plan. The non-disclosure agreement safeguards against undue competition from other event organising companies who might be given a copy of the business plan by an event stakeholder.

Executive Summary

The executive summary provides an overview of the business plan. It summarizes key points and recommendations to ensure a successful event. Among these are the brief description of the proposed event concept, its mission, aims and objectives, the recommended target participants and the overall design of the event and its business management.

The Main Body

This main section of the business plan will provide information on all the aspects of the business plan that have been mentioned previously in this chapter.

Appendices

The appendices to the business plan can include attachments of images, photos, and sample illustrations for the décor, floor plan, and layout of the event.

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11 Plan and Implement a Critical Path for an Event

A critical path is defined as the sequence of activities that have to be completed in order for a project (in this case the planning of the event) to be completed on time. Designing a critical path for a project is based on the assumption that a certain activity cannot be started until a previous activity has finished. Planning and implementing a critical path involves evaluating what exactly needs to be achieved for a project to take place then planning the various stages and activities that have to be undertaken to implement the project. Events can be quite complex to organise as they might involve many different activities and there may well be many different people, resources and organisations to co-ordinate. So, devising and implementing a critical path for an event is an essential task for the event manager.

The steps to follow when devising a critical path for an event are:

- identify all the activities that have to be completed
- analyse each activity to understand what each activity

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involves – what has to be done and completed, who will undertake the work, and the resources required to undertake each activity
- calculate the time to complete each activity and understand which ones will need a longer time to complete; some activities will be completed in hours, others in days, weeks or months
- analyse the relationships between the activities – which activities have to be completed first and which one subsequently need to be completed
- identify which activities can be completed simultaneously
- confirm the logical order in which each activity has to be implemented – the sequence of activities
- identify potential risks and other contingencies that might affect the activities being completed on time and plan how to deal with these
- build into the critical path 'slippage time' to give a margin of error if some of the activities take longer to complete than expected
- identify the 'milestones'- the times in the critical path when major tasks need to be completed in order for the project as a whole to be on schedule

Due to the complexity of some events and the many factors that might lead to problems occurring when they are being prepared, the event manager will likely form a team of colleagues to assist with the project planning and the creation of the event's critical path sequence.

Detailed planning is essential for the creation of a critical path for an event, with Network diagrams or Gantt charts being used to sequence the activities that are needed for the event to start on time. Network diagrams and Gantt charts are visual tools that map out the activities and show the duration (hours, days or weeks) that each activity will take to complete. The Network

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diagram or Gantt chart is a valuable control tool that can be used to monitor the progress being made in preparing for the event. If the preparations for the event are not running to the schedule and sequence specified in the Network diagram or the Gantt chart, corrective action can be taken. Activities along the critical path cannot be delayed or take longer than their estimated time to complete, without affecting the overall duration of the project. An effective event manager ensures that the time to complete each activity is strictly adhered to, otherwise the event might not start on its scheduled date and within the agreed budget.

A Network diagram is a set of boxes that represent each activity, with arrows connecting the boxes in the sequence that each activity has to be completed. Software applications such as Microsoft Project can be used for designing Network diagrams.

A Gantt chart presents the activities to be completed in the form of a bar chart with each bar representing a different activity and drawn to scale according to the length of time it will take to complete the activity. Gantt charts can be easily created using either a table in a word-processing application or by using a spreadsheet application and shading in the cells where an activity occurs.

The event manager should use critical path analysis to ensure that the event starts on time and to budget. Once the critical path for the event has been designed:

- activities can be assigned to appropriate individuals or groups
- adequate resources can be allocated to the activities
- it can be reviewed at appropriate intervals to:
  - analyse variations between estimated and actual time and resources needed to achieve goals
  - solve problems and make necessary adjustments
  - communicate with individuals and groups
  - record progress for future planning

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Figure 9: An Example of the Steps Required to Produce a Network Diagram

Activity Symbol	Activity Description	Immediate Predecessors
A	Develop the advertising plan (a detailed plan of projected social media, radio, television, and newspaper advertising)	
B	Develop the promotion and training materials plan (a detailed study of the materials that will be required for training the event volunteers)	
C	Develop the training plan (the design of the training program that the event volunteers will undertake prior to the start of the event)	
D	Schedule the social media, radio, television, and newspaper advertisements that will appear prior to the event	A
E	Develop the advertising copy that will be required	A
G	Prepare promotion materials which will be used for the advertising campaign	B
H	Prepare materials which will be used in the training program for the event volunteers	B
I	Conduct a press conference	D, F
J	Screen and select the event volunteers who will undergo training	C
K	Conduct the training program	H, J
L	The final preparations for the event	G, I, K

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Figure 10: An Example of a Network Diagram

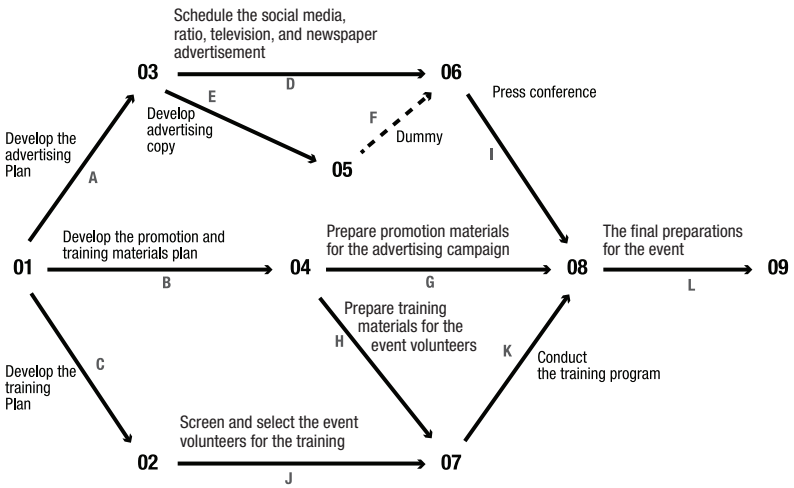
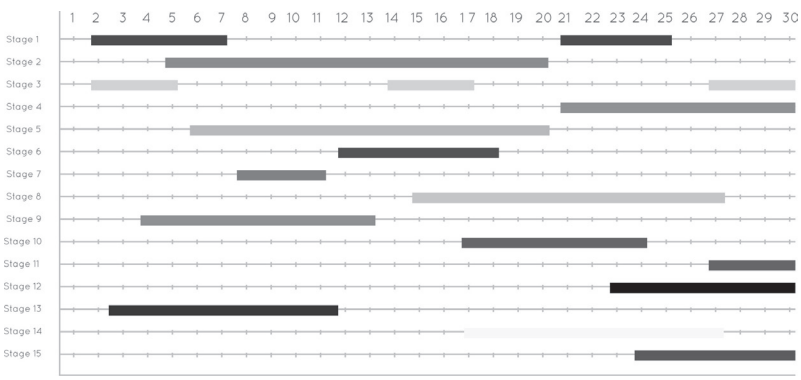


Figure 11: An Example of a Gantt Chart



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12 Research and Select a Venue for an Event

Factors to consider when selecting event venues

Choosing the right venue for the event is an essential part of the event preparation process because the venue is a key building block for client and participant satisfaction and enjoyment. Aligning the event venue to the theme and concept of the event plays a major role in creating a memorable event experience. Selecting the right event venue is a key role of the event manager's responsibilities as the event venue can be central to the overall design and impact of the event. The starting place for researching and selecting a venue is to fully understand the client's objectives for staging the event and then to develop a profile of who will be the event participants. With this information, the event manager can focus clearly on the specific requirements for selecting the best venue in which to stage the event.

Selecting a venue is partly based on the event manager's judgement as to which venue will be most suitable for hosting the event and partly based on detailed analysis and evaluation of the event venues that are available in the destination where the event is to be held. In selecting an event venue, there are many options available to the event manager which include purpose-built

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venues, such as hotels, concert halls, convention and exhibition centres, to venues which can be repurposed so that they become unusual and unique event spaces, for example, places of worship (churches and cathedrals) to the many outdoor spaces which are being used as event venues (rainforests and beaches). The theme and concept of the event will be a key factor in selecting the event venue, for example, whether the event is to educate, entertain, inspire or to provide meeting and networking opportunities for the event participants.

Today, the range of venues available for the event manager to choose from is extremely varied and the venue that is selected should harmonise with the purpose and concept of the event. Increasingly, the venue becomes a major component of the event itself. The event participants will look forward with anticipation to going to a specific event venue because it may well be an iconic venue such as a historic monument or an extremely high-tech venue. Every event is unique and the right venue, with the right staging, can transform a bare space into a magical location that creates memorable experiences for the event participants.

In terms of services for holding the event, some venues provide both lodging and function rooms while others are designed without accommodation. Traditional indoor venues such as hotels and resorts offer the convenience of accommodation, meeting space and production design all within a single physical site. Hotels and resorts generally have departments that manage banquets, décor, and staging requirements. These departments can also assist with the staging of outdoor events that are held on the grounds of the hotel or resort, such as beach weddings and teambuilding events.

On the other hand, non-traditional venues like art galleries, bookstores, cafes, historical monuments, outdoor public spaces,

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and places of worship do not always have their own departments to manage the event and so the event manager may well sub-contract elements of the event's organisation to specialist companies with skills in staging events in non-traditional venues. So, one factor to consider when selecting an event venue is the type of venue and the support services that will be needed to implement the event concept.

The size of the venue will also be a determinant in whether a specific venue can be used for the event. Staging and production for the event can require high ceilings, open layouts, and a considerable amount of space for the participants to sit or stand at the event. Therefore, the event manager must review the event concept and select a venue that best provides the event requirements at the optimal price. In selecting the event venue, it will be essential to ensure that the space is not too large or too small for the number of participants and that the space available enables the creative aspects of the event to be delivered effectively.

Today, most events incorporate technology into the design and creative aspects of the event. The event manager needs to investigate carefully the technological capabilities of each venue that could be used for staging the event. Key technological criteria for selecting a venue include the venue's capability for enabling the event to utilise virtual reality, artificial reality, and artificial intelligence during the event and the connectivity of the venue for video-conferencing as well as the equipment that the venue can provide such as LCD projection screens and equipment. Robust Wi-Fi provision that provides access to the internet for multiple devices at a speed of more than 3mb/second for each participant is essential in event venues.

Types of venues

Academic Venues

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- Alumni hall
- Chapel
- Classrooms
- Gymnasium
- Campus open spaces
- Library
- Student lounge/union
- University auditorium
- University museum

Attractions

- Amusement parks
- Man-made attractions
- Natural attractions
- Theme parks
- Tourist attractions
- UNESCO heritage sites

Civic Venues

- Association headquarters
- Country club
- Fraternity clubhouse
- Government buildings
- Retreat house

Non-Traditional Venues

- Airport
- Art gallery
- Atrium
- Basilica
- Beaches
- Bookstore
- Café/restaurant
- Castles

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- Campgrounds
- Cruise ship
- Desert
- Farms
- Gardens
- Hangar
- Library
- Museum
- Parking garage
- Places of worship
- Planetarium
- Rainforest
- Ranch
- Rooftop
- Shopping malls
- Streets
- Trains and train stations
- Underground spaces
- Villas
- Vineyards
- Warehouse

Purpose-built venues

- Concert hall
- Conference hall
- Convention centre
- Cultural centre
- Exhibition hall
- Hotels
- Music hall
- Resorts
- Sports arena
- Theatre
- World Trade Centre

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Sources of information about venues and facilities

There are many sources of information about possible venues and facilities that can be used for staging an event. Among these sources are the following:

- Advertisements, brochures, catalogues, and newsletters from venues
- Online reviews from previous clients
- Press articles
- Recommendations from colleagues, family and friends
- Social media and social networking sites
- Trade magazines
- Websites

SPECIAL

Specialist websites that have been created specifically to assist an event manager who is researching possible event venues

https://www.eventup.com
https://www.headbox.com
https://www.peerspace.com
https://www.smartmeetings.com
https://www.socialtables.com
https://www.splacer.co
https://www.thisopenspace.com
https://www.venuebook.com

Selecting and choosing the preferred venue

There are many criteria that the event manager can use when selecting and choosing the most appropriate venue to stage the event. Here is a list of factors that could be taken into account when selecting a venue for the event. This list is only indicative of the many factors that the event manager could consider and it is not an exhaustive list. When the event manager discusses the choice of the venue with their client, it is likely that not all of these factors will be relevant and that other factors will have to be added to this list:

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No.	Criteria	Yes	No	Note
1	Access to the airport			
2	Any issues that may restrict access to a particular venue			
3	Any legal, health and safety, or ethical implications of using a specific venue or location			
4	Available docking and storage areas			
5	Access to multiple modes of transportation			
6	Access to tourist attractions			
7	Acoustics capability of the venue for sound projection quality			
8	Aesthetics of the venue design to create an evocative, inspiring venue			
9	All-inclusive package and pricing to include audio-visual, décor, furniture, F&B, electricity supply, exhibition construction, technical provision			
10	Assistance from government agencies, eg ambulance service, immigration, customs, fire service, police force			
11	Assistance for tourism incentive trips, eg shopping, casino, golf, cultural centres			
12	Available additional staff for staging the event, eg waiters for sit-down dinners, ushers			
13	Available choices for lodging accommodation at different price/tariff levels			
14	Available event and function rooms, eg dimensions, amenities, flexibility, technology			
15	Available facilities for people with special needs, eg ramps, wheelchairs, support technology			
16	Available fire escapes, water sprinklers, and other safety and security equipment			
17	Availability of the venue on the dates for the event			
18	Available transfers, eg airport-venue, airport-train-venue, ferry-bus-venue			
19	Available valets and parking for guests			
20	Climatic, physical, environmental factors that are likely to affect the health and safety of participants			
21	Complimentary services provided by the venue			

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22	Contingency arrangements to cover extremes of weather or non-availability of certain venues or locations because of environmental factors			
23	Cost of hiring the venue			
24	Crowd control measures, eg facial recognition technology, CCTV and security cameras, X-Ray screening, professionally trained stewards			
25	A detailed list of allowable staging and production equipment, tasks, and gadgets, eg balloons, painting and posting on walls, generators, signages			
26	Existing relationships with the event venue that might result in a discounted fee for hiring the venue			
27	Flexibility for the required floor layout for staging the event			
28	Free car parking close to the venue			
29	A full-service offering of the venue to include event production, food & beverage, and technical support			
30	Immersive opportunities for the event within the venue			
31	Information on possible additional expenses, eg housekeeping, corkage, storage, water and electrical consumption			
32	Menu options for special meals, eg vegetarian, locally sourced ingredients, low sodium, halal, kosher, organic			
33	Multi-sensory offering by the venue – an all-inclusive technology offering			
34	Negotiable rates, eg upgrades, downgrades, discounts, vouchers, group rates			
35	Opportunity to customise the venue with the corporate brand of the client and with décor to indicate the theme of the event			
36	Overall colour, style, layout, décor and furniture to co-ordinate with the event concept, design, and theme			
37	Privacy and security for artists, performers, and VIPs			
38	Proximity to the downtown area for restaurants, shopping and leisure activities			
39	The proximity of the venue to public transportation			

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40	Quick access to the kitchen for the food and beverage staff			
41	Refinement, splendour and elegance of the venue to create a high-quality ambience and experience			
42	Regulations on firearms and ammunition, medicines and medical supplies, except if this is related to the event concept			
43	Safety and security protocol and resources at the venue			
44	Schedules of events before and/or after, in case there are other similar events in the same venue			
45	Skill and experience of the venue's in-house staff			
46	Suitability of the venue for the concept of the event			
47	Suitability of the venue for using special effects such as lasers and pyrotechnics			
48	Sustainability of the venue, its carbon footprint, in-room sensors to control lighting and achievement of ISO 14001 and ISO 20121 standards. The venue's approach to energy and water conservation, recycling and use of local suppliers			
49	Technical assistance, eg audio-visual equipment, internet access, technicians on standby			
50	Technology capability, eg hosting AR, VR, AI, data & voice networks, laser projectors, robust Wi-Fi access for multiple devices with at least 3mb/second, LCD projection screens/ equipment, video conferencing			
51	The need for permissions and licences when using a particular venue			
52	Transparency regarding policies on down payments, cancellation, re-booking, early check-in and late check-out, penalties, attrition, overtime etc			
53	Use of sustainable event practices			
	Visibility of the venue to enable participants to easily see and find the venue			

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Three of the main criteria for selecting a venue are the costs of hiring the venue, alignment of the venue with the event concept, and the objectives of holding the event. With reference to the financial budget, the event manager must forecast the income and the expenditure costs that will be incurred by holding the event in a particular venue. These financial considerations will include what is included in the cost of hiring the venue, the pre-payment requirements, and financial penalties that will arise if the event has to be cancelled. Generally, event venues have a minimum deposit required to reserve the venue with the full payment to be made at an agreed date prior to the start date of the event.

The type of event to be organised will have a major influence on the choice of the venue. The event manager needs to prepare a detailed checklist that can be used to verify that the chosen venue meets all of the logistical, technical, and experiential requirements for the event. For example, a trade show needs safe entry and exit routes for exhibitors, storage and security for the exhibitors'

Did you know?

- Each destination has many different types of event venue some of which might be unique to that particular destination. The abundance of forests, lakes, beaches, temples and ancient buildings across the Asia Pacific region will create memorable experiences for the event participants. Singapore Botanic Gardens, Borobudur and Prambanan Temple in Indonesia, the historic city of Malacca in Malaysia, baroque churches of the Philippines, the Taj Mahal in India, and the Great Wall of China are all special event venues some of which are also listed as UNESCO World Heritage sites.
- The Rungrado May Day Stadium (RMDS) was built by North Korea as a response to the Olympic Games held in Seoul, South Korea in 1988. The total capacity of the RMDS is approximately 114,000 people. The most spectacular element of the stadium is its roof. Should official data be correct, it covers 94,000sq. m which is double the size of the previous record-holder King Fahd Stadium in Riyadh, Saudi Arabia.

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products. The venue for hosting a birthday party will probably require food and beverage serving facilities, comfortable seating, music entertainment technology, and a dance floor.

All of the event stakeholders must agree to the recommended venue that is proposed by the event manager. An ocular or site visit can be conducted by designated decision-makers with the event manager. As a rule, event managers should present at least three choices of venue to the event stakeholders emphasizing the strengths and opportunities of each one.

Ocular inspection

Event managers must conduct an ocular inspection of the venue and its facilities before entering into a contract with the venue owner. It is recommended that computer software is used to produce 3D images of what the event venue will look like when it is fully designed for the event. Professional event venues will be able to prepare these 3D images for the event manager. For those venues where 3D computer imaging software is not available, the event manager should take photos and actual measurements of the actual spaces. These will assist in the design and execution of the event concept.

The dimensions of the floor, ceiling, doors, and hallways are necessary to ensure that the entry and set-up of furniture, furnishings, equipment, and people are safe, secure, and comfortable. The event manager must consider the flow of people within the venue as well, not only of the participants but of all the other event personnel such as food service staff, kitchen staff and technical personnel. During the ocular visit, the event manager should discuss with the venue manager all of the event's requirements that need to be incorporated into the design and layout of the floor space and detailed floor plans have to be drawn up.

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A good method of determining if a specific venue is suitable for holding an event is to see images and records of previous events that have been held at the venue. Most venues will have video and photographic records stored in a digital archive that can be used to demonstrate how the venue can be adapted for the hosting of different types of events. To enable a systematic analysis and evaluation of each potential venue, the event manager needs to draw up a checklist of criteria that can be used on each ocular visit, for example:

Figure 12: Sample Checklist to be Used When Selecting a Hotel as an Event Venue

Hotels	Location	Features	Price	Comments
Hotel #1	5 km from the airport. Accessible by public transport or taxis.	4 stars quality rating		Adjacent to a shopping mall. Has several experiences hosting high-level VIP guests. Set in spacious gardens that can be used for a pre-dinner drinks reception. Recently re-furbished public areas.
Permissions and Licences				The hotel has licences for selling alcohol and for providing live music. No additional permissions are needed for this event.
Accessibility				The hotel has appropriate and safe entry and exit routes from the main highway for all types of vehicle. The hotel is fully accessible for people with special needs.
Climatic, Physical and Environmental Factors				The event is indoors apart from an outdoor drink reception. If there is inclement weather, the drink reception can be held indoors.
Contingency Arrangements for Inclement Weather				All aspects of the event can be delivered indoors if there is heavy rain on the day of the event.
Health and Safety				The hotel has up-to-date fire safety inspection records. The kitchens comply with all food safety and hygiene regulations as evidenced by certificates. Up-to-date risk assessment documents have been received. The hotel managers and supervisors receive regular training on health, safety, and evacuation procedures.
Legal and Insurance				Public liability insurance for the hotel is in place. The hotel has a legal operating

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				licence to provide food & beverage, guest accommodation and meetings and events.
Rooms		20 x Single beds	US$50/night bed & breakfast	Negotiable rates for guaranteed 100 people/ 3 nights stay.
		50 x Twin beds	US$80/night bed & breakfast	Negotiable rates for guaranteed 100 people/ 3 nights stay.
		3 x Suites	US$100/night bed & breakfast	Suitable for VIP guests. Negotiable rates for guaranteed 100 people/ 3 nights stay.
Function Rooms		Ballroom can accommodate a maximum of 500 pax seated theatre style	US$30/person day delegate rate to include refreshments	Can be subdivided into smaller function rooms. High ceilings. Wide doors. Opportunity to decorate the ballroom in the corporate brand of the client.
Meeting Rooms		Each meeting room can accommodate a maximum of 30 pax seated boardroom style	US$20/person day delegate rate to include refreshments	Only 2 available on event schedule.
Restaurant		Celebrity Chef	Gala Dinner US$25/person	Two Stars Michelin rated. Can serve halal cuisine.
Amenities		Swimming pool, fitness centre, spa		Free car parking on-site for 300 cars.
Technology				The function and meeting rooms have touchscreen data boards, lapel microphones, and LCD projectors. 3mb/ second broadband. A technician is available on stand-by.
Sustainability				The restaurant serves locally sourced produce. Motion detector sensors in all public corridors.
Security				In-house CCTV surveillance cameras. On-site security guards.
Other Factors that Need to be Considered at this Venue				This hotel is used regularly for functions and meetings. The hotel staff are experienced in all aspects of event management.

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After producing a shortlist of event venues (no more than three venues), the event manager is now in a position to negotiate with the management of each venue the overall price that the venue will charge. Event managers should negotiate the top concessions first, namely the best rates for accommodation, meals, meeting room facilities, and required technologies. The negotiations on the venue hire charges will also normally take into account:

- the guaranteed number of persons per day who will attend the event
- available technology, equipment, and support personnel to be provided by the event venue

The event manager along with key stakeholders have to prioritize what they need to be provided by the event venue versus what would be "nice to have" in a venue. As soon as a decision is reached on which event venue is to be used, the event manager must inform the preferred venue so that a contract can be prepared for signature – the contract will include all the details that have been discussed during the negotiations and is legally binding on all parties who sign the contract.

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13 Managing Contracts for an Event

In preparing for the event, the event manager has to ensure that all the necessary legally binding contracts are in place for the successful staging of the event. A contract is a voluntary agreement between two or more parties (individuals, companies, or organisations) that is enforceable in law. Some of the terms used to denote a contract are agreement, legal tender, memorandum of understanding (MOU) and memorandum of agreement (MOA).

The event manager must ensure that employees, suppliers, contractors, and vendors have written contracts that detail tasks, deliverables, budgets, and deadlines for the provision of their services. Discussions, especially verbal agreements with clients, sponsors, and cooperating agencies, must also be covered by a formal written contract. Changes to any part of a contract must be an addendum to an already existing legal document. Templates can be used as a guide to map out the details of a contract.

The contracts that are required for staging an event will be determined by the legal requirements of the country in which the event is being held concerning labour laws, government regulations on permits and licenses, as well as restrictions that

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can affect the staging of the event. In cases where English is not the main medium of communication, a translation of the contracts must be prepared and reviewed prior to the signing. Some countries may prefer a specific format for an agreement and may require notarization. The event manager must use the services of a legally qualified person in this situation to avoid any problems from occurring.

Once the contracts have been signed, the event manager must record details of all the approved contractors and their deliverables on a spreadsheet. The spreadsheet will facilitate the monitoring and supervision of all the contracts that are needed to stage the event. Some event managers will designate specific personnel to monitor and quality control the contracts to ensure that all aspects of them are being delivered to specification and on schedule.

Contract law is the body of law that relates to the legally binding agreements and obligations that arise when two or more parties enter into a contract. Contracts are normally established for the sale of goods, the provision of services, or the exchange of interests or ownership. All legally binding contracts need five elements:

- the actual agreement itself known as the 'offer'– what is to be bought or sold or what services will be provided or exchanged. The contract should list all the products and/or services that a party intends to provide. Detailed specifications should be provided such as product/service information, delivery schedules, and warranties
- the intention of all parties to the contract to create a legally binding agreement and the roles and responsibilities of each party
- the payment (consideration) that will be made on successful completion of the contract and the timeline for the payment of the fees as well as the mode of payment
- the negotiated fees for returns and cancellations

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- information about arbitration in case one party defaults on their part of the contract and legal assistance is needed to resolve the dispute

Other information in a contract can include clauses that relate to:

- the protection of the reputation of the parties specified in the contract
- escrow (where a third party becomes involved in holding funds and making payments on behalf of the parties)
- force majeure, a natural disaster that might mean the event has to be cancelled
- indemnification, the procedures to follow if one of the parties to the contract defaults on their obligations
- insurance to cover the event stakeholders in case of a difficulty arising during the staging of the event
- non-competition clauses that specify that the parties to the contract will work exclusively with each other and will not undertake work for a competing event organising company
- prescription period, the duration over which the contract will be valid and when it will terminate
- quality control measures to ensure that the work that each party to the contract undertakes is to the required performance standard
- warranties (or guarantees) that specify what will happen if the services or products provided by the parties to the contract are not to the standards that have been specified

A contract becomes effective when the terms of the contract are agreed by all parties and this is evidenced by the signing of the contract document by the parties to it. In writing a contract, all the words and terms used must be precisely written and unambiguous. Contract law is complex and there will be variations in the law of contract in different countries. The event manager must seek legal advice and guidance from a legally

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qualified person who understands the law as it relates to the event industry in the country within which the event is being staged. If the event manager signs a legally binding contract without fully understanding all of the clauses contained in it, they could find themselves in a costly financial dispute with the other party to the contract if there is an unforeseen difficulty in implementing the terms of the contract.

The event manager has to identify the key elements of the event that need to have a contract. Each contract will specify clearly and precisely the responsibilities that each party who signs the contract has to undertake and perform for the successful staging of the event. Many different contracts could be needed to run an event, for example:

- barter arrangements, where goods or services are exchanged without the payment of monies. Instead, some other mutually agreeable form of recompense is made
- consulting agreements where a person or organisation provides consultancy services to the event manager
- contracts with vendors from whom products or services are purchased
- employment contracts for all personnel directly employed by the event manager
- exhibitor agreements for organisations who hire exhibition space at the event
- purchase orders which confirm what is to be purchased from suppliers, the payment to be made, and when that payment is to be made
- sales agreements when products or services are to be sold
- sponsorship agreements which specify the terms and conditions under which sponsorship in money or in kind will be provided by a sponsor
- terms and conditions under which the contract is undertaken by all the parties to it

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There are also special types of contracts that are used in the entertainment and events industry:

Riders

Aside from contracts, the managers and agents of performers in the entertainment industry issue another type of document called riders which are considered part of a service contract. Riders refer to specific requests or demands that a performer requires. Aside from performers, speakers and high-profile guests such as dignitaries, government officials and celebrities also include riders in their contracts. It is common to see in riders a list of requirements such as a brand of drinking water, preferred flowers for an airport welcome, or exotic desserts to be provided in the dressing room. There are three main types of riders, namely, hospitality, technical and tour riders.

- hospitality rider - this enumerates the items required for the comfort of a performer, usually on the day of the event and/or during rehearsals. Among the most common requests are specific brands of food and beverages, towels, personal assistance, complimentary tickets, security detail, and wardrobe
- technical rider - the technical rider details the light, audio, and video specifications, staging, décor and production requirements as well as dressing rooms and lounge areas. Some of these requirements can include a preferred brand of musical instrument or equipment, elevated areas onstage, as well as specific musicians and technicians. The rider can cover permissible photo shots during the performance, acceptable stylists and even the room temperature during shows and rehearsals
- tour rider - this refers to requirements for the performers who are on the tour. Aside from items listed in the hospitality and technical riders, this can include preferred airlines, land

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transport, and hotels as required stops for refreshments, exercise, and personal hygiene. It also covers schedules for "meet-and-greet with fans," press conferences, and decoys while in transit

Contracts will probably have to be drawn up between the event manager and the following parties:

- the client
- the sponsors
- the participants
- volunteers working at the event
- the artists and performers at the event
- the suppliers and sub-contractors to the event
- the full-time and part-time employees of the event organising company

Here is a list of some of the organizations with whom contracts will have to be signed:

Figure 13: Organizations with Whom Contracts Will Be Needed

The Event Suppliers	The Event Logistics
Art and Graphic Designers	Customs Brokers and Immigration Consultants
Architects and Engineers	Emergency Services, Ambulance, Fire and Police
Choreographers	Fabricators, Rigging & Staging Engineers
Copy Writers and Scriptwriters	Freight Forwarders, Storage Facilities, Transportation
Digital Technology and Multi-Media Specialists	Packaging Companies
Decorators and Set Designers	Suppliers of Electricity, Telecommunications, Sewerage and Toilets

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Food Stylists and Caterers	Security Companies
Marketing, Social Media and Publicity Consultants	Taxis and Shuttle Services
Painters and Interior Designers	Travel Agencies, Tour Operators and Tour Guides
Performers, Artists, Singers, Bands, Dancers and Musicians	
Photographers and Videographers	
Special Effect and Pyrotechnics Designers	
Stage Designers, Florists	

To illustrate what a contract could include a contract between the event manager and their client will include clauses (a section or provision within the contract which covers a specific aspect of the agreement between the parties) relating to the following:

- the services that the event manager will provide for the staging of the event in as much detail as possible, for example:
  - the venue for the event
  - the dates/times of the event
  - schedules for ingress, set-up, break-down and egress
  - full details of the event production
  - technology for the event
  - the provision of food and beverage
- the fee that the client will pay the event manager for staging the event and the dates by which the client has to make payments to the event organising company in advance of the event taking place
- cancellation conditions and terms. Clients might have to cancel the event. Therefore, the contract with the client needs

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to specify the financial liability of the client if the event is cancelled at different time periods in advance of the event, for example, if the event is cancelled within 4 weeks and 8 weeks before the start date of the event. The contract should also indicate the circumstances in which the contract can be cancelled

- reasons why the contract might be terminated by either party. A common clause that is used in contracts for events relates to a force majeure – an unforeseen natural disaster that means the event cannot take place, for example a hurricane, earthquake, flood or tsunami. The termination clause has to specify the circumstances in which the contract can be cancelled, the parties to the contract who can cancel the contract, and what will happen if the event is cancelled (will it be re-scheduled or will event participants receive a refund of the monies they have paid)
- a clause known as an 'indemnity clause' that explains the legal liabilities of each party to the contract if a problem arises before, during or after the event due to negligence – 'who is responsible for what'

For contracts with sponsors, the following information should also be included in the contract:

- monetary or in-kind value of the sponsorships
- details of what the sponsors will receive in exchange for their support
- details of marketing collaterals to be provided by the sponsor
- deadlines for the submission of art and copy requirements to include, but are not limited to Pantone colour guides, text, logo samples, and other corporate branding details
- schedules of deliveries of marketing collaterals
- agreements on barters and/or non-cash sponsorships, if applicable
- assigned seats or other complimentary items offered to the sponsor, if applicable

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For contracts with sub-contractors, the following information should also be included in the contract:

- scope of work, tasks, deliverables, and resources to be provided by the sub-contractor
- schedules of ingress, set-up, break-down, and egress, if applicable
- policies on ingress, set-up, break-down, and egress, if applicable
- schedules of meetings to review progress on delivering the agreed work schedule

For contracts with advertising agencies, publicists, and the press, the following information should be included in the contracts:

- scope of work, tasks, deliverables, and resources to be provided
- sizes of collaterals
- colour guides
- branding guidelines
- paper stock
- printing specifications
- production schedules
- distribution lists for press/photo materials
- schedules of online sales and marketing campaigns
- set-up and tear-down of posters, island signs, flags, and billboards
- texts for specific collaterals
- delivery schedules
- storage facilities, if needed
- schedules of photo and video shoots
- signatories for approvals and release of monies
- the allowable number of revisions with additional fees

For contracts with local government offices, the following information should also be included in the contracts:

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- ambulance, fire and police assistance information
- assistance with inter-agency coordination
- emergency response chain of command
- traffic re-routing
- first aid onsite

Special requirements for contracts

In addition to contracts and riders, the event manager must be familiar with the legal documentation required for customs and immigration as well as community regulations regarding sustainability and ethnic traditions. Special equipment and products such as ammunition, cryogenic freezers, and pyrotechnics also require special permits. Furthermore, the event manager should consult accredited suppliers and logistics groups to use these.

The event manager must provide details on catering requirements, especially if some attendees and participants eat specific food such as halal, kosher, and vegetarian or have food allergies. There must also be designated areas for prayer specifically for Muslims. All of these items can be included in the contract with relevant suppliers, such as caterers and the venue.

As indicated in this Section, depending on the size and scale of the event, there could be many different contracts that have to be drawn up and agreed in order for the event to take place. As mentioned previously, it will be essential that the event manager uses the services of a legally qualified person to draw up these contracts. When all the contracts have been signed, it is the responsibility of the event manager to:

- monitor the activities of the parties to the contract against the terms and clauses of their contract at appropriate intervals to ensure that the other party is complying with the terms of the contract

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- identify any non-compliance with the terms of the contract, feedback to the other party about their non-compliance and provide support to the other party within the limits of the contract to assist them if unforeseen circumstances are affecting their ability to comply with the terms of the contract
- where necessary, follow the correct procedures to vary contracts if all parties agree that the contracts need to be amended
- keep documentary evidence as a record of the progress that is being made on the completion of each contract

Keeping a record of all the contracts

It will be essential for the event manager to record and compile together all the approved and signed contracts in a matrix for easy reference, see Figure 14. The contracts and their descriptions must be categorized.

Ethics relating to contracts

All contracts must seriously consider generally accepted principles of doing business ethically and legally. Prior to the finalization of contracts issues pertaining to culture, tradition, etiquette, and norms must be taken into consideration. Business etiquette and protocol must also be observed. In addition, the event manager must be sensitive to sustainability practices, rights of women, children, senior citizens, and those people who have special needs.

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Figure 14: A Sample Matrix of Approved Contractors and Suppliers

Contract Description	Supplier/ Contact Details	Price/ Unit	Number of Units	Total Price/ Monies Due	Special Arrangements (Listed as a requirement for each item)	Status
Accommodation						
Suites					Welcome kit in room upon check-in	
Single					Daily wake-up call for breakfast	
Double					Early check-in, Late check-out	
					Extra bed for double rooms	
Transportation						
Air					Number of passengers per trip	
Land						
Airport transfers						
VIP transfers						
Function rooms						
Ballroom					Seating arrangement	
Function Room 1					Flags	
Meeting Room A					Rostrum	
Meeting Room B					Sofa during break-out sessions	
Exhibit Area						
Meals						
Welcome Drinks					Options (allergies, vegetarian, halal)	
Breakfast					Table set-up	
AM Snacks					Decor	
Lunch					Timing	
PM Snacks					Waiter service	
Dinner						
Gala						
Technology					Onsite and offsite	

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Professional Services						
Florist						
Entertainment						
Music						
Décor						
Invites						
Security						
Photography						
Videography						
Awards						
Tokens						

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Case Study:

International Standard MICE Venues

The choice of venue is a crucial decision for the event manager because the venue is an integral part of the success of the event and, to a large extent, helps to set the atmosphere for the event. When considering which venue to use for an international MICE event, there are many options available from hotels with purpose-built conference halls to stand-alone congress halls and large-scale convention centres.

Convention and exhibition centres should provide the following facilities: at least one convention hall, two mini-convention halls, one exhibition hall, one restaurant, and parking facilities. The convention hall should provide audiovisual conferencing equipment, facilities for high fidelity recording, video projection, and video graphs. The seating capacity in the hall set-up in a classroom-style should provide space for at least 1500 participants. The mini-convention halls provide space for seminars, workshops, and meetings with the seating style being flexible, for example, theatre style or classroom style. Exhibition halls tend to be large, open spaces that can accommodate many different types of event such as trade shows in which companies promote their products and services using exhibition booths.

When considering which convention and exhibition centre to use, the event manager should also consider the other support facilities and services that are provided, for example: administrative facilities for event personnel; a media/press Lounge; VIP Lounges; technical facilities such as electric power back-up-system; facilities for people with special needs; first aid with doctor on call facilities; fire safety arrangements; and the security arrangements for personnel and storage of equipment.

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The International Association of Convention Centres (AIPC) is the worldwide industry association for professional convention and exhibition centre managers. The purpose of AIPC is to support the professional development of convention and exhibition centre managers as well as accrediting centres that meet its criteria for accreditation. AIPC mission is to support, encourage, and recognize excellence in convention centre operation and management. When the event manager is selecting a MICE venue in which to stage an event, AIPC accreditation is one of the factors that could be taken into account when selecting the most appropriate convention or exhibition centre.

In order to comply with AIPC Quality Standards, a convention centre must be able to meet very detailed criteria, just a few of the criteria are listed here: the main auditorium must seat a minimum of 300 delegates; the stage should measure a minimum of 70cm high and 50sq. m in area; there should be facilities for simultaneous interpretation to ISO 2603 standards; breakout rooms must offer at least 80% of the seating capacity of the main auditorium; catering areas must provide seating for a minimum of 60% of the capacity of the main auditorium, allowing for 1sq. m per delegate; exhibition space must provide sufficient access and an appropriately sized delivery bay.

Exhibition areas that are AIPC accredited have to have: a minimum ceiling height of 4m; the minimum live load capacity has to be 10 KN per sq. m; electricity, data and telephone connections must be available to every stand; direct access on to the exhibition floor for delivery vehicles; and minimum overall lighting of 300 lux.

An AIPC accredited convention and exhibition centre also is required to provide information to the event manager, for example: the number of hotels rooms available on-site, within walking distance and within a short taxi or bus ride in the 3, 4, and 5

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star categories, together with details of budget accommodation; parking facilities on-site and within close proximity; transport available from the nearest airport; an overview of the main tourist and leisure attractions within the immediate locale, together with a range of brochures; and the range of support services available within the region, including transport companies, conference organizers, exhibition stand contractors and other meetings related services.

In the Asia Pacific region, the following convention centres have received AIPC accreditation: Cairns Convention Centre, Australia; Darwin Convention Centre, Australia; Melbourne Convention and Exhibition Centre Australia; Borneo Convention Centre, Kuching, Malaysia; and Kuala Lumpur Convention Centre, Malaysia. The award-winning Kuala Lumpur Convention Centre (KLCC) is an example of a modern, purpose-built MICE venue that offers world-class facilities to its users. KLCC was the first convention centre in Asia to be 'benchmarked' by Green Globe International for its environmental operational standards and has been accredited at the 'gold standard' level of excellence by AIPC.

Located right in the heart of Kuala Lumpur, the KLCC is a state-of-the-art convention centre that provides flexible events spaces that can host conferences, exhibitions, seminars, meetings, and entertainment events. The spacious Plenary Theatre is often used for opening ceremonies, concerts, and graduations. There are six exhibition halls that can host sports events and trade fairs.

When selecting a venue, the event manager should consider very carefully if the preferred venue has been accredited by an international association and whether that venue is one of the best in the locality for staging events.

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EVIDENCE REQUIRED FOR THE APIEM CERTIFIED EVENT MANAGER QUALIFICATION

For readers who want to study for the APIEM Certified Event Manager Qualification, you are to select an event that you have organised in the previous 12 months or are going to organise in the next 12 months and provide a portfolio of evidence that will contain:

1) Evidence of the research you undertook in researching and agreeing on the scope of the event with the client – the questionnaire used with the client to establish their requirements and the outcomes of your research with the client.
2) A copy of the mission statement; aims and objectives; critical success factors; financial planning and administration of the event.
3) A copy of the logistics/operational plan; the marketing and sales plan; the people and resources who will be needed to make the event a success; how the event will be evaluated; the leadership and management structure of the event.
4) A copy of the planning cycle and critical path/deadlines for the event.
5) An explanation of the research process followed to select the venue for the event and a venue selection checklist that can be used to collect and evaluate information about potential venues.
6) Copies of the main legally binding contracts that have been prepared for the running/operation of the event.

You will also write a reflective report that explains:

1) The process you followed for undertaking the research – how did you carry out the research? The challenges faced in carrying out the research?
2) The reasons why you set the mission statement and aims/objectives for the event? Why the critical success factors

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are the key to the success of the event? The profit that is expected to be generated from the event. Why you chose the administrative structure for the event?

3) The financial budget that will be needed to implement the marketing and sales plan for the event. Why you chose the different elements within the marketing and sales plan – how will they attract people to the event?
4) The reasons for setting the critical path/deadlines for the event.
5) An explanation of the reasons why you chose the venue that you selected for the event referring to permissions/licences; climatic, physical, environmental and health, and safety factors.
6) An explanation of the importance of having legally binding contracts for the running/operation of the event.

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chapter 4
planning the event

After reading this chapter, you will be able to:

- design and develop the concept for the event
- use technology in the event
- provide access to the event for people with special needs
- develop and write policies and procedures for the event
- select contractors and suppliers for the event

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14 Trends Affecting the Design of Event Concepts

A good event begins with a good concept – the idea for the event and what the event will entail, for example, the story that the event will tell, the experience that the participants will enjoy, and the overall design of the event. Before considering how an event concept can be designed and developed, this chapter will identify some of the trends that are affecting event concepts.

Event managers must keep up with event industry trends and best practices. These will affect the concept, design, and execution of events. Here are some of the trends that are influencing the design of events.

Engagement and experience

Participants of events are now seen as co-creators of their event experiences. They want to actively participate in the design and creation of their event. What this means for the event manager is that the design of the event concept should enable the participants to be fully engaged as active participants rather than passive observers. Opportunities have to be taken to immerse the participants in the event experience. When designing the concept for the event, the event manager must build into the design

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interactive experiences for the participants.

Digital technology now provides many opportunities for the event manager to provide a truly immersive experience for the participants of an event – before, during and after the event. Participants can use mobile devices to register online, to receive the program for the event in advance, to join contests, post images and comment about, and evaluate the event on social media sites. Delegates to a conference can choose to download a presentation, listen to an audiobook, or chat with the resource speaker. Through open-source software, the event manager can provide QR codes instead of maps, video clips instead of lectures, and print-on-demand souvenir programs in PDF formats. Participants can be co-creators of their event experiences through the use of digital technology and are now empowered stakeholders of the event to suit their needs and expectations.

Further information on how to incorporate technology into an event will be given later in this chapter.

Authenticity

There is a growing interest in activity-based events where participants can interact with the community where the event is being staged or with an expert on a specific subject. Participants are choosing to learn new skills, such as cooking heirloom recipes or a new dance technique, as well as taking part in volunteering activities that might assist disadvantaged people in the local community. Authentic experiences can be incorporated into the design of the event and will give the participants a different and immersive experience that can add to their overall satisfaction of the event.

Information and communication technologies (ICTs)

The range and scope of ICTs for use in the events industry continue

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to expand rapidly. There are technologies focused on specific event functions such as production, staging, and registration. The event manager can design, manage, and evaluate many event management processes across functions using ICTs working seamlessly on simultaneous tasks. ICTs are also key components of creating relationships with event participants through the use of websites, event applications and social media. Another category of ICTs are gadgets, wearable technology, drones, artificial intelligence, and other technological innovations. All of these ICTs innovations will feature heavily in the design of the event concept.

Inclusivity and accessibility

When designing the concept for the event, the event manager has to ensure that it will be an inclusive and accessible event for all members of society. The event concept has to be such that no section of society will be prohibited or restricted from participating in and enjoying the event experience. Participants with special needs have to have equal access to the event and should not be discriminated against in any way.

There is growing awareness in the events industry that special consideration in designing the event has to be given to senior citizens and people who have special physical needs. All events should now provide facilities such as ramps, hearing aid technologies, wheelchairs, and other equipment for people with physical impairments. The event manager must also seek to understand and respect the special needs of cultural and religious groups who might be attending the event and must build into the design of the event the dietary requirements of all participants as well as making designated space available for prayer and worship.

Sustainable practices

There is a growing interest in events that encourage, if not mandate,

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practices that can minimize the negative impact of the event on the environment. Environmental standards of compliance can now be set for contractors and suppliers aimed at mitigating the adverse effect of their work practices on the environment. Some of these are guidelines on the garbage disposal, exhibit booth construction, use of recyclable materials, and the use of online tools. There are also recommended initiatives for destinations, venues, accommodations and transportation providers to reduce carbon footprints, or the design of carbon-neutral policies. For example, some event venues use efficient technologies to reduce water and energy consumption. Caterers can be required to create farm-to-table menus where the produce is sourced from the local community. The event itself can contribute to sustainable practices through the use of digital technologies instead of paper for distributing event invitations to participants, for event registration and the provision of souvenir programs.

Share economy

Airbnb, Grab, Uber, and co-working office spaces have popularized the concept of the sharing economy where unused assets such as rooms, houses, and cars provide service for others. The event

Did you know?

- Japan is well known for the discipline of its people, including disposing of their garbage after an event. At major events, the Japanese audience can be seen cleaning the venue of the garbage left behind by the other participants.
- For the 2020 Japan Olympic Games, technology will be used to make this mega event the most sustainable one ever staged. The stadia will be powered by 100% renewable energy; old phones will be transformed into medals; taxis will be driverless and powered by electric motors; robots will act as translators for foreign tourists and will carry luggage for disabled people and the elderly.

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manager may be able to outsource some of the requirements for the event to similar companies to reduce the cost of implementing the event. The sharing economy provides a platform for the event manager to create and leverage new business relationships with contractors and service providers.

Alternative venues

As indicated in Chapter Three, many possible venues can be used for the staging of events. Even social events like weddings can move away from traditional venues (places of worship) to be held in unusual locations such as coastal beaches and even tropical rainforests. Exotic destinations and cruise ships have also become new venues for association meetings. The event manager has to think carefully about the venue to be used as it will be a factor contributing significantly to the overall participant experience and enjoyment.

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15 Designing the Concept for an Event

A successful event combines the best concept with an appropriate event strategy and seamless execution of the event, all anchored on the objectives of the stakeholders and within the financial budget for the event. The event concept when agreed is then translated into the detailed plan for the event that includes everything from the choice of venue, selection of contractors, to the optimal use of resources with feasible schedules of deliverables, to the technologies to be used for planning, staging and the event production.

In designing and developing the concept for an event, some initial questions have to be answered:

- what is the event about? This question helps define the details needed for the initial conceptualization and design of the event. It will provide the event manager with an overview of the description, expectations, and rationale for the event. This question also looks into the critical factors and trends that can affect the success and sustainability of the event

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- who are the stakeholders of the event? The answer to this question gives information about the interests, core values, as well as the levels of influence and control of the key people and organisations involved with the event. The stakeholders are individuals or organizations who will invest their resources to ensure the success of the event or are the people who will be affected by the staging of the event. Event managers must prioritize the objectives and motives of the key stakeholders when creating the concept for the event
- who are the participants to the event? Understanding clearly who will be attending the event, what their profile is, and what their expectations are will enable the event manager to design an event that will meet their needs. If the participants belong to groups with special needs, their specific requirements will play a big role in the conceptualization and implementation of the event. The marketing and communication strategies designed to promote the event must specifically appeal to the target participants
- why is this event important? This question provides insights into the objectives for the event. Some of these include personal reasons such as private celebrations with friends and family or for a business event to generate awareness of a company and its products or services
- where will the event be held? The destination where the event is to be held is very important as the destination will have a variety of different event venues from which the event manager can choose. The event venue is critical for the success of the event – for further information on event venues, see Chapter Three
- when will the event be held? The date for staging the event is important as the timing of the event can influence both the number of participants who might be able to attend as well as the overall cost of staging the event. Normally, venue hire costs will be lower during the off-peak months rather than

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in the peak season. Participant attendance might be higher for some events which are held over a weekend rather than during the working week

With answers to the above questions, the event manager can begin to think how to design and develop the concept for the event. The first consideration to take into account is to understand the event's aims and objectives.

Aims and objectives for the event

In designing and developing the concept for an event, the starting place is to understand clearly the aims and objectives for staging the event (see Chapter Three for further information about how to write aims and objectives). The objectives that are set will vary by the type of event but no matter what the objectives are, they have to be written in the SMART format. Different types of event will have different objectives.

The objectives of business events can be for strategic, marketing, or financial purposes.

Strategic Objectives

- Create long-term relationships with stakeholders
- Develop and/or sustain competitive advantage
- Establish trading opportunities with customers
- Generate and/or transfer knowledge through education
- Generate goodwill among suppliers, consumers, and other stakeholders
- Increase productivity of employees
- Influence and modify the behaviour of participants
- Network with stakeholders

Marketing Objectives

- Attract media attention to a company, products or services

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- Build brand equity
- Create or increase awareness for a product, service, or organization
- Enhance company image and reputation
- Generate sales leads
- Highlight corporate innovations and best practices
- Increase market share
- Introduce a new product, service, or organization to existing customers
- Introduce a new product, service, or organization to new markets
- Introduce new applications to existing customers
- Maintain or extend relationships with existing customers
- Maintain market presence

Financial Objectives

- Generate new sources of funds
- Generate sales revenues
- Increase profits
- Increase subscriptions
- Raise funds

Objectives of Life-Cycle and Leisure Events

- Attend live music events and enjoy the music
- Celebrate personal milestones
- Pay homage to cultural traditions
- Renew one's religious faith
- Spend time for rest and recreation
- Strengthen social relationships with friends

Objectives of Sports and Recreational Events

- Compete with other athletes
- Gain international recognition for the destination where the event is being held

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- Introduce a sport to a new territory
- Network with fellow sports participants
- Train athletes in preparation for a sports event
- Watch sports events

The budget for the event

Once the aims and objectives for the event have been agreed, the event manager needs to clearly understand what the financial budget is for staging the event. The financial budget will determine how the event can be designed and what can be included in producing the event, for example, the artists and performers, the type of food and beverage, and the sophistication of the technology that will be used.

The event stakeholders

The event manager must realize that events are designed for different stakeholders (the client, sponsors, and participants) and that the expectations of the stakeholders are central to the design of the concept for the event. Although events can have similar objectives, the actual concept must be customized to fit the interests and objectives of the stakeholders. Therefore, event concepts must be aligned with the interests and objectives of the stakeholders.

When the above factors have been identified and agreed, the event manager can then undertake research to gather the information that can be used to help develop the concept for the event.

Research to develop the concept for the event

Many different types of research can be implemented to help develop the concept of the event:

- conduct research and analysis of similar events. The information gathered from analysing similar events gives the event manager insights into lessons learned about event

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concepts that worked successfully and what aspects of the concept for previous events could be improved. When researching events that were organised by other event organisers, information can be obtained from:

  - publicity materials published by the event organiser that provide information on the theme of the event, the program, and success highlights
  - visiting and attending events to observe details of the event concept such as theme, décor, staging, entertainment, floor plan, catering, and other aspects of the event
  - online resources such as the websites of competing event organising companies through which video and photo images will be published of events that have been successfully staged

- conducting qualitative research with the event stakeholders (the client, sponsors, and target participants). Qualitative research is used to analyse perceptions, attitudes, and behaviour using focus group discussions, in-depth interviews, and observations. Focus groups bring together a sample of the stakeholders to discuss specific issues concerning the concept for the event. These can relate to their levels of interest, personal goals, and motivations in attending the event and their preferred content, activities, and schedules. This research technique requires expert facilitation and systematic recording of the inputs of the participants
- analyse the concepts of previous events that the event manager organised to identify why these events were successful and what contributed to the success of the events. Much can be learned from analysing and evaluating the event manager's own events utilising feedback from the event manager's employees, clients, other stakeholders and participants
- brainstorming ideas for the event concept using the SCAMPER technique. In SCAMPER, each letter in the acronym represents a way to create new ideas. One version of the use of the

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acronym is as follows: S is for "substitute"; C is for "combine"; A is for "adapt"; M is for "minimize or maximize"; P is to "put another use"; E is to "eliminate"; and R is for "re-arrange." The following matrix illustrates how to use SCAMPER

Figure 15: Example of the use of SCAMPER to Generate Event Ideas

SCAMPER	Idea: International Food Show	Changes Made to the Idea
Substitute	Asia Pacific Food Show	substitute *Asia Pacific* for *International*
Combine	Asia Pacific Food and Beverage Fair	combine *food* with *beverage*
Adapt	Asia Pacific Organic Food Exhibit	add *food organic* and *exhibit*
Minimize/ Maximize	1st Farm-to-Table Conference in Indonesia	Focus on *farm-to-table* instead of organic food; and on *Indonesia*, instead of Asia Pacific
Put to Another Use	Asia Pacific Fashion Accessories Sourcing Trade Show	Change from *food* to *fashion accessories*; and limit the *focus on sourcing* only
Eliminate	London Chefs Farm-to-Table Ingredients Sourcing Festival	Eliminate *Asia Pacific and fashion accessories*, and delimit the concept to a farm-to-table sourcing event
Re-arrange	Organic Agriculture Training Program	Instead of a sourcing fair for chefs, the event becomes an *organic seminar*

Aside from generating event titles to create new ideas, organizers can use SCAMPER to guide additions, deletions, and improvements in processes, components, design, target markets, among other factors of the event's design, see Figure 16.

After conducting research, the event manager must review the feasibility, relevance, impact, risk versus reward, as well as

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Figure 16: Example of the use of SCAMPER to Enhance the Event

SCAMPER	Original Idea	Changes Made to the Idea
Substitute	Birthday party in a hotel	Change the venue from hotel to a *cruise ship*
Combine	Exotic cuisine and table setting	Contest focusing on *a fusion of culinary flavours*
Adapt	Photography and video coverage	*Use drones* for aerial shots
Minimize/ Maximize	Children as target markets	*Multi-generational families*
Put to Another Use	Signages to guide guests	*Holograms* to welcome guests
Eliminate	Gifts	Encourage guests to *pledge their support for the celebrant's favourite charities*
Re-arrange	Break-out sessions for meetings	*Use of app to empower delegates* to pre-select topics to attend and reserve seats

the alignment of all the possible event concepts that have been generated with the key objectives of the stakeholders. One analytical tool that can be used for this is SWOT analysis.

SWOT analysis

A SWOT analysis can be used to review the feasibility and viability of the event concepts that have been generated through the research. A focus group discussion with selected stakeholders can uncover strengths, weaknesses, opportunities, and threats of each of the event concepts. Each of the event concepts must be systematically analysed to evaluate if it can be used for the event. Questions that need to be addressed at this important stage of reviewing each of the concepts include:

- are there any health, safety or security issues related to implementing the concept?
- can the concept be implemented using available resources?

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- does the concept meet the aims and objectives for staging the event?
- does the concept reflect the client's image and strategies?
- does the concept meet legal and regulatory requirements?
- does the concept require any special contributions from external agencies or organisations?
- is the concept attractive to the target market?
- is the concept clearly expressed?
- is the concept flexible enough to allow for optional courses of action if it needs to be modified?
- what are the risks associated with implementing the concept?
- what are the ethical considerations in taking the concept forward to implementation?
- will the concept result in a truly memorable participant experience?
- will the concept result in a sustainable event?

The responses to the above questions will indicate the possible strengths, weaknesses, opportunities, threats, challenges, and potential problems associated with each of the event concepts. By applying SWOT analysis to all of the event concepts that have been generated, the event manager will eventually arrive at one preferred event concept that can be taken forward to the next stage of the event planning process – creative event design.

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16 Creative Event Design

The events industry is extremely competitive due to the many event organising companies that operate in the industry. A big challenge for the event manager is to give potential clients a reason for selecting their event concept rather than the proposal from a competing event organiser. One way of achieving this competitive advantage is by ensuring that creativity, story-telling, experience, and design are the four building blocks of the event concept. The combination and integration of these building blocks into the concept for the event will contribute significantly to the event proposal being well-received by the client.

Creativity

Creative thinking lies at the heart of being innovative. Creativity is the process of generating new ideas or concepts by imaginatively connecting ideas and experiences, perhaps in a new way to produce an innovative idea or exciting new concept for an event. You do not have to be a special, gifted or artistic person to be creative. It is something that can be learned and developed as part of human behaviour through imagination. Everyone is capable of creative thought. One way of generating new ideas or concepts is through divergent thinking.

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Divergent thinking is where a team of people meet and think of all the different ways to solve problems or devise new ideas for an event. There should be no comments, ridicule or criticism made of the various ideas or concepts that are proposed at this stage of the creative thinking process. All ideas or concepts should be welcomed, irrespective of how strange they might seem. The purpose of divergent thinking is to encourage a free-flow of inspirational and imaginative ideas so that the team members do not feel restrained or embarrassed in making their suggestions – no matter how crazy they might seem. Many possible creative ideas and concepts should be produced because it is better to have a long list of potential new event ideas and concepts than a shortlist. The longer the list, then the higher the quality of the final idea or concept that is selected to be taken through to implementation.

When all the ideas from the divergent thinking process have been recorded, the next activity is to analyse each idea in turn to see if it is actually realistic and could feasibly be used as part of the event concept. This process is known as convergent thinking. A systematic analysis should be made of each idea that has been proposed by asking a series of questions:

- what are the strengths of the idea?
- what are the weaknesses of the idea?
- what resources will be required to implement the idea?
- how will this idea look and sound in practice?
- does the idea comply with all relevant legislation?
- will the cost of developing the idea be affordable?
- has any other event company developed this idea?
- how will the idea contribute to the overall guest experience and success of the event?

When convergent thinking is undertaken, some ideas will be rejected for not being suitable for the event. Eventually, one or

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two ideas will remain and can be taken forward for more detailed analysis and evaluation until one idea is actually chosen as the preferred option for the event.

A key element of creative thinking is not being bound by just considering existing, well-tried ideas and concepts but being able to 'think as if there is no box'. This is very important in the events industry as each event that is organised must be better and more creative than the last one that the event manager organised. The reason for this is because clients and their customers will always be looking for new experiences and just offering the same concept each time an event is organised will not result in a competitive advantage being established for the event manager and a potential loss of business.

Storytelling

To be successful, an event needs to be creative and tell a story – every event should tell a story. This is very important but frequently

Did you know?

- The basic ideas of the Asian Games 2018 Opening Ceremony were based on incorporating the four elements of water, earth, wind, and fire into performing arts cultural entertainment.
- The ceremony featured a stage designed as a 26-metres-high mountain with a waterfall. It weighed 600 tons, was 120 metres long, and 30 metres wide. It included a display of Indonesian plants and flowers, as well as a mock volcano that represents the location of Indonesia in the "Ring of Fire" that circles the Pacific Ocean.
- The epic opening dance was performed by 1,600 high school students from 18 schools in Jakarta. The dance which originated from Aceh province is named Ratoh Jaroe.

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ignored or overlooked by the event manager. Incorporating a story into an event is important because stories can:

- connect the event participants to the host client and the theme and context of the event that they are attending
- help event participants to fully engage with the event and to temporarily forget about their normal day-to-day activities
- stimulate the imagination of the event participants and encourage them to think differently about a challenge that they might be thinking about in their work or daily lives
- entertain, educate, and inspire event participants in ways that other forms of communication might not be able to do – a successful story can have a lasting impression and impact on event participants
- motivate action from the event participants after they have left the event, perhaps generate increased loyalty to their employer if the event is a company conference, or encourage sales for a particular product if it is a trade show
- continue being told after the event has finished. Social media is a great way for the event manager as well as the participants to keep telling the story of the event when it is over by sharing messages, photo images, and videos online. Post-event storytelling can be a very valuable means of promoting the success of the event and for advertising the next event that is being organised.

Stories at an event can be told visually, through sound and text with the story being fully integrated into the event from its beginning to its end. There are three basic components of a story – the setting or place where the story is to be told; the characters who play roles in the story; and the script of the story, the message that is communicated.

The venue (setting) for the event is extremely important as it can greatly enhance the overall satisfaction that event attendees gain

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from the event. There are now many different venues that can be used for an event – outdoor, indoor, purpose-built or specially adapted spaces and settings (see Chapter Three). Where possible and feasible, the venue should be harmonious and complementary to the story that is being told by the event. The venue should be part of the story. When a venue has been chosen, it then has to be 'dressed' for the event. Dressing the event will be considered in the design section that follows below.

The characters in the story may either be professional or amateur actors, or employees of the event organising company, or a combination of both. The characters in the story have a very important contribution in creating the ambience and communicating the brand image of the event through their dress and how they communicate and interact with the event participants. The event manager needs to ensure that all characters in the story are fully trained in their role and understand precisely how they have to behave whilst they are performing at the event. The characters in the story need to see themselves as the event's brand ambassadors and that they are key in establishing high satisfaction with the event participants.

All stories have a script – a message that has to be communicated. In the case of the event, all of the characters who are performing the story need to be able to communicate their script in a professional way to the event participants. To achieve this, each character will need to be informed what it is that they have to say as their contribution to the overall story and how to say it – what tone of voice to use and which parts of the story need special emphasis. As with all performances, preparation and rehearsal are vital for the story to be told effectively by the actors. The event manager needs to ensure that preparation and rehearsal occur before the event takes place.

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Many different stories can be incorporated into the event, stories about:

- the client
- the sponsors
- the event organising company
- the event participants themselves
- the musical artists who are performing at the event
- the destination or venue in which the event is being held
- the product, service or brand that is being promoted at the event
- the values and ethos of the company that is being featured in the event

However, all stories that are told at the event should be on the same theme and help to communicate a consistent message to the event participants. This will require the event manager to take on the role of 'event scriptwriter' to ensure that this consistency occurs and that there are no deviations from the overall message that is being communicated by any of the actors in the story.

To make the story memorable, the event manager should ensure that the event participants can:

- relate to the story, connect with it and understand it – do not use a story that is too abstract for the event participants to understand
- relate with the characters that are in the story, for example, heroes and villains who can add tension and excitement to the story that is being told
- appreciate and understand the conclusion of the story – what was the purpose of telling the story, what action should be taken by the event participants after being immersed in the story

The story that is being told at the event will also be about the event organising company and, if the event is successful and

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exceeds all expectations set for it, the stakeholders associated with the event will have a very favourable image of the event organising company. The opposite will be the case if there are some unsuccessful aspects of the event.

Every event should tell a story and hopefully a story that lives longer than the event itself. Stories help people to understand and remember important messages and contribute significantly to the competitive advantage of the event organising company.

Experience

A characteristic of a successful event is that there is participant experience built into the design of the event. People attend events for many different reasons, but the most important reason probably is to have a wonderful, unforgettable experience. Providing a memorable participant experience is vital and careful thought needs to be given by the event manager on how this can be achieved.

It is important to contrast immersion with absorption. When people watch an event such as a music concert on television, they can only enjoy the concert using two senses – their sight and hearing – this is known as absorption. However, when people attend an event, they can participate by using all of their five senses – sight, hearing, touch, smell, and taste. If the event manager can incorporate as many of these five senses into the participant experience as possible, the immersion of the participants into the event will be deeper and more memorable.

Immersing participants into the event can be achieved in many ways. When thinking about a formal business event such as a meeting or conference, participant immersion includes:

- providing comprehensive information about the event to the participants well in advance of the event starting so that they

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can plan and look forward to their personal itinerary and schedule for when they attend the event

- the choice of MC for the event, the person or people who stage-manage the event. The MC will play a vital role in engaging the event participants with the theme of the event and the MC's charisma and communication style and skills will have a very positive impact on the participation of the audience during the event
- if appropriate for the type of event, introducing the event participants to each other through 'icebreaker' activities that help the participants get to know each other
- including in the event schedule dedicated, structured time for networking (conversation time) – this is frequently seen as one of the important benefits that event participants gain from attending events, meeting and talking to other attendees
- build into the event 'sample time' whereby the event participants can see and sample the products which sponsors might be promoting at the event
- using games as an activity during the event – people like and enjoy playing games and designing an appropriate game for the event participants to play can considerably enhance their experience of the event
- incorporating digital technology and display screens into the event for the sharing of information and ideas that the event participants generate themselves and want to share with others – have a social media wall
- the type of food and beverage to be offered to event participants and how it is to be served; different cuisines can be used to complement the theme of the event, for example 'brain food' if the event requires the attendees to be active participants in a problem-solving activity. People can be energised by the food they eat and look forward to the different types of food that will be served at the event. Think about how the event participants will eat and drink – will it be better to have finger food rather than food requiring cutlery?

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- the types of drinks to be provided at the event should be appropriate for the culture within which the event is taking place and the type of event – should cocktails or mocktails be served? What about wine and other alcoholic beverages? How can the drinks provide a memorable experience for the event participants?
- providing 'wellness zones' where event participants can relax and chill during breaks in the event to help them refresh before the next activity commences
- incorporating socially responsible activities into the event to enable the participants to engage with activities or organisations that complement the theme of the event and to give a wider purpose for attending the event. Think about ethical and sustainable experiences that can be integrated into the experience of event participants, for example, donate any event items that can be recycled or reused to charitable or other organisations that will appreciate receiving these items at the end of the event
- incorporating 'sponsored' gifts into a souvenir bag for the event participants that they take away from the event and which will act as a permanent reminder of the event. Use an e-bag rather than a tangible bag and provide digital souvenirs for the event participants
- a climax to the event, a peak experience, the highlight of the event
- creative flows for the event that might be generated through lighting, music or multi-media technology

The event manager needs to fully grasp the concept of immersion. It is very different from being a passive absorber of an event. People enjoy being involved at events – doing things and being active. Creative thinking can be used by the event manager and the event team to be imaginative and innovative when devising the immersion strategies for the event.

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Design

All events have to be very effectively designed. Design pervades many different aspects of the event:

- music
- lighting
- venue décor
- venue layout
- furniture and fittings
- dress and costumes worn by the event actors
- graphics and colours used for visuals and text-based materials
- colour schemes for the fittings and furnishings used at the event

When contemplating the design to be used for the event, a number of principles need to be followed:

- understand the participants for the event and use designs that will resonate with them
- all design elements should work together within the overall theme for the event
- be consistent in the design that is used and replicate the design on all materials that are produced for the event
- keep up to date with the contemporary fashion designs that are currently popular – colours, textures, and images and use these in the design of the event. Unless it is a nostalgia-based event that is being organised, in which case designs from the event era will be used
- try and keep the overall design relatively simple and uncluttered, all items used in the design of the event should be there for a purpose
- consider the comfort of the event participants – choose furniture that will be as comfortable as possible and will allow the design of the venue to be shaped appropriately for the activities that are taking place
- plan for the flows of people during the event and design the

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venue so that it facilitates rather than hinders the physical movement of the event participants from one place to another

- provide space in the venue design for networking – create 'conversation hubs' with appropriate furniture and the provision of food and beverages
- where possible include power supply outlets within the design of the venue space that is being used – many event participants will need to charge their mobile technology at some point during the event
- think about the whole space that is available for use in the event – the stage, the seating, the entrance/exit ways, the backdrops – and ensure that the design of the event includes the whole space
- visual communication is very powerful and can set the mood for the event
- use colours sparingly – do not have too many colours in the design of the event:
  - use the 'colour wheel' when selecting colours for the event and ensure that the chosen colours harmonise appropriately with each other
  - have one colour as the base colour for the event
  - think about using 'warm colours' at the participant facing parts of the event and 'cool colours' towards the rear of the event space
- when using text in the design of the event, consider incorporating different font sizes, colours, and shapes to add contrast to the design – this makes the text more appealing and interesting to read and helps participants to remember the message that is being communicated
- consider using the food and beverage that is being served and their serving stations as part of the theme and décor of the event – as long as food hygiene regulations are not breached. Intricately designed food and drink stations contribute positively to the colour and overall design effect of the venue space that is being used for the event

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Depending on the nature and scale of the event and the event manager's own design experience, specialists may be employed at this stage of the event planning and organising stage. This is particularly true for events that will need to incorporate contemporary special effects, sound, lighting, and multi-media technology. Audio-visual production designers will have an up to date knowledge of their specialist areas, with considerable experience in visualising an event space and recommending a feasible design that will bring the wow factor to the event. Likewise, the event manager may not have the design skills or expertise that is needed in choosing the colour schemes and fabrics that are needed and, if this is the case the expertise of skilled graphic, textile or interior designers should be utilised.

If the four building blocks of creative event design can be skilfully integrated in a harmonious and complementary manner, the event manager can be assured that the event will be special and memorable. Events that are framed around creativity, storytelling, experience and design are the ones that will create that all-important competitive advantage for the event manager.

Did you know?

Applying principles and elements of design will enhance the creative aspects of your event:

- Principles of design: pattern, contrast, emphasis, balance, proportion/scale, harmony, rhythm/movement
- Elements of design: line, shape, form, colour, texture, space, value.

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17 Using Technology in Events

Technology is not only used to enhance the staging and production of an event, but also pervades all phases of event management from planning to evaluation. The use of technology has become an important element in planning, organising and managing events. Besides, technology is critical in empowering participants to co-create their memorable experiences. The wide range of currently available information and communications technologies (ICTs) include software, hardware, mobile applications, gadgets and equipment, among many others.

Advantages of using technology

Event managers can benefit from the cost-efficient management of value-chain activities by utilising technological means in their work practices. This means that unnecessary activities concerning organising the event can either be eliminated or reduced to manage costs. Besides, information and communications technology (ICT) can empower stakeholders to focus on critical transactions while repeatable, redundant processes can be done using online tools.

Collaboration

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ICT improves collaboration between and among the event stakeholders as it facilitates decision-making. Conference calls, video chats, and live messaging are alternatives to personal contact. Files, reports, illustrations, and images can be uploaded to be seen simultaneously by several people where their discussions can be recorded. Amendments to a memorandum or contract can be finalized online with electronic signatures being used to signify agreement to the minutes of a meeting or a contract.

Enhances engagement

The events industry is moving towards customer-centricity which means that participants are interested in designing their own experiences within the event environment. For example, delegates to a conference can choose topics from a menu of seminar-workshops by using the event app. In this way, they create their own itineraries based on their interests. This is a similar practice with spectators of multiple sports events who choose the sports they would like to see before the start of the sports tournament and with ICTs, the process becomes easier. Mobile applications, online pre-registration sites, and social networking links can direct the participant to the event of their choice. With inputs from big data analytics, the event manager can forecast possible participant choices for the different activities within an event and adjust the organisation of the event to meet these preferences.

With the use of the right technologies, staging, entertainment, production, and décor can further engage the participant. Technologies are used to elevate the standards of staging and production. Participants are more engaged when the event environment is fun, exciting, and sensory. For example, robots can act as tour guides; concert light sticks will enhance illumination; and images can be uploaded to a giant screen. Conventions can encourage the distribution of QR codes instead of printed brochures and calling cards. These will contain relevant

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corporate information using a combination of text, audio, and video. Meetings can be in hybrid form, both in-person and virtual. Thus, ICTs can be used to design authentic, co-created, sensory event experiences.

Enhance the image of key stakeholders

The use of sophisticated ICT tools can help enhance the image and reputation of the principal event stakeholders. Webinars can be archived for multiple audiences; performances can use holograms; and sponsors can generate more mileage and visibility through wearable technology, virtual reality, and interactive games.

Quick information dissemination

The ubiquitous internet enables the event manager to send information quickly to ensure that the stakeholders are always kept updated about the preparations, planning and organisation of the event. For event managers, technology speeds up the communication process. Last-minute changes to a conference program, delays in set-up, and requests for assistance can be easily done through online project management tools, social media, and social networking sites. Team members are quickly alerted and can respond to information and new requests from the event manager in real-time. Also, social media posts provide evidence of the modifications and the actions taken by a designated member of the event staff. The use of social media for communicating eliminates the need for constant face-to-face meetings that may interrupt any work in progress.

Research

ICTs can be used to gather data, evaluate feedback, and generate analytics. Surveys can be done through social media and mobile applications with statistical software for analysis. Moreover, emotions, experiences and feelings can now be captured, monitored and reviewed using big data analytics. As its name

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suggests, big data refers to the availability of large amounts of information from both structured and unstructured sources. Surveys, focus groups, and interviews are examples of structured sources; while credit card transactions, social media posts, and emails are classified under unstructured data. Big data analytics provide the event manager with information they can use to enable experience co-creation by participants, exhibitors and audiences.

Safety and security protocol

Instead of printed identification cards, participants can be provided with badges that can be used to access different areas and zones in the venue. All-access wearable passes can be issued to event managers and selected staff to enable them to gain entry to areas and zones of the event that can only be accessed by certain event stakeholders. In addition, luggage and equipment for storage can be tagged with radio frequency identification (RFID).

Seamless integration

ICTs allow the seamless integration of processes by addressing redundant, repeatable processes. This enables the event manager to focus on the critical aspects of the event. For example, requests for proposals from pre-selected suppliers can use online forms detailing the required product or service. Interested contractors can fill in forms and attach their quotations along with videos and images of the services that they will be able to provide. Automation saves time, resources, and effort that could have otherwise been used for manual activities, which in turn, reduces costs. For example, an event manager can request for 3 dimensional (3D) videos taken using a mobile phone to give them an overview of the event venue and its facilities. The videos also assist the event manager in narrowing down their choices before conducting an ocular inspection. Technology enables the event manager and

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contractors to seamlessly coordinate their work activities across functions. Decision-making becomes quicker when immediate access to stakeholders and their staff is available.

Sustainability through Technology

Technology contributes significantly to the creation of sustainable events where paper, the carbon footprint, and waste are reduced. Online registration, archived presentations, print-on-demand identification cards and conference programs, and downloadable exhibit manuals are examples of paperless strategies which reduce costs of printing, photocopying, paper and ink. Constant travel for meetings is replaced with online tools limiting work interruptions. Automating redundant, repeatable processes can reduce the expenses in organising events leading to more cost savings.

In conclusion, ICTs empower the event manager to simultaneously oversee the event, reduce costs, collaborate, and develop a competitive advantage as it delivers seamless memorable experiences for participants while achieving the strategic, financial, and marketing objectives of the key event stakeholders.

Digital technology

In the early years of the C21st, we are experiencing another technological revolution – the digital era. This digital era is considered to be one of the most significant technological periods that society has experienced because it is transforming how we live and work. A variety of different electronic devices enable the transfer of large volumes of data between individuals and companies throughout the world at extremely fast connectivity speeds so that the communication of information is instantaneous. The digital era is transformational – it changes behaviours and habits. Online shopping is now accepted as the norm as a consequence of retailers being able to transfer product information

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via the internet, websites and apps to personal computers and mobile technology. The automation of warehouses through digital technology enables the products that have been ordered by consumers to be packaged and despatched within a matter of hours of the order being placed. The use of social media for corporate and personal communication has been adopted by all generations in society. Digital marketing strategies lie at the heart of many organisational promotional strategies for communicating their goods and services to precisely defined target markets.

Digital technology is now an integral part of many organisational business strategies and has transformed the way that these organisations interface with their stakeholders – never before have we been able to access so much information at the click of a button or through a voice command.

As an event manager, a good knowledge of how digital technology can be utilised in the planning, organising and managing an event is essential. Digital technology in the events/MICE industry can offer new ways of engaging with all stakeholders and enhance participant experience, adding value to the event that is being planned and organised.

When considering how digital technology can be used by an event manager, a strategic approach should be adopted. One way of taking a strategic approach is to analyse the life cycle of the event and then determine which elements can be enhanced or made more efficient by the application of digital technologies.

Developing a digital technology strategy

The rationale for using digital technology in an event is to create added value for stakeholders and to improve the participant experience of the event along each step of their event journey. Strategically, digital technology can:

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- deliver information and event content before the event commences, during the event and after the event
- automate functions at the event that previously were undertaken manually
- personalise the participant experience and by so doing deepen the connection between the event organising company and its customers

When the event life cycle is analysed, digital technology can be used in the following ways:

Pre-event

- event marketing – a variety of digital tools, for example, websites, social media and email, can be used to promote the event to its target markets. Creating custom event landing pages on a website and communicating to the target market by social media and email enables the promotional messages to be personalised to the recipient so that everyone is a VIP. The digital marketing strategy needs to be well planned identifying the promotional messages that need to be communicated, the frequency of sending the messages and the media that will be used. Having an event hashtag will assist in the marketing of the event
- targeted messaging – digital technology can be used for communicating specific messages to other stakeholders of the event: performers, suppliers, sponsors, the event management team, the emergency services, the media etc. Email distribution lists are a key tool for this type of communication
- event website – creating an event website is essential – it will significantly enhance the experience of all stakeholders who will be involved in the event. The website is the digital home and brand of the event. It is often the first impression that people will have of the event brand and what it stands for.

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The website as a minimum will provide information about:
- ticket prices, booking methods and registration
- the programme for the event
- site maps
- artist information
- local transportation and accommodation
- Q & A section

The event website should be easy to find, simple to navigate, attractive to look at and fast to load

- apps – an event app is a useful tool for providing and communicating a tremendous amount of information about the event in a very convenient format using mobile devices. More information about event apps will be provided later in this section
- online registration – participant experience can be enhanced by enabling pre-event online registration and the printing of tickets or the downloading of tickets to a smartphone
- chatbot – the event app may include a chatbot, an example of artificial intelligence. The chatbot is a means of communicating information about the event through the user posing verbal questions and receiving verbal answers
- visualising venue design – augmented reality apps enable the event manager to access the floor layout of a particular venue and to superimpose a specific design for the event space using furniture, fittings, décor and colours that might be used. This technology can form a valuable means of comparing different venues without having to visit them all, saving the event manager time and money

During the event

- facial recognition – face recognition technology is being developed for many event management purposes: check-in and registration of suppliers, contractors, employees and participants; identifying attendees who could pose threats to

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the security of the event; and photo tagging, the preparation of event identification passes for event participants and event personnel. The use of facial recognition technology speeds up the registration process which ultimately will enhance stakeholder satisfaction of the event

- wearables incorporating RFID technology – radio frequency identification chips can be inserted into wrist bands, badges and other wearable items. This technology has many different uses at an event, for example, enabling event participants to buy products from vendors and using the wearable to make secure financial payments to the vendor. Event employees can use swipe cards to access secure sites at the event venue
- robots – as digital technology develops further, the use of robots at events will diversify from currently being used to provide information and to undertake straightforward automated tasks to perhaps being able to multi-task and to provide a variety of different intelligent functions for the event participants
- augmented reality – digital technology enables information that previously might have been communicated through static text-based visual displays to now be communicated through small headsets connected to smartphones or goggles that combine sound and vision in very creative ways. For certain types of large events, for example, a car show, augmented reality can be used to reduce the number of cars that have to be displayed as the customised headsets will be able to provide a more dynamic experience for the attendees through sound and vision showing the cars in action rather than just being static at the show
- app interpreters – where an event is taking place for a multi-lingual audience, an event app can be created to provide simultaneous translation of the message that is being communicated to members of the audience via their smart phones and headsets. This digital technology will require the event venue to have a strong and robust Wi-Fi network

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- digital technology flooring – this technology enables quantifiable measures to be taken of the number of people passing through a particular entranceway or zone of the event. Every time pressure is placed on the floor covering digital technology records this in terms of the number of people passing into the event space. This information is valuable not only to provide feedback to the event manager of how popular a particular zone of the event is but also for health and safety reasons to monitor visitor attendance and ensure that the capacity of the venue is not exceeded
- chatbots – this is a computer powered chat interface where the user seems to interact with a person. Chatbots or concierge apps, help in getting relevant responses immediately. During the event, the event chatbot not only continues to be a source of information but also collects information from participants, for example, feedback on their satisfaction with the event. If the event manager requires continuous feedback on participant satisfaction whilst the event is on-going, the chatbot can be used to collect this information
- event streaming – digital technology can connect audiences who are not attending the event to the event itself in real-time. Social media channels provide the opportunity for live streaming of events, for example, Facebook Live, Twitter and YouTube. To respond to this opportunity, events can now sell online only tickets as well as tickets for participants to attend the event in person

After the event

- building interest in subsequent events – the data collected through digital technology about the participants at the event can now be used to send them promotional messages about future events that will be organised by the event manager. The data collected will include the contact and profile information of the participants, which event sessions they attended, and which sessions they enjoyed the most

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The event app

The event app is an example of artificial intelligence. Sophisticated event apps can be activated through voice control as well as by manual touch. Event apps are now an important tool for the event manager to consider because they provide a range of functions:

- acting as a personal assistant by sending messages to the participant during the event on which session should be attended next, and the location of that session
- enabling live updates to be communicated to participants about the programme for the event and any changes that might need to be made to it
- listing who will be attending the event
- live polling features to receive immediate feedback from the event participants on their satisfaction with the event. Asking questions such as 'were your expectations met by attending this event?' can provide valuable immediate feedback. More detailed questions can also be asked, for example, participant satisfaction with the events' catering outlets, transportation and ticketing system
- maximizing participant engagement through the information they provide
- personalising participant engagement by recommending which event sessions they should attend (based on their social media profile)
- promoting the sponsors of the event by including their videos and logos on the event app
- providing event participants with valuable networking opportunities by enabling participants to connect through bespoke networking communities and one-to-one messaging
- providing profile information of the key speakers at the event

For many participants, event apps have become an increasingly expected part of the live event experience; for many event managers, event apps present a valuable opportunity for better

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managing and measuring live events. Event apps provide a method of gathering data about participants, such as which sessions at the event were the most popular and conversely which were the least popular. In addition, the event app will enable the event manager to analyse who attended the event, which companies and industries the participants were employed by, the job functions of the participants, and where the participants came from geographically.

Analysing the data collected through an event app will give the event manager a picture of the participants and their behaviour from the moment they first engage with the event to the time they leave. All of this information can help the event manager to plan subsequent events (design the content of the next event and the marketing strategy to be implemented to attract participants) using the data generated from the event app.

Event apps should now be seen as a valuable extension of the event manager's team and, when used strategically, can enhance participant engagement with the event as well as helping to improve the efficiency of staging the event.

Where can the technology be used?

As mentioned previously in this chapter, technology can be used at all stages of the event preparation, planning, organisation and management phases. Some examples of technologies that can be used in events are as follows:

Across All Phases

- antivirus and malware protection software
- artificial intelligence– robots and chatbots
- business matching of participants (networking opportunities)
- CAPTCHAS – an online test to see if the person is human
- cloud servers for storing digital files and big data
- collaboration tools

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- credit card payment technologies across currencies
- data security software
- drones for aerial photography and live streaming
- electronic brochure, catalogues, magazines and promotional flyers
- electronic contracts and legal document signing
- electronic invoicing
- encrypted signatures
- Facebook Messenger
- file sharing
- live streaming feeds
- Google Maps
- mobile applications
- mobile/satellite Wi-Fi
- networking tools for the participants
- official event blog and vlog
- official event website
- online advertisements
- online manuals
- online payments
- open source software
- photo editing software
- process flow software
- push notifications – delivering information to mobile devices
- QR codes
- redundant servers – the provision of 'back-up servers'
- SMS messaging
- Skype communications
- smartphone printers
- social media and networking sites
- task management software
- touchscreen devices
- temporary Wi-Fi hotspots
- traffic advisories

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- WhatsApp
- Wi-Fi connectivity
- Viber

Event Planning and Coordination

- abstract management software for paper presenters
- accelerated registration of participants
- accounting applications
- affiliate marketing technology
- appointment scheduling software
- automated call for papers
- automated peer review management
- computer-aided design (CAD)
- conference management
- database management
- Facebook account
- flexible listening tools
- flowcharts
- GIFs
- Instagram account
- mobile payments
- mobile RSVPs
- online bookings for flights, transport and accommodation
- online exhibit/conference manuals
- online maps
- online registration forms
- online request for proposals (RFPs)
- online search for vendors, suppliers, and contractors
- online ticket sales and downloading of tickets
- Pinterest
- project management software
- security technology – CCTV, X-ray machines
- touch pens
- Twitter account

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- voice over internet protocol (VOIP)
- volunteer database

Event Production and Staging

- 3D imaging
- 360 degrees videos
- animation
- archived documents, photos and webinars
- artificial intelligence
- augmented reality
- automated transcription
- badges
- bag checks
- barcodes
- beacons
- business card scanners
- charging ports
- crowdsourcing
- decibel monitors
- digital note-taking
- digital signage
- drones
- electronic directories
- electronic signages
- event marketing
- facial recognition
- gamification
- geo-location tools
- green screen
- hand-outs
- headsets
- holograms
- inbox management
- information sharing for attendees

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- large LED screens
- live video streaming
- live updates
- microphones
- online communities
- onsite online kiosks
- photo booths
- podcasts
- projectors
- push notifications
- pyrotechnics
- radios
- radio frequency identification (RFID)
- real-time editing
- revolving stage
- robots
- scoreboards
- security verification
- shared digital notes
- speaker database
- ticket scanning
- transcription services
- translation services
- webcams
- video calls
- virtual reality games
- virtual reality chats
- virtual tours
- voice-activated tools
- wearable technology

Evaluation of the Event

- attendance tracking for check-in
- attendance per session

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- big data analytics
- bookmarks
- booth visits
- business matchmaking
- foot traffic
- Google analytics
- hashtag trackers
- heat maps
- lead generation
- networking
- online forums
- online surveys
- polls
- social media analytics
- split advertisement tests
- sustainability calculators
- ticket sales
- URL trackers
- users download data
- web traffic

With such a variety of different types of technology from which to choose, the event manager has to be analytical in the decision-making process.

Decision points when choosing technology

The decision to use technology for an event should be based on criteria, for example:

- the specific technology must match the purpose of its use. Indoor events may not necessarily benefit from drones. However, drones for use in open-air venues must follow government policies and legal restrictions
- the technology should enhance participant engagement and not interfere with their event experience. For example,

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mobile apps should be easily downloadable on any platform. Its use will be limited if it is only downloadable on a specific brand of a gadget. Also, the app should be free for use during the event, otherwise, participants may decide not to use the app

- the technology must fit into the layout and floor plan of the venue. The set-up of the technology equipment may require more space. It can also block the view of the participants as well as impose restrictions on room-layouts, for example, banquet arrangements
- will the supplier be willing to provide onsite technical support from the rehearsals to the actual event? This way, the technological equipment will have been tested with provisions for back-up
- the costs, as well as the savings to be gained from the use of technology, should justify its use
- the safety and security of all stakeholders must be factored in when using technology including the confidentiality of guest information that might be collected by the event manager through participant registration forms and payment methods

Checklist for the use of technology

When the event manager is considering which type of technology to use for the event, some factors have to be taken into account:

Buy-In

- are the event stakeholders aware of the capabilities and limitations of event technology?
- are the event stakeholders interested in using technology?
- does the technology contribute to achieving the aims and objectives of the event?
- In which phase of the event will the technology be used?
- which specific technological tools will be used in the event?
- will technology enhance the participant experience?

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Compliance with Legal and Privacy Laws

- are the participants' data safe, what safeguards are in place?
- is the technology being used compliant with legal laws?
- is the technology being used compliant with privacy laws?
- who will own the data generated from the event?

Costs vis-à-vis Return on Investment

- can the technology enhance the image of the event stakeholders?
- is it possible to have the technology sponsored?
- is it possible to pre-select the technological features needed for the event?
- is the cost of using technology within the budget for the event?
- is the fee for using the technology negotiable?
- is the technology free to use?
- what is the opportunity cost of not using technology?
- what is the cost of the technology per participant?
- will a customized technology solution be more cost-effective?

Production and Staging

- can the internet bandwidth at the venue support the use of technology?
- how long will it take to test and rehearse the use of the technology?
- how much space will the technology equipment occupy?
- how much storage space will the technology equipment require?
- where will the technology be situated on the floor plan for the event?
- will the technology limit the movement of the participants in the venue?
- will the technology enhance participant engagement?
- what will be the overall impact of using technology?

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Systems Integration

- are the servers using cloud technology?
- are there options for integrating the technology into the current systems?
- is there a need to purchase additional technological equipment and accessories?

Technical Support

- can the event staff be trained to use the technology?
- can the event staff be trained to troubleshoot problems with the technology?
- how long is the learning curve for the event staff after their training?
- is the technology safe from viruses and malwares?
- is there onsite support for the technology for the duration of the event?
- is there offsite technological support?
- will participants be given assistance with the technology they need to use?

By answering the questions above, the event manager will be in a better position to decide on the use of technology and the technical support that might be required from technology professionals to integrate and implement the technology into the event.

An important part of the event manager's own personal development is keeping up to date with the rapid changes that are occurring in the design and development of new technologies for the events industry. Keeping up to date with advancements in technology will be an important part of being a successful event manager.

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18 Providing Access for People with Special Needs

The event manager needs to understand how to prepare, plan and organise events so that they are inclusive and accessible for all members of society. In some nations, it is a legal requirement that all events do not discriminate against and prevent people from attending them because they have special needs such as a disability. Disability discrimination can be of three types.

- direct discrimination where a person is directly treated less favourably than someone else because they have a disability
- indirect disability discrimination where a business process indirectly disadvantages disabled people
- discrimination arising from disability where a person is treated less favourably than someone else, not because of their disability, but because of something connected with it

The event manager must organises events that do not discriminate against any members of society so that everyone can enjoy participating in the event without any restrictions placed on their participation as a result of their special needs.

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When organising events, it is not just about ensuring everyone can access the physical space where the event is taking place but it involves planning and organising the event so that all participants can enjoy the same standard of service and the same experience irrespective of their special needs. The event manager should make all possible and feasible reasonable adjustments to the design and organisation of the event to enable all event participants to have the same or similar experience of the event. Any 'inaccessible features' of the event should be removed or minimised.

Some principles can be followed by the event manager that will enable all members of society an equal opportunity to enjoy and participate in the event.

Pre-event promotional material

At the early preparation and planning stage, the event manager should consider how the event will be promoted and how the tickets will be sold. Some people with special needs such as people with learning difficulties should not be prevented from going to the event because they are unable to understand what the nature of the event is and how they can purchase tickets.

The pre-event information that is published should include details of how people with special needs can purchase tickets and reserve seats at the venue. In addition, the pre-event information should specify the facilities that will be provided at the event for people with special needs and how their personal carers will be able to support them at the event.

Access

Careful thought needs to be given to the access routes to the event venue and the circulation routes within the venue. Will people with special needs be able to travel to the venue by public transport

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that has been adapted for people with a disability? If a private car or taxi is used, is there a drop-off and collection point for people with special needs? What about car parking spaces, are they close to the entrance of the venue? When entering the event venue, will there be a separate entry point for people with special needs to reduce the amount of time they will have to spend queuing?

Within the venue, flooring should be even and solid to enable easy access by wheelchair users. All flooring materials must be securely fastened to the floor to prevent people from tripping, especially people with visual impairments. Ramps have to be provided on inclines which will pose difficulties for wheelchair users. Any obstacles in the access or circulation routes need to be identifiable through tapes or contrasting colours. All unnecessary obstacles (including furniture) should be removed from the space that is being used by event participants.

Stewards who are on duty or other event staff need to be trained in providing appropriate support and guidance to all event participants in the zone of the event where they are working.

Furniture

The event manager needs to consider the furniture that is to be used at the event, for example, chairs and tables. The furniture that is used should enable people with special needs to feel comfortable at all times during the event and if need be specially designed furniture with appropriate armrests or side supports should be provided.

Lighting, information and signage

The brightness of the lighting at the event should be such that everyone can see the access and circulation routes they have to follow, but care needs to be taken to ensure that the lights do not glare and cause further visual distress for people with sight

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impairment. If strobe lighting, flashing lights or other special visual effects are to be used, information about their use should be communicated in the pre-event promotional material and during the event itself.

The visuals that are used at the event have to be accessible and readable by all event attendees. The signs should be positioned so that they can be read but, at the same time, do not cause an obstruction. For people with a visual impairment, it is better to position all information messages and signage close together in a print and font size that is easy to read. Contrasts in the colours used should be such that they do not result in the text becoming difficult to read and having a variety of UPPER CASE and lower-case text is better than having all text in either upper or lower case.

Sensory adjustments

The event manager has to make all reasonable adjustments at the event for people with sight or hearing impairments. Large print text, documents printed in Braille, and audio-apps or tapes can all be utilised if appropriate. If videos are to be shown at the event, can they be audio described and sub-titled? Hearing induction loops can be provided at the event for people with hearing impairments. This technology helps to reduce certain background noises whilst at the same time accentuating the spoken voice. Professionals who have sign language interpretation and communication skills or deaf-blind communication skills can be employed at the event to help people with hearing and visual impairments to understand what is being communicated by performers at the event.

The colour schemes that are chosen for the design of the event can have an impact on people with a visual impairment. Colours have 'tones' and for some people who have a visual difficulty some colours that might seem to contrast look quite similar. Green and

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brown colours, pink and grey are very similar tonally and should not be used next to each other at an event.

Facilities for people with special needs

When a venue is being considered for use as an event venue, the event manager has to review the facilities it has for people with special needs, for example, catering provision, car parking for disabled people, and toilets that can be used by people with special needs. Concerning catering, a table service option should be considered for people with special needs to reduce the requirement for them to queue at a self-service buffet counter. In addition, does the venue publish information that will inform people with special needs how to travel to the venue and what facilities are available within the venue itself to make it an inclusive and accessible venue? Examples of how the event manager can organise an event that is accessible to people with different special needs are provided here:

People with physical disabilities

- allow entry to the venue before the start of the event
- if required, provide an early exit from the event
- have a supply of mobility aids at the venue, for example, crutches, canes, and wheelchairs
- make sure the venue has smooth pathways
- the provision of ramps at the venue is essential wherever there is a staircase or a steep incline
- if disabled people will be required to go on to the stage, a mechanical hoist (or some other aid) should be provided for people in a wheelchair to make the stage accessible in a dignified way

People with hearing impairment

- if appropriate, consider providing a written text of the script for people with a hearing impairment

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- offer writing materials to people with hearing impairment so that they can write down questions or comments that they might have during the event
- if sign language interpretation is provided ensure that the people with a hearing impairment can see the person communicating in sign language – adequate lighting is needed as well as proximity to the sign language interpreter

People with sight impairment

- facilities at the event should be provided for people who might bring a guide dog
- stewards or event staff should guide people with a sight impairment to their seats and should be attentive to their needs throughout the event
- literature in Braille or an audio system should be provided as standard for people with a sight loss
- if possible, dim or low lighting at the venue and during the event should be avoided as it will make it difficult for people with sight loss to see the event

Pregnant women and women with small children

- at events especially intended for pregnant women, female personal attendants should be arranged to provide support and care for the pregnant women
- special baby feeding rooms with bed facilities for the mothers of newborn babies are essential
- there should be separate entry and exit doors for pregnant women to reduce the amount of time they have to stand and queue
- comfortable seating should be arranged near the entry and exit doors
- a secure space will be required to park prams
- nutritious food must be offered as part of the catering service
- high chairs for children should be provided, especially in the dining area

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- a child play area should be provided to keep them entertained during the event

Elderly people

- priority should be given to elderly people when entering and exiting the event venue and when queuing for facilities such as toilets
- stewards or event staff should guide elderly people to their seats and should be attentive to their needs throughout the event
- reserved seats for elderly people should be provided at the front of the venue or in a location that will enable them to enjoy the event in a relaxed and comfortable manner
- catering staff should be prompt in serving elderly people with water, snacks, tea and other beverages

Events for an international audience

- consider using an event app that has simultaneous translation capability
- if it is a large event with participants from many nationalities, a variety of interpreters or multi-lingual staff should be employed to provide support for the people who do not speak the main language in which the event is being conducted
- event signage indicating directions to important places such as food/snack counters and toilets should be printed in appropriate languages

Emergency procedures

All emergency evacuation procedures and emergency exit routes at the event venue have to be designed for people with special needs. The stewards and event staff, as part of their training, need to be informed about the procedures to be followed if an emergency occurs at the event and how to evacuate safely and calmly people with special needs.

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Ensuring an event is accessible for people with special needs

The above principles will help the event manager to develop an understanding of the issues involved in planning, preparing, and organising the event for people with special needs. Everyone has basic needs when attending an event, but the requirements for people with special needs in event management are different. Movement and activities which look simple and easy to a physically and mentally fit person do not seem so to those with disabilities. For instance, a lack of ramps at the venue is problematic for people with a physical disability as is the problem of hearing or seeing a performer at the event for someone with a sensory impairment. The event is not a product; it is a service. The event manager is the service provider. Thus, it is their responsibility to make the event accessible to people with different physical and sensory abilities. The principles specified above will help the event manager to design an event that is accessible to people with special needs with empathy, not sympathy.

A key part of planning, preparing, and organising an inclusive, fully accessible event is that of carefully choosing the event venue. Before selecting the event venue, the event manager should visit the proposed venue to review how suitable it is to provide an inclusive environment for all event participants. During the visit, a comprehensive health and safety risk assessment should be undertaken that specifically considers the risks that the venue might pose for people with special needs. The health and safety risk assessment will help the event manager to learn about the vulnerable spots in the event venue that might need to be adjusted to make the venue accessible for all event participants.

In addition, feedback could also be received from different groups of potential event attendees, for example, pregnant women and elderly people, to identify their needs when at the event and how the activities can be designed to enable them to participate

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safely in and to enjoy the event. Once appropriate reasonable adjustments have been made, the event manager should then ensure that training is provided to all stewards and event staff on how they can provide support, help and guidance to people with special needs. A key part of the training programme should be on how the event personnel should address and speak to people with special needs – speaking directly with the person rather than their personal carer and speaking in a respectful, polite non-condescending manner. The training should also include ancillary event staff such as transport personnel and caterers – this will ensure that an inclusive experience can be provided for people with special needs.

The importance of preparing, planning, and organising accessible events

The event manager is now expected to organise inclusive events that are accessible by all members of society. Wherever possible, reasonable adjustments have to be made so that people with special needs can attend and enjoy the event. This can be extremely challenging if the event is using a non-standard venue which has not been purpose-designed to hold events. Specialist health and safety consultants may well have to be employed to assist the event manager in designing the event. In some nations, this is a new development for the events industry, but there should be no reason why certain members of society are excluded from attending an event because of their special needs.

When the event manager has designed one fully inclusive and accessible event, the learning that is gained should then be transferred to the next event so that, over time, designing inclusive, accessible events becomes a standard element of the event organising process. This will have significant benefits as people with special needs who enjoyed their event experience are likely to attend future events organised by the event company and recommend their friends to do so as well.

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So, when planning an inclusive, accessible event, the event manager needs to consider how all stages of the event lifecycle can be made welcoming for people with special needs – the pre-event stage, during the event and the post-event stage. Different aspects of the event have to be adjusted to make them accessible for people with special needs – transportation to and from the venue, registration and entry to the event, the venue and its facilities, the event itself and the event staff who will be interacting with all event participants. "Something for everyone" should be the objective of an inclusive, accessible event.

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19 Develop and Write Policies and Procedures for an Event

All event organising companies need to have formal written policies and procedures that their employees comply with. Policies are principles that guide the overall direction of a particular functional area of an organisation whilst procedures are more detailed step-by-step process-orientated instructions that have to be followed and implemented to ensure compliance with the policies. Policies and procedures specify the standards of performance and behaviour that employees have to meet and how they are to conduct the business of the organisation to meet all relevant laws and regulations. Well written policies and procedures contribute to the culture of the organisation and how it is perceived by its employees and stakeholders.

Writing clear and precise policies and procedures is a skill that the event manager needs to develop to enable their event organising company to operate effectively. The event manager has to fully understand all the laws and regulations that relate to the type of event that is being staged and consequently which aspects of the event require policies and procedures to be developed so that the event organising company complies with the law, regulations and other requirements for the event.

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Review legal, regulatory, and other requirements for the event

When a venue has been chosen and the creative concept has been developed, the event manager must confirm that all of the elements involved in staging the event complies with national and local laws, regulatory and other requirements set by the different organisations who are responsible for authorising the event to take place. These legal and regulatory requirements will vary by the type of venue to be used (indoor or outdoor, purpose-built for events or a specially adapted venue) and the city and country where the event will take place. Therefore, research has to be conducted in advance to identify which legal and regulatory requirements for the event might need specific policies and procedures being written by the event manager.

Some of these legal and regulatory requirements could be directly linked to the potential risks associated with organising the event, for example, the risk of fire or the potential for the venue to be overcrowded which could result in a safety hazard for the event participants. The event manager is legally responsible for complying with and implementing the relevant legal and regulatory requirements for staging the event. The policies and procedures that are developed will set the standards of performance that event staff and stakeholders will have to follow to enable the event to fully comply with the legal and regulatory requirements that are in place.

Identify which aspects of the event need policies and procedures

Many different aspects of the event could require policies and procedures to be written. For example, some event participants may need to drive to the venue and so the development of parking policies and procedures will be essential for the event planning process. Another example of where policy and procedure will

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be required is in the recruitment, training, and employment of event staff. Policies and procedures for the event staff could cover a variety of different aspects such as the terms and conditions of their employment, the training that is to be provided for them, and what the employees are to do if an emergency arises at the event.

Figure 17 provides a systematic way to identify which aspects of the event might need the development and writing of specific policies and procedures.

Based on the internationally recognised Event Management Body of Knowledge (EMBOK) Domain Structure, the five domains of risk, administration, design, marketing and operation all consist of technical knowledge, specialized skills and ethical standards. Each of these domains will need to be considered by the event manager to see if policies and procedures need to be written to ensure that the event complies with the relevant laws and regulations in the country where the event is taking place. A

Figure 17: A Systematic Checklist of Aspects of the Event that Might Require Policies and Procedures

√	Environment Design
√	Hunan Resources
√	Public Relations
√	Financial Management
√	Food & Beverage
√	Transportation
√	Foreign Affairs
√	Lottery & Gaming
√	Intellectual Property



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further checklist for considering which domains might require policies and procedures being written can be developed by considering specific aspects of the event, for example, it's:

- environmental design and the need to comply with environmental laws and regulations
- human resource management and employment law
- public relations strategy and how to manage media relations
- financial management of the event and the receipt of monies and payment of expenses
- food and beverage provision and the need to comply with food safety regulations
- transport plans for the event
- foreign affair aspects of the event and dealing with customs and immigration procedures
- lottery and gaming legislation and regulations in the country where the event is taking place
- intellectual property rights and the 'ownership' of the intellectual property generated by the event

Analyse existing policies and procedures to see if these cover the aspects where policies and procedures are needed

For some frequently recurring events policies and procedures may already exist, for example, policies and procedures for the employment of event staff. If this is the case, the event manager should analyse these policies and procedures to determine whether they are still applicable to the new event that is being organised or if they have to be amended. Besides, many venues, administrative authorities or institutional partners may have their own existing policy and procedure documents which the event manager can use.

Where necessary, obtain and act on expert advice and information

Event managers are always seeking new, innovative and creative

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experiences for their clients. Pushing the boundaries of existing event experiences will probably involve incorporating new technologies or special effects into the design of the event. In these circumstances, it will be essential that the event manager employs specialist consultants or contractors who are experienced in the technology or special effects that are to be used. When the innovative event experience has been designed, policies and procedures will likely have to be written and communicated to all event staff and stakeholders. In writing these policies and procedures, the event manager should work with the specialist consultants or contractors who are experts in this type of event experience to ensure that correct and accurate information is included in the policy documents.

Draft or up-date policies and procedures as necessary

When writing policy and procedure documents, five principles must be kept in mind:

- have a consistent writing style and format
- write in the 'third person', do not use 'I' or 'we'
- choose words carefully – use words whose meaning is precise and unambiguous, avoid vacuous words which do not have a clear meaning
- use the same template or structure for all documents
- ensure the policy and procedure documents are easy to use and to understand

A suggested structure for the policy and procedure document is:

- front page - the policy title, the date it was approved
- introduction page(s) – what the policy is about, who it applies to, the reason why it has been developed, the laws, regulations and requirements that relate to the policy and its procedures
- the policy and procedure statement pages – the exact details of the policy and procedures, the standards of performance and behaviour that have to be met, detailed step-by-step instructions on how compliance is to be achieved

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- scope pages – who the policy and procedures relate to and who is responsible for their implementation
- definitions page (if required) – to define any abbreviations, words or phrases that might not be understood by all people who read the document
- appendices (if required) – supplementary information and forms that need to be completed to show compliance with the policy and procedures should be included in the appendices

When a first draft of the policy and procedures document has been written, it will be important to test the feasibility of the contents of the document through a practical exercise. The event staff who will be implementing the policy and procedures should be required to follow the policy and procedures either in a simulated scenario or a real-life situation to see how they work in practice. The feedback received from the event staff should then be used to refine and amend the draft policy and procedure so that it can be finalised and approved as being a formal event company policy.

Ensure policies and procedures are understood and observed by all stakeholders

When the policy and procedure documents have been produced, the event manager should ensure that they are collated and distributed to all relevant event stakeholders through face-to-face training and online or hard copy circulation. Following the training, the event stakeholders should undergo an assessment to ensure that they have understood the content of the policy and procedures document. Everyone who completes the training and assessment should be awarded a company certificate to confirm that they have attained the required level of knowledge and understanding. If someone does not pass the assessment, then further training might be needed to ensure that they fully meet the performance standards that are required.

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The event manager should ensure that an up-to-date record is kept of the people who attended the training and the outcomes of their assessment. Then, throughout the full event life cycle, the event manager needs to monitor the performance of the event staff to verify that they are applying in their work practice the standards of behaviour and performance that are stipulated in the policies and procedures. If non-compliance with the policies and procedures is identified, further training and support might be needed for those employees who are not working to the expected standards.

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20 Select Contractors and Suppliers for an Event

Selecting contractors and suppliers for the event is another important task of the event manager. There are many different services, activities and functions that are needed to stage the event and could be sub-contracted to independent contractors and suppliers, for example, the construction of the rigging and staging and the provision of multi-media technology.

To utilise the services of a sub-contractor, the event manager has to produce a written brief (specification) of what the work tasks and activities will be and then invite tenders from sub-contractors who have the skills and experience to carry out the work. Prior to the release of invitations for proposals, the event manager should have completed a needs assessment of the event and what the sub-contractors and suppliers will be expected to do.

When bids are received from potential sub-contractors and suppliers, they need to be assessed against selection criteria to ensure that they are evaluated according to the objectives, theme, concept, and needs of the event. A number of factors will be taken

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into account when the event manager reviews the bids:

- the quoted price from the sub-contractor
- previous business relationships with the sub-contractor
- the closeness of the bid to the exact requirements of the event manager
- references that the event manager might be able to obtain from previous clients of the sub-contractor

It is always useful to keep a record of the bids that are received and use this record as part of the selection process for the preferred sub-contractor. Figure 18 provides a sample form that can be used for this purpose.

Once contractors and suppliers have been selected, the event manager should establish effective working relationships with them by adopting the following principles:

- accept feedback from the contractors and suppliers to ensure that the quality and consistency of all aspects of the event planning process progresses efficiently
- behave ethically and honestly in all dealings with the contractors and suppliers
- build rapport and communicate with them in a professional, timely, patient and appropriate manner
- deal proactively with contractor and suppliers' complaints or problems
- develop relationships with them that demonstrate trust, commitment and cooperation
- ensure that all contractors and suppliers are fully briefed on what their tasks and responsibilities are before they commence their work
- ensure that the contractors and suppliers deliver what each has promised within the timescale agreed
- monitor and evaluate the effectiveness of the relationships regularly

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Figure 18: Sample Form for Collating Bids from Suppliers

ITEM	Supplier 1	Supplier 2	Supplier 3	Notes
Hotel accommodations (5 Star)				
Single				
Double				
Suites				
Hotel accommodations (4 Star)				
Single				
Double				
Suites				
Event venue				
Function rooms				
Exhibition halls				
Ballroom				
Storage				
Kitchen				
Amenities				
Facilities				
Technology				
Onsite/online registration				
Drones				
Event applications				
Marketing Collaterals				
Advertising Agency				
Independent Art Director				
Independent Photographer				
Printer				
Web Designer				
Social Media				
Shipping and Logistics				
Freight Forwarder				
Customs Brokerage				
Delivery				

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- provide feedback to the contractors and suppliers on the quality and efficiency of the products and services that they provide
- record the expectations, conversations and agreed actions that take place with the contractors and suppliers.

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Case Study:

Storytelling: The Miss Universe Pageant

All events should tell a story. One of the first things an event manager should do when planning an event is to determine the story that their client would like to tell through the event. Storytelling is frequently ignored by clients and event managers, yet a story-based event will result in a more memorable experience for the event participants if creatively designed.

When designing the story, the event manager should structure it so that it has a beginning, middle and end. Having a clear structure for the story is essential as it provides a guide through the event for the participants. The script of the story is the actual content of the event. At each stage of the event (beginning, middle and end), the script should be designed to meet the objectives of the event and to communicate the message clearly and simply to the participants. It is always best to keep the script simple and aligned precisely with the purpose of the event.

Wherever possible, the participants of the event should be immersed in the story, ideally as co-creators of the event itself. If this can be achieved, the participants will have a more engaging experience and will remember the event in the months ahead. When thinking about who will be the participants, all of the key stakeholders can be included – the audience or guests; the event company employees; event exhibitors; the conference speakers; and the actors and performers who contribute to the program of the event. All of these stakeholders are the characters of the story and can have a role to play in communicating the message that the client of the event wishes to send to all of the participants.

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The Miss Universe Pageant is a good example of how to tell a story through an event and to immerse that participants into the event from the beginning of the pageant right to the end. The first Miss Universe Pageant was held in California in 1952 by a company called Pacific Mills that produced ladies bathing costumes. In 1952, there were very few means for an organisation to advertise and promote its products nationally and internationally – very limited printed media, television and cinema advertising. Pacific Mills wanted to advertise its ladies bathing costumes to an international audience so decided to create a beauty pageant contest where all of the competitors would wear one of their bathing costumes. Thus, the first story to be communicated through the Miss Universe Pageant was the style and design of the bathing costumes produced by Pacific Mills.

Now, the Miss Universe Pageant communicates many different stories and messages to a global audience. To compete in the final of the pageant, each country holds its own contest to select the contestant who will represent their country in the final. This is a great opportunity to immerse the population of each competing country in the pageant in the months ahead of the final by giving the populations of these countries the chance to vote for their preferred candidate to go forward to the final.

In the days before the actual Miss Universe Pageant final, the contestants undertake a tour of the country where the final is being staged. This provides an opportunity for the host nation to tell a story about the leading tourist destinations in that country which are included in the tour program of the finalists.

The actual final of the competition is broadcast live around the world through digital technology providing a showcase for the host destination to demonstrate its ability to stage such a global event. During the event, the fashion and jewellery designers from each

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of the competing nations can tell a story about their expertise by designing the costumes and accessories that the contestant from their country wears. The audience that attends the final is fully immersed in the competition by being able to cheer and applaud their country's contestant whenever she is on stage. When the new Miss Universe is chosen, she is awarded a 12-month contract to travel the world to promote and communicate messages on issues that are of importance to her – so the story continues after the final of the pageant has come to an end.

All events should tell a story and, as demonstrated by the Miss Universe Pageant, many different stories can be told through an event. By immersing all participants in the stories, the event manager will have designed a more successful event.

EVIDENCE REQUIRED FOR THE APIEM CERTIFIED EVENT MANAGER QUALIFICATION

For readers who want to study for the APIEM Certified Event Manager Qualification, you are to select an event that you have organised in the previous 12 months or are going to organise in the next 12 months and provide a portfolio of evidence that will contain:

1) Evidence of the research undertaken to research and agree on the scope of the event with the client – the questionnaire used with the client to establish their requirements and the outcomes of the research with the client. The concept that was designed and developed for the event – what is creative and innovative about the concept?
2) Evidence of the technology used for the event and an explanation of the technical support provided to ensure that all aspects of the use of technology were successful.
3) Information on how the event will provide access for people with special needs.
4) Copies of the main policies and procedures written for the event.

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5) An explanation of how the contractors and suppliers were selected.

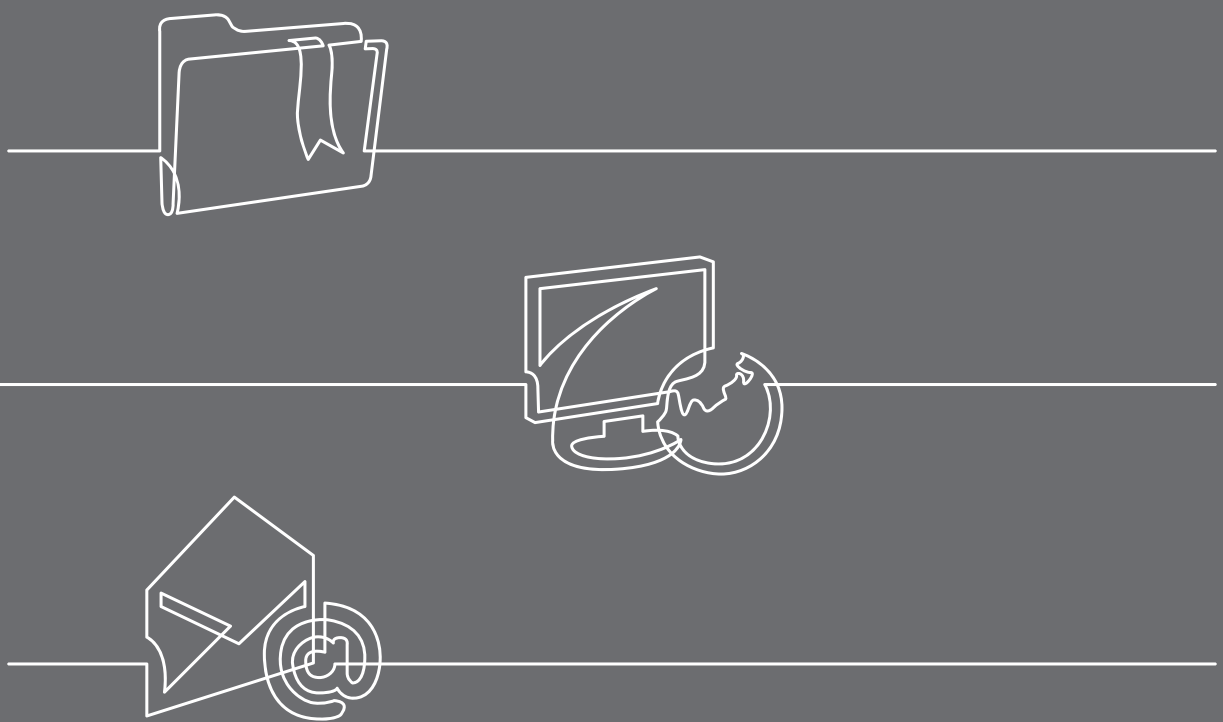
You will also write a reflective report that explains:

1) The process you followed for researching for the concept of the event – how did you carry out the research? The challenges faced in carrying out the research.
2) The reasons for designing and developing the concept for the event in the way that you did.
3) The reasons for using the different types of technology implemented for the event.
4) The challenges or difficulties that will have to be overcome by providing access to the event for people with special needs.
5) The importance of having the policies and procedures for the event.

The importance of having criteria for the selection of contractors and suppliers.

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chapter 5
organising the event

After reading this chapter, you will be able to:

- organise the set-up and break-down of an event
- organise and co-ordinate events
  - before the event
  - at the event
  - after the event
- manage the running of an event
- coordinate the stewards at an event

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21 Organise the Set-up and Break-down of an Event

The term 'event logistics' refers to the organized movement of people, machines, equipment and other resources required to stage an event. The event manager is required to develop a detailed logistical plan for the organisation of the set-up and break-down of an event to guide event contractors, suppliers, and other stakeholders in the work they have to perform. A well-written logistical plan, referred to as the event manual, is a key component of the process for successfully organising an event. The event manual and its contents will be discussed later in this chapter. First, consideration will be given to the factors that can influence the set-up and break-down of an event.

Factors affecting the set-up and break-down of an event

The process for the set-up and break-down of an event depends on several factors. First, the set-up and break-down of an event may differ based on the complexity of the event objectives, concept and location. For example, an outdoor event may require tents, stanchions, and quick access to a kitchen. It will also require a back-up plan in case of an abrupt change in weather. Events which are held in a purpose-built indoor venue will not require such complex set-up arrangements.

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Next, the requirements for each phase of organising the event can also be based on the magnitude and scope of the event. If the event manager is organising a small-scale community event that is taking place on a single day attracting local participants, there will be far fewer factors to take into account in the set-up and break-down of this event than those factors that have to be taken into account when organising a major or mega sports events that will run over a four weeks period.

Third, the event manager must be sensitive to the cultural norms and traditions of the country and location where the event is being staged. For example, events with Muslim employees should take into consideration their prayer schedules. For events in Spain, the "siesta," which can be loosely defined as "rest time" is important and might affect the availability of employees to work during the siesta. The event manager must review events scheduled during major holidays to understand the implications of these dates on the organisation of the event such as the availability of venues, rooms, and transportation, among other requirements. In addition, traffic movements and congestion can increase during holiday periods, which can affect the on-time delivery of equipment that is needed for the set-up of the event.

Finally, the event manager must abide by the laws and regulations pertinent to the set-up and break-down of the event in the locality where the event is being staged. These include permissions for staging the event, local transport regulations, health and safety legislation, international protocols relating to customs and immigration procedures, and security procedures.

Event manual

To ensure the event is professionally organised so that the set-up and break-down procedures are well-coordinated and synchronized, the event manager must prepare a manual of

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policies and procedures for distribution to all the key stakeholders – this is known as the event manual.

An event manual is a **key tool** that provides guidance and reference for all principal staff and advisors working on the event. It recounts final decisions taken by the event's key planners on all operational aspects of the event and provides a practical operational guide. It will help ensure that all the operational aspects about the event that have been decided upon to date are logged in one document and that the key decision-makers in the event team and any outside agencies are all working from the same information.

If the event is small and straightforward, the event manual will be concise and it may have very limited distribution to only the key event stakeholders. If the event is more complex, for instance, a large outdoor event or it takes place in a number of different venues all at the same time, the event manual will feature more information and is likely to have a much wider distribution list.

The event manager along with other key organisers should principally write the event manual but, if the operational aspects of the event have been planned with assistance and advice from outside agencies or partners who have an operational role, then these stakeholders should also be involved in the writing of the manual. When the manual has been written, all the key event planners and agencies must agree to the manual's methods and recommendations before it is published and distributed.

The event manual is essentially a 'How To' guide. It should contain all the information that is relevant for the set-up, operation and break-down of the event. It should be assembled with clear chapters or sections and each page should be numbered.

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A suggested format may include the following:

- front cover that states the event name, dates of the event, the person (s) who has prepared the manual as well as the date of issue
- introduction and/or statement of intent – a message from the event manager about the event manual's use
- the event, a general overview of the event and its location/ venue
- contents page clearly setting out the chapters/sections with page references
- distribution list, all those stakeholders who are to receive a copy of the manual and the organisations they represent
- event communications such as basic information about site contacts (where to find people and how to get in touch on site) and radio links (who has a two way-radio, which channel are they on)
- a copy of the event permits and passes (ie names of event personnel who have parking passes, access all area passes) could go in this section to inform everyone of what they look like and what they mean
- if the size or complexity of the event requires a Joint Agency Control Room, an explanation of its function and identification of those who will be present needs to be provided
- running order of the main event and any ancillary attractions
- site/venue plans, the physical layout of the event site to include car parks, first aid posts, fire safety equipment, emergency evacuation routes, loading/unloading areas and toilets
- contact details for each member of the event management team and when they will be on duty
- roles and responsibilities of all key agencies involved with the event in operational terms
- the names and contact details of the technical staff who will be on duty
- dates of ingress, egress, set-up and break-down

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- the sequence of entry of products and personnel
- requirements for ingress, egress, set-up and break-down, eg permits, inventory of products, ID requirements, parking areas, docking guidelines, storage areas
- method statements on all operational and safety aspects of the event. This section may include information on production, access and egress (of artists, competitors, staff and public), security and stewarding provisions, traffic, transport and parking arrangements and site facilities (such as toilets, medical provisions, lost persons, drinking water etc). All facilities that are mentioned have to be plotted on the site/venue plans
- designated areas for storing equipment, equipment washing, power distribution, reserve generators and water supplies
- designated areas for religious worship
- details on arrangements for specific requirements, eg security for valuables, cryogenic freezers, live plant and animal sanitation, inspection, and quarantine, dangerous items
- policies on sustainable practices on-site including recycling and waste disposal
- emergencies and protocol – detail procedures for lost persons, medical emergencies, show-stopping, evacuation and the types of emergency announcements that could be made
- appendices – for ancillary and support information that may be required for reference during the operation of the event. Risk assessments, site rules, safety memos, staff briefing document, pre-event control measures, outside agency statements of intent etc can all be included here as appropriate

The event manager should not underestimate how crucial the event manual can be in the smooth set-up, running and break-down of an event. It is a tool that should be continually referred to by those who receive a copy. The reader must be able to trust its contents, so the information should be as detailed and up-to-

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date as possible. The information should be presented in plain language and be clearly indexed. The event manual must be streamlined and portable. If the information is proving lengthy, the event manager should decide whether appendices could be presented in a separate document.

The first draft of the event manual should be prepared as soon as planning for the event commences. Information is then added when it becomes available and obsolete information is removed when it is no longer relevant for the organisation of the event.

Event forms

In organising the event, the event manager must prepare different types of documents to assist contractors and suppliers with their requests. Some of these documents must be submitted months in advance to ensure that the requirements can be fulfilled.

Some of these documents are for requests such as:

- electrical power supplies

Did you know?

- Your stakeholders will appreciate if you provide an area for religious worship at the event, especially in the Asia Pacific region. There is no need for special equipment in the room. Muslims will much appreciate if you place a Qibla sign that indicates the direction to face to perform ritual prayers. They will more appreciate it if you put a washroom nearby in order to do ritual purification with water before doing the prayer.
- Before you do the set-up, find out more about the local culture that might be beneficial for the organising of the event. Ask the do's and don'ts of local cultural practices to ensure that the event staff are working in-line with the norms and beliefs of the indigenous cultural system. In some areas, local people voluntarily help you to do the preparations for the event so that local customs and traditions are followed.

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- furniture and its set-up
- immigration and customs assistance
- installation of special facilities such as pyrotechnics
- parking slots for deliveries
- parking spaces for contractors and suppliers
- permits to bring flammable, toxic and hazardous materials onto the site
- storage facilities
- Request for VIP airport transfers
- VIP airport transfers

Ingress and egress

Ingress refers to the load-in and entry to the venue of equipment, furniture, products, and personnel in preparation for the event. While egress refers to the removal from the venue of all resources and supplies, ensuring that the venue is returned to its original state.

The event manager has to ensure that the entry and exit procedures to the venue are clear. A site map accompanying the event manual must mark specific areas for storage, waste disposal, catering and production facilities. First-aid posts, fire-fighting equipment, police booths, evacuation assembly points and evacuation routes must be marked on the site map.

In organising ingress and egress to the event venue, the event manager has to arrange for the following information to be prepared:

- dates and time schedules of move-in and move-out of each event phase, ie ingress, set-up, break-down and egress
- designated parking slots
- entrance gate passes for equipment, tools and supplies
- floor plan of the venue and layout
- identification cards for the event personnel, contractors and suppliers

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- list of allowable on-site equipment, tools, and supplies
- list of available materials for rent and/or sale, eg chairs, tables, cables etc
- list of inclusive services, eg housekeeping, janitorial, waste disposal etc
- list of names of contractors and suppliers who will need to access the venue
- list of names of event personnel who need to enter the venue and their contact details
- list of prohibited items
- location of docking areas
- location of storage facilities
- procedures for entry, eg location, security procedures etc
- provisions for power supplies, lighting, water etc
- request forms and rates for onsite services, eg signages
- sequence of entry of personnel and equipment

Set-up and break-down

Set-up refers to the temporary assembly and installation of all the facilities and equipment required for the staging of the event, for example, rigging, staging, event production technology, exhibition booths, catering equipment, seating and table settings. Once the equipment is installed, the event venue will probably need to be decorated and 'dressed' in the colours and styling for the theme of the event. Break-down refers to the dismantling of all temporary structures and removal of the event equipment from the venue that was used for the event. To ensure that the set-up of the event progresses efficiently, the event manager needs to inform the event stakeholders of the:

- entry and exit procedures of personnel
- entry and storage procedures for equipment
- policies on damage to property
- requirements for the use of sustainable materials and equipment
- rules for using walls

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- safety and security policies
- schedule of work hours
- waste disposal facilities

Specific information for entertainment shows

- designated parking slots for the artists and performers
- entry and exit procedures for artists and performers
- identification cards for artists and performers
- list of names of artists and performers
- lounge area and catering options
- rehearsal schedules
- requirements for the security detail

Specific information for sports events

- accommodations for athletes, coaches, medical personnel, and chaperones
- changing rooms
- locker rooms
- practice areas
- storage areas for equipment

Set-up and break-down schedule

Managing ingress, set-up, break-down and egress can be likened to a perfectly choreographed dance. To achieve a smooth logistical organisation of the event, each stakeholder group must be informed of the schedule for their tasks as well as those of other contractors and suppliers. This ensures that all stakeholders are aware of what everyone else is doing and how their work affects the activities of the others. Delays in the sequence of activities and tasks can lead to work interruptions, which could result in increased pressure on the event manager to ensure that the event starts on schedule.

A critical path method, such as a GANTT Chart, can be used to track progress with the logistical organisation of the event (see

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Chapter Three). Production schedules can be prepared on an hourly, daily, weekly and monthly basis depending on the scale of the event and the preference of the event manager.

Figure 19: Sample Set-up and Breakdown Timeline

Tasks and Details	Start	End	Person/s Responsible	Status
Inspect venue	5am	5.45am	Event Manager	
Load-in and set-up of stage	6am	8am	Event Manager	
Ingress, set-up, and test of lights and sound equipment	8am	10am	Audio-visual	
Ingress and set-up of technical team	8am	10am	Coordinator	
Technical rehearsals	10.30am	12noon	Coordinator	
Ingress of tables and chairs	12noon	1.30pm	Caterer	
Set-up of linen, cutlery, chinaware	2pm	3.30pm	Caterer	
Load-in and set-up of flowers	4pm	5pm	Florist	
Final run-through	5.30pm	6.30pm	Event Manager	

Information and communication technology tools

Information technology tools, such as mobile applications, Excel spreadsheets and software tools play an important role in the organisation of the event facilitating information sharing and updates, monitoring and coordinating the work of the event stakeholders. There are many types of software and applications that the event manager can use. It is highly recommended that the selected tools can work online/offline, require minimum internet speeds and are available for both Apple, Windows, Mac, and

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open systems to enable different types of device to be used. The technology that can be used when organising the event includes:

Software

- chatbots
- cloud for file storage and retrieval
- collaborative files
- email
- group chat applications
- meeting schedulers
- mobile device reminders
- online calendars
- portable data storage devices
- project management software
- scheduling tools
- shared work software
- spreadsheets
- 'to do' applications
- workflow management software

Communication tools

- laptops
- mobile phones
- tablets
- two-way radios

A checklist of key responsibilities for the set-up and break-down of an event

Finally, to make sure that the set-up and break-down of an event progress efficiently, the event manager needs to:

- communicate clearly with all those involved with the set-up and break-down of the event in line with agreed communications protocols
- complete all relevant documents and records relating to the

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event set-up and break-down and keep these in accordance with company policies

- ensure all event personnel receive the information, instruction, training and supervision they need to carry out their function
- ensure all resources used during set-up and break-down are checked, and respond correctly to any problems with the resources
- keep to the agreed plans for set-up and break-down, or adapt plans to changing circumstances, where necessary
- maintain the health, safety and welfare of all event personnel and resources throughout the set-up and break-down process
- after the event has finished, identify what the success points of the set-up and break-down were and how any mistakes can be rectified for future events

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22 Organize and Coordinate Events

Organizing and coordinating the event is another important responsibility of the event manager. To coordinate the event successfully three phases can be considered. Each of these phases will involve different work activities being undertaken:

Before the event, the event manager should:

- delegate functions to the event team as appropriate
- ensure all of the resources needed for the event have been ordered
- liaise with the venue to reconfirm all of the requirements for staging the event
- make arrangements for rehearsals, if required, to make sure that the event runs smoothly
- make sure all those involved with the event are briefed and trained to fulfil their roles

At the event, the event manager and the event personnel should:

- coordinate activities and resources during the event, in line with agreed plans
- ensure event participants feel welcome

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- liaise with venue management to prepare the venue and make sure all necessary resources are in place
- monitor compliance with relevant health, safety and security requirements during the event
- oversee the work of key staff during the event
- resolve any problems that occur
- respond promptly to participants' needs throughout the event

After the event, the event manager and the event personnel should:

- clear and vacate the venue, in accordance with the terms of the contract
- complete all documents and records that have to be kept as a result of staging the event
- reconcile the event accounts to the initial budget to determine the financial success of the event
- seek and collect feedback from those involved in the event, analyse the feedback received and share the analysis with relevant people so that the key learning points from staging the event can be used to improve the running of future events

Event coordination refers to the implementation of the logistics and operations across the three phases of the event specified above: pre-event, event proper and post-event. A timeline and an event action plan can be used to designate activities based on the schedule and the assigned personnel. The event action plan (and its checklist) is a valuable tool for monitoring the actual running of the event. The items listed in the action plan, as well as the schedules, are dependent on the scope and type of event that is being held. The event manager should be as detailed as possible in listing the required activities to ensure that all aspects of the coordination and running of the event are covered. A GANTT chart (see Chapter Three) can also complement the timeline and event action plan. Aside from the details listed in the event action

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plan, it facilitates quick monitoring of the scheduled activities for the event. An example of an event action plan is given here:

Figure 20: Sample Event Action Plan with Timeline

Schedule	Tasks	Person/s or Committees Responsible	Deadline	Status
Pre-Event				
9-12 months before the event	Conduct needs analysis, market research, and SWOT analysis			
	Prepare financial assumptions and forecasts			
	Design concept, objectives, and themes			
	Seek out sponsorships and partners			
	Meet with local tourism organizations			
	Finalize the business plan			
	Review corporate social responsibility plan			
	Designate committees and tasks			
	Incorporate sustainability practices			
	Invites for abstracts			
	Incorporate inclusive facilities			
6-9 months before the event	Identify venues and destinations			
	Source vendors and contractors			
	Conduct ocular inspections, food tasting, banquet arrangements			
	Book venues			
	Sign contracts with third parties			
	Secure assistance for safety, security, and risk mitigation			
	Review of final research papers			
	Prepare a critical path			
4-6 months before the event	Monitor construction, painting, and renovation			
	Begin sales and marketing collaterals			
	Design event organization structure			
	Design merchandise			
	Send invites to guests			
	Preparation of standard operating procedures			
	Confirm guests and performers			
	Secure permits and licenses			

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3 months before the event	Finalize transportation and hotel arrangements			
	Finalize staging, production, and catering arrangements			
	Finalize incentive tours			
	Finalize itinerary			
	Deposits due			
	Develop contingency measures			
	Order merchandise			
	Final list of participants			
	Distribute media kits			
2 months before the event	Finalize program			
	Finalize the event manual			
	Finalize accommodations			
	Finalize transportation			
	Prepare name tags and participant kits			
1 month before the event	Schedule press conferences and interviews			
	Discuss the protocol for dignitaries and VIPs			
	Finalize handover ceremonies			
2-3 weeks before the event	Recruit and train volunteers			
	Installation of posters, island signs, and other signages			
	Courtesy calls with relevant groups			
1 week before the event	Final inspection of all venues and supplies			
	Schedule technical and general rehearsals			
	Ingress and set-up			
	Major blitz for publicity and promotions			
	Load-in and set-up of technology tools			
	Set-up Secretariat office			
1-2 days before the event	Run-through of all technical equipment and onsite technology tools			
	Set-up registration counter			
	Provide office supplies for the Secretariat office			
	Install directional signages onsite			
	Implement safety and security protocol			
Event Proper				
	Generate feedback			
	Conduct inspection of venues, before and after each activity			
	Final technical rehearsal			

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	Position all teams before the start of each event			
	Designate officers-in-charge for each activity and venue			
	Centralize storage and distribution of tokens, medals, and certificates			
	Traffic re-routing			
	Awarding of medals, certificates, and tokens			
	Respond to inquiries			
	Troubleshoot problems			
Post-Event				
Immediately after the event	Housekeeping			
	Tear-down and egress			
	Final payments due			
	Proper waste disposal			
	Post-event publicity			
	Qualitative evaluation of the event			
1-4 weeks after the event	Quantitative evaluation of the event			
	Send thank you messages to stakeholders			
	Evaluation of vendors and suppliers			
	Evaluation of contractors			
	Evaluation of volunteers and staff			
	Audit reports			
	Financial reports			
	Submit final report			
2 months after the event	Review lessons learned			
	Research for new clients			
3-4 months after the event	Research on new event concepts			

Committees

Most events are coordinated and managed by teams of people who are grouped into specifically defined and named committees each with its function and tasks. A committee will have its own leader and the people within the committee will be assigned certain tasks that they have to undertake. The number of committees that have to be created will be dependent on the objectives, scope, magnitude and concept of the event. There can be few or several

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committees depending on the size and complexity of the event. Some of the committee work can be outsourced if specialist skills are required such as expertise in sponsorship, marketing, ticket sales or merchandising. Here are some of the most common committees created for events:

Secretariat

The Secretariat provides the leadership for the entire event, from planning to evaluation. The members set the strategic direction, decide on critical issues, and designate committees and their members. This committee acts as a liaison between the main client, key stakeholders, and the event team. Furthermore, the team liaises with pertinent organizations for the safety, security, and risk management of the event. It is highly recommended that an oversight committee is created as one of the key groups within the Secretariat. This team will be responsible for overseeing the details of the event ensuring that all arrangements are aligned with the concept and objectives. The role of the oversight committee is to avoid conflicts of interest and provide guidance on all aspects of the event.

Finance and Accounting

This committee organizes all matters relating to the financial management of the event and the various financial transactions that have to be made. The members are also responsible for the budget, the release of monies, record-keeping, and the preparation of financial statements for audit and report purposes. The Finance and Accounting Committee is also responsible for guiding activities related to generating sales and revenues, such as auctions, retail sales, and fund-raising.

Marketing

This committee is in charge of preparing a comprehensive marketing strategy for the event using the techniques of market

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segmentation, target marketing and the design of a marketing mix, namely product (event), pricing, distribution, and promotions using both traditional and social media methods. The members of this committee may also be responsible for liaising with VIPS; issuing event invitations; organizing the hospitality suite for artists, performers, dignitaries and VIPs; managing relations with the media; organizing ticket sales; arranging sponsorship; generating publicity; and soliciting partnerships with other organizations. Some of these marketing activities can be outsourced to expert marketing agencies if the event team does not have the expertise.

Program and Physical Arrangements Committee
This committee plans the program for the event in accordance with the concept, objectives and theme of the event. It is also involved in recommending the best physical arrangements for each part of the event, from the opening ceremony, gala dinner, competition areas, closing ceremony, break-out sessions, to the receptions. The committee members usually work in tandem with the catering and banquet suppliers.

Meetings and reports
Throughout the timeline for the event, there will be several meetings with different committee leaders and event stakeholders regarding the progress of the event preparations. These meetings are for the coordination of activities, briefings, and discussion of progress reports, response to potential changes as well as for contingency planning. The event manager needs to manage all of these important meetings and can use an organogram (organization chart) to help with this process.

An organogram indicates the lines of reporting and responsibility within the event management team. The organogram is useful in deciding the number of meetings that need to be held and the people who should attend the meetings. The Secretariat Committee

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will normally monitor and organize the various meetings and reports that need to be held. If the event is a complex event with many committees and stakeholders, the event manager will need to have a very clear reporting structure and set of meetings that will help in the efficient coordination of the event.

An Excel spreadsheet or online project management software and applications can be used to track the progress of each meeting and the action points that arise from it. These online tools can be designed to enable the event manager to post comments, updates, and feedback that can be shared with all of the event planning team so that all personnel are kept up to date with decisions that have been made.

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23 Manage the Running of an Event

When the event is being staged, the event manager has a very crucial leadership role to undertake and needs to:

- confirm that all the resources, personnel and support are in place and ready
- control change during the event to minimise disruption to participants
- ensure all agreed plans for the event are followed
- ensure that all event personnel and stakeholders are fully briefed on their roles
- keep all those involved in the event informed of relevant developments
- maintain required records during the event
- monitor the running of the event and deal effectively with any problems that arise using the risk management plans
- oversee the work of key event personnel and other stakeholders using effective communication
- provide authorisation for each stage of the event to take place

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Production schedule

To manage the running of the event, a detailed production schedule that provides the exact running order of all the different activities of the event, listed in sequence with the start and finish times of each one has to be designed. The production schedule will also indicate who is responsible for implementing each activity and the place where the activity is taking place.

Figure 21: Sample Production Timeline

No	Date	Activity	Start	End	Person/s Responsible	Place
1	Monday 19-03- 20..	All committees standby – final preparations	07.00	08.00	All	6th floor
2		Participant registration	08.00	08.30	Registration committee	6th floor
3		National anthem and opening ceremony	08.30	09.00	MC	6th floor
4		Keynote speaker 1	09.00	09.45	MC	6th floor
5		Coffee break	09.45	10.15	Catering committee	5th floor
6		Keynote speaker 2	10.15	10.45	MC	6th floor
7		Break-out parallel sessions	11.00	12.00	Conference committee	4th floor
8		Lunch	12.15	13.30	Restaurant	8th floor
9		Break-out parallel sessions	13.45	15.00	Conference committee	4th floor

Contingency planning

If all of the steps that have been explained in the preceding chapters of this book are implemented, the event will meet all of the objectives that have been set for it. Unfortunately, though,

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some events will be affected by problems or challenges that arise during the actual staging of the event. In these circumstances, the event manager has to quickly solve the problem so that the event can continue as originally envisaged. The impact of the problems or challenges can be reduced with foresight and proper planning. Prior to the event, the event manager and team should identify all of the potential problems that could arise at the event and decide how to react to each of these challenges. For example, an unforeseen increase in attendance will affect the seating plan and catering. An overflow of people can also adversely affect the experience of other participants. A technological failure will affect the production of the event. Contingency plans have to be devised for all possible problems that could arise and the event staff have to be trained in how to respond to these problems if they do happen.

Some of the problems that could arise during an event and which require contingency plans include:

Banquet and Catering

- delays in the preparation and serving of the food will cause timing problems for subsequent activities in the event schedule
- food allergies causing participants to become ill
- inappropriate linen, glassware and silverware for the theme of the event
- limited amount of seating for the number of participants

Physical Problems

- adverse weather causing strong winds, flooding or thunder and lightening with the potential to cause harm
- cables not securely fastened creating a health and safety risk through tripping
- collapse of staging resulting in physical injury for event personnel and participants

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- no directional signs affecting the participants' ability to find the venue and delaying the start of the event
- queuing for entry and exit resulting in crowd congestion problems and participant frustration
- sudden increase in the number of participants affecting the room layout or seating arrangements
- traffic congestion resulting in delays for participants arriving at the venue
- venue too hot or too cold affecting the well-being of event personnel and participants

Power

- lack of electrical power causing all equipment to cease working

Safety and Security

- bomb threat resulting in the evacuation of the event venue
- drunk participants becoming aggressive
- fire breaking out in equipment affecting the safety of participants
- lost children causing panic and anxiety with their parents or carers
- terrorist activity resulting in threats and attacks on participants
- theft of valuables

Staging and Production

- digital devices not working causing event production problems
- missing and/or late performers delaying the start of the event
- problems with the audio-visual equipment meaning a temporary halt to the event
- slow internet connection affecting live streaming
- unavailable or inappropriate supplies being delivered affecting the production of the event

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Theme and Decorations

- décorations falling causing physical harm to participants
- risks with hazardous and/or toxic materials affecting the health and safety of participants

To be prepared for some of these problems occurring at the event, the event manager needs to devise a 'plan B', a contingency plan, that includes provision for:

Onsite Facilities

- alternative event spaces that can be used if there is inclement weather
- additional seats and tables
- back-up power supply resources
- portable air-conditioning or heating units
- spare resources that are needed for the event production
- spare technology devices and audio-visual equipment

Before the start of the event, it will be essential that training is provided for all event personnel and event stakeholders in what they have to do if a problem or emergency arises:

- how to deal with and report an emergency
- safety and security procedures to follow and implement
- standard operating procedures for the event

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24 Coordinate the Stewards at an Event

Stewards are people who work at an event either as paid employees or as volunteers. The work of stewards is crucial to the success of the event as many will be deployed in participant facing roles such as ticketing and registration, giving guidance and information to the participants or playing an important role in monitoring the health and safety of the participants. Although stewards assist the event manager temporarily, they should be flexible, diligent, punctual, team players and responsible. They should display a pleasant personality, customer service skills, and be capable of working for long periods at a time. They must be willing to be assigned to different posts within the event venue and need to be willing to learn several tasks. Stewards can be required to assist in critical areas where there are crowds or potential risks. The event manager must have a policy on the recruitment and selection of stewards including opportunities for local residents, senior citizens, students and persons with disabilities.

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Stewards have responsible tasks to undertake and their recruitment needs to be professionally organised. When recruiting stewards, the event manager should request for resumes/CVs and character references as well as arranging for applicants to be interviewed in person.

Before the event starts, each steward has to be issued with a contract of employment that they have to sign. The employment contract specifies the duties, roles, responsibilities and expected behaviour of the steward. To ensure that the stewards fully understand the importance of their contribution to the event, training should be provided for them on the following:

- clearly defined tasks and responsibilities
- crowd control measures
- details of the event
- emergency procedures and evacuation routes
- fire safety procedures
- hours of breaks
- hours of work
- how to report and record an incident
- locker room areas for storage of personal effects
- officers-for-the-day/officers-for-the-activity
- physical areas of work
- prescribed attire
- schedules of meetings and updates
- taking care of their own health and safety
- venue for meetings

The role of stewards, whether as front-line or back-end support staff, must be well-articulated. They will have several opportunities to meet directly with event stakeholders and participants; their demeanour will have an impact on the image and reputation of the event organizing company. They should also be informed about how their work performance will be assessed,

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the standards they have to meet, and what will happen if they are unable to meet these standards.

Managing stewards

As indicated already, stewards are very important employees for all events. However, labour laws in the country where the event is being staged must be considered when employing and deploying stewards. The event manager must assign all stewards to an event supervisor who will monitor, oversee, and supervise the stewards as well as providing guidance to them. A clear line of communication should be in place to support the stewards on duty. The event supervisors should make themselves available whenever the stewards require support when dealing with a difficult situation or when there is a need to make decisions and intervene to avoid any untoward incidents.

Stewards can be assigned a variety of different roles to assist with the management of the event:

- car park attendants
- crowd control duties
- entry and exit procedures
- health, safety and security monitoring
- participant support roles including assisting those with special needs
- providing guidance and information to participants
- traffic control duties

Obligations to stewards

In exchange for their work, stewards must be rewarded for their time and effort. Aside from providing meals, transportation, uniforms and work supplies, the event manager can choose to pay an hourly rate of pay, provide honoraria, give tokens, and/or provide certificates of participation. Stewards can also be rewarded with recognition and special incentives for their

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accomplishments for the day as well as for work done beyond the call of duty.

Special training

The event manager is also obligated to train stewards in cases of emergencies. They should be thoroughly trained to respond to crises without risk to themselves. Aside from these, stewards must have appropriate materials and gadgets, such as two-way radios that can be used to quickly communicate with their event supervisor, to facilitate their work.

The stewards should be trained to intuitively help people with special needs. They should be aware of available ramps, elevators, and other special arrangements to make these participants comfortable. In addition, stewards who are fluent in more than one language and those who can communicate in sign language can be given special jobs that require the use of their linguistic skills.

Volunteers

Most events utilise volunteer staff to help with the organisation and staging of the event. Volunteers are a flexible form of human resource who can be offered short-term contracts to work on a single event. The benefits to the event manager in using volunteers is that they can bring specific skills to the event that might not be available within the event team's paid employees. The volunteers also benefit in that they will be gaining practical work experience that will contribute to their career progression.

Two main types of event volunteers can be recruited: executive volunteers and event volunteers. The executive volunteers are involved in the planning stage of the event while the event volunteers are individuals tasked to assist during the event. Executive volunteers might be used to plan the strategic direction

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of the event, help raise funds, and to provide wisdom and leadership. Event volunteers work on the operational and logistical aspects of events such as ticketing, artist liaison, stewarding and ushering. Large-scale events will require more volunteers than smaller-scale events due to their scale and complexity.

A volunteer agreement should be provided for all volunteers (that they sign) that specifies their duties, roles, responsibilities and expected behaviour. Full training, that covers the same topics as for stewards, should be provided for the volunteers and the volunteers (and stewards) have to sign a form to confirm that they have understood the training they have received.

Concerning incidents that might occur at the event, the event manager should:

- ensure that the stewards and volunteers understand how to assess, respond, and take action which is appropriate to any incidents that might occur at the event
- ensure that they understand how to escalate a serious incident to their immediate supervisor and/or the event manager
- train the stewards and volunteers how to record information on the incidents and the action taken

In addition, the event manager needs to:

- ensure that the supervisors of the stewards and volunteers communicate with them throughout the running of the event to ensure that they fully understand how to carry out their tasks
- ensure there is the required number of stewards and volunteers recruited for the event and that they are deployed to designated points, and that they are carrying out their duties as indicated in the event management plan
- monitor the stewards and volunteers while they are working at the event

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- monitor and maintain the safety and welfare of the stewards and volunteers at all times
- provide the stewards and volunteers with instructions and directions in line with the policies and procedures of the event.

Did you know?

- Volunteers are the heroes for all events big and small. The Olympic Games, the biggest sports event in the world, are only successful because of the thousands of volunteers who work hard to make them a success. Without volunteers, the games cannot happen, the athletes cannot compete, and the spectators will not have a warm welcome to enjoy the whole event. The International Olympics Committee says that the volunteers are the lifeblood of the Olympic Games.

- For the second Olympic Games held in 1952, only 191 volunteers were involved. By the 2012 London Olympic games, there were 70,000 volunteers. For Tokyo 2020, there will be 80,000 volunteers selected from more than 200,000 applicants from around the world. Managing volunteers is a challenging job, and the event manager has to pay careful attention to the recruitment, selection and training of the volunteers to ensure that they perform their roles effectively.

- Many volunteers share their personal blogs that illustrate their unique and memorable experiences from working at an event: "You will be at the backstage of the world stage and be part of an event where others can only view it from their TV screen. You will make friends from around the world. You will get a free (and cool) uniform – only you can have it! You may have a chance to have free tickets. In some contexts, you are in very close proximity to famous musicians or athletes. In your free time, you can explore the local area and culture. In the Paralympic Games, it will open your heart and bring awareness about disabled people. You will respect the differences of culture, race, and religion. And for sure, you will improve your communication skills!"

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Case Study:

Training Volunteers

Most events will recruit volunteers to help with the successful staging of the event. Although the volunteers will be temporary employees, they have to be trained to perform their roles in a professional way that conforms to the policies and procedures of the event organising company. A very important responsibility of the event manager is to provide a structured training program and written information to enable volunteers to perform their duties to the highest possible standards. Each event manager has to decide on the content of the volunteer training program and the content of the written documents that are provided for the volunteers. Many event managers will include a Volunteer Code of Conduct in the training materials that are used. An example of such a code is provided here.

Volunteer Code of Conduct

This Code of Conduct explains how all event volunteers are required to conduct themselves before, during and after the event. The purpose of this code is to enable all event staff to work in a safe, secure and harmonious environment where dignity and respect are shown to all. Failure to follow the guidelines in this code could result in the termination of the contract of the volunteer.

1 **Fairness, Dignity, and Respect**

- The event company implements an equal opportunities policy through which nobody should be discriminated against because of their race, gender, religious belief, sexual orientation, disability, education or any other characteristic.
- All volunteers will show politeness, dignity and respect to

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all stakeholders of the event and harassment or bullying of others will not be tolerated.
- If a volunteer is subjected to any form of discrimination, bullying or harassment, they should immediately inform their line manager.

2 Professionalism
- All volunteers should act professionally before, during and after the event. They are required to carry out their duties in accordance with the policies and procedures for the task or role they are performing.
- All volunteers should calmly perform their duties and cooperate fully in a courteous way with the other event personnel with whom they are working.
- All volunteers should report for work at the times specified in their job rota schedule wearing the clothing and footwear that is required for the task they are performing. If a volunteer is unable to attend for work, they have to notify their line manager immediately.
- The consumption of alcohol or illegal drugs or substances before and during the event is strictly prohibited.

3 Support
- Any volunteer who requires additional information or support to carry out their tasks to the expected professional standard should ask their line manager for further guidance or training – assistance will be provided.
- Any volunteer who feels unwell whilst working should seek first aid treatment from the medical staff.

4 Working with Others
- Listen very carefully to all instructions that are given to you by your line manager and co-workers and follow these instructions precisely.
- Share your ideas for undertaking the task you are performing with your line manager and co-workers – this

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is considered to be good practice.

- Receive all feedback you are given by your line manager and co-workers positively, don't feel disappointed or over-react if the feedback you receive is not to your liking.
- If you have any grievances with your line manager or co-workers, then try and resolve these immediately with the people involved and failing this notify the event manager of your grievance.

5 **Confidentiality**

- Do not share or make copies of any event information you are given unless instructed to do so by your line manager – this includes emails, event documents and other information or images of a confidential nature.

6 **Image and Social Media Communications**

- Always promote a positive image of the event (before, during and after the event) through all your contacts and networks in the spoken and written word, including social media posts.

7 **Health, Safety and Security**

- Follow all the health, safety and security policies and procedures that are in place for the event and implement all the health, safety and security instructions that you will receive before and during the event.
- Remember that health, safety and security are the responsibility of all event employees. If you notice any breaches of the health, safety and security procedures, you are to notify immediately your line manager or another supervisor or the event manager.

EVIDENCE REQUIRED FOR THE APIEM CERTIFIED EVENT MANAGER QUALIFICATION

For readers who want to study for the APIEM Certified Event Manager Qualification, you are to select an event that you have

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organised in the previous 12 months or are going to organise in the next 12 months and provide a portfolio of evidence that will contain:

1) The event action plan and timeline.
2) The production timeline for the event.
3) The number of stewards and volunteers required for the event and their roles.
4) The Event Manual.

You will also write a reflective report that explains:

1) The process you followed to create the set-up and break-down timeline and the critical points/phases in the set-up and break-down of the event.
2) The process you followed to create the event action plan and timeline.
3) The process you followed to create the production timeline.
4) The reasons why you have decided to use the number of stewards that you have selected for the event.
5) The challenges you faced in preparing and writing the Event Manual.

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chapter 6
managing health, safety, security and emergencies at the event

After reading this chapter, you will be able to:

- research and write a health and safety risk assessment for an event
- research and write a security risk assessment for an event
- understand how to respond to emergencies at an event

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25 Making Health, Safety and Security a Priority

All events that are organised, no matter the type of event or its location or venue, have to be organised in such a way that everybody connected with the event enjoys it safely and leaves it healthily. Managing the health, safety and security of an event is the ultimate responsibility of the event manager. Safety is the primary responsibility of the event manager – this is one of the key legal responsibilities of the event manager.

There are many important reasons why safety is the primary responsibility of the event manager. Legally, the event manager has a 'duty of care' to take responsibility for all aspects of the health, safety and security of the event and all participants in that event. Many countries have laws that formally stipulate the legal responsibilities of the event manager in this respect.

Another important reason for organising safe events is that of finance. If an event has a health, safety or security problem and breaches legislation, it is likely that there will be a financial penalty to be paid by the event manager as compensation to people who

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have been adversely affected by attending the event or as a fine imposed by a court of law following a breach of legislation. The reputation of the event manager will be severely diminished if a court case is pursued as a result of a health, safety or security infringement.

The final reason why health, safety and security is a priority for the event manager is that everybody associated with the event – employees, contractors, suppliers and participants – all want to have a great event experience. If there is a health, safety or security problem, the experience of all stakeholders will be negatively affected and, as a result, the event will not be seen as a success. This will inevitably affect attendance at future events that the event manager wishes to organise.

Managing health, safety and security at an event is an intellectually challenging task and requires considerable training for the person who takes responsibility for the event's health, safety and security policies and procedures. The event manager needs to fully understand not only their own health, safety and security responsibilities but also how to ensure that all stakeholders involved with the event work fully within the health, safety and security requirements that are expected of them.

The event manager needs to fully understand and comply with all the relevant health, safety and security legislation that applies to the country within which the event is being organised. Breaches of this legislation could result in the event manager being given a custodial sentence or paying a fine and facing considerable negative publicity.

The following phrase should always be kept in mind by the event manager: **by law, you must do everything reasonably practicable to ensure the safety of your event and all the**

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people who are involved with it. If a health, safety or security problem occurs, the event manager cannot claim ignorance of the relevant legislation that had to be complied with. The event manager also cannot pass the responsibility for the health, safety or security problem occurring to another employee or someone else – the event manager is accountable in a court of law for any accidents that occur – no matter their cause.

Did you know?

- As an event manager, it is important to understand the historical data of natural disasters in the locality where your event is taking place. Japan, the Philippines, and Indonesia have frequent earthquakes which can be very destructive and prevent an event from taking place. These three countries are located on the Pacific Ring of Fire – a 40,000 km horseshoe shape with 452 active volcanoes, and tectonic plate movements.

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26 Carry Out an Initial On-Site Health, Safety and Security Induction Visit

All events have potential health, safety and security challenges that can pose risks which might result in injuries to any of the stakeholders involved with the event: event company employees, contractors, suppliers and participants.

Health, safety and security challenges occur because of the characteristics of the event. The event might involve large crowds of people moving between locations. The people attending the event will probably be in an unfamiliar venue which they may well be visiting for the first time and so will be unaware of the layout of the venue and the evacuation routes that have to be followed in an emergency. Some events require the employment of large numbers of temporary, freelance employees who may not themselves be trained in working to best practices of health, safety or security procedures at an event. Besides, many other uncontrollable factors can severely affect an event when it is operating: inclement weather or terrorist attacks.

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The above challenges are serious and should not be ignored or underestimated by the event manager. The first thing an event manager should do when deciding on the venue to use for staging an event is to carry out an initial on-site health, safety and security induction visit to carefully review and see if there are any hazards or operational factors at the venue that might make it an unsuitable venue in which to stage the event.

The initial on-site health, safety and security induction visit is essential. The event manager during this visit should:

- review the accident statistics of the venue. It is crucial to understand what accidents have previously occurred at the venue, their frequency and severity. From this information, the event manager has to discover what has taken place at the venue since the accidents occurred to prevent them from happening again in the future
- understand the government regulations for using the venue. Before contracting to use a venue, the event manager needs to fully understand the health, safety and security legislation that has to be complied with when using that particular venue. This is a very important part of the on-site health, safety and security induction visit as there might be legislation to be complied with that might make use of that venue impossible for the planned event – for example, the use of special effects such as pyrotechnics or limitations on noise or the offering and consumption of alcohol
- review the floor plan or footprint of the event. The venue has to be suitable for the type of event that is being organised. This includes the capacity of the venue in relation to the number of participants to be attracted; the seating plan for the event; traffic management issues such as traffic flows and car parking; emergency access and egress; facilities for storing event materials; the access space for contractors and suppliers, plus many more issues. If the event manager decides that the

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potential venue will pose health, safety or security problems to any of the aforementioned venue characteristics, then an alternative venue should be used

Undertaking an initial on-site health, safety and security induction visit is essential for all events that are organised. The person who conducts this visit should be a competent person who is fully trained and experienced in conducting such visits from a health, safety and security perspective. As part of the training and experience of the competent person, they should be knowledgeable about the legal aspects of using the specific venue as well as being able to identify potential hazards that might result in accidents or security breaches occurring at the venue.

The ultimate aim of conducting the initial on-site health, safety and security induction visit is for the competent person to be able to decide on whether any of the hazards that might be present at the venue are so severe that no control measures can be put in place to make them manageable.

All events that are organised will involve risks of one form or another – it is a feature of the events industry. In choosing the venue to be used, the event manager should be assured that the control measures that are implemented will reduce the risk to a tolerable level.

If the event manager can provide evidence to demonstrate that the risks in staging the event have been reduced to a tolerable level, then compliance with legislation will normally have been met (depending on the law in place in a specific country). One critical component of this evidence is the risk assessment strategy for the event.

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27 Undertake a Risk Assessment

Risk assessments are required to enable the event manager to identify the potential hazards and risks that may be encountered when staging an event. Although many risks are self-apparent, such as falling from heights, many others are not.

The risk assessment process can be used to identify and evaluate the risks that might occur at all stages of organising an event – the pre-event stage, implementing the event, and the post-event break down stage. Once potential risks have been identified, the next step in the risk assessment process is to design and implement control measures to either eliminate or control the effects of the hazards.

For every risk assessment that is produced, all those people who are working on the event must be informed on the content of the risk assessment and are trained in implementing the control measures that relate to the area of work that they are engaged in.

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In some countries, it is a legal obligation for the event manager to arrange for a risk assessment to be written for every event that takes place. There is no choice, the risk assessment is required. The risk assessment strategy document is an essential part of managing the event so that the event runs without any health or safety problems occurring. As such, the risk assessment should be produced at the initial planning stage of the event, as the content of the risk assessment might have implications for the design of the event itself. This is a very important but frequently neglected point – do not leave the writing of the risk assessment until the event itself has been planned, write and disseminate the risk assessment strategy document before the detailed planning for the event commences.

Whilst the event manager is ultimately responsible for ensuring that the risk assessment strategy is comprehensive and is an accurate reflection of the potential risks that could occur with relevant control measures in place, the event manager could delegate the task of preparing the risk assessment to a competent person. This is someone who is trained and experienced in health and safety and in conducting risk assessments. For very large events, the event will likely employ a health and safety manager as a competent person to oversee all aspects of health and safety at the event. For small scale events, it could well be the event manager who completes the risk assessment strategy document.

The risk assessment process

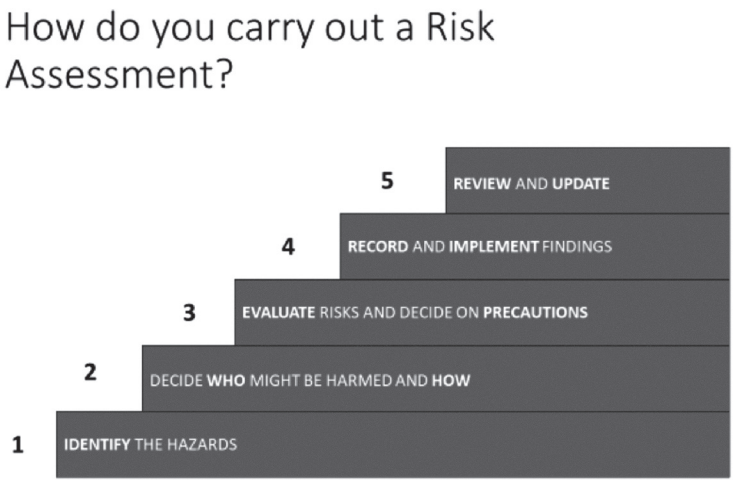
The commonly used international terms in conducting a risk assessment are:

Hazard: something with the potential to cause harm
Likelihood: the probability of a hazard occurring
Severity: a measure of the harm caused by the hazard
Risk: a combined assessment of the likelihood and severity of a hazard

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Control Measure: a means of eliminating or controlling the impact of the risk to a tolerable level.

Figure 22: Carrying out a Risk Assessment



The steps to be taken during the risk assessment process are summarised below:

- review the task and activities which are to be carried out. These should include all the tasks and activities that might result in a health and safety hazard occurring. There are many potential tasks and activities to review, for example, setting up the rigging for a music event; providing a food and beverage service; and erecting exhibition booths. The tasks and activities should be allocated to pre-event, set up; implementing the event; and post-event, break down
- identify the hazards that are likely to occur associated with each task. For each task and activity that has been identified, consider the hazards associated with each task. At this stage,

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the event manager needs to have a good understanding of each task that could result in harm. For example, riggers working at a height when erecting the rigging; food hygiene problems arising from the preparation of food; and electrical malfunctions when installing lighting for an exhibition booth. The person conducting the risk assessment has to ask some very difficult questions starting with 'what if?' What will be the potential harm if this occurs? If the event manager can demonstrate that all significant hazards have been considered, then he or she has done everything reasonably practical in developing the risk assessment strategy. A significant hazard should not be ignored because the event manager thinks it might not occur. If it is ignored, the event manager could be prosecuted for negligence and, if found guilty, could face a severe punishment.

The list of potential hazards also has to take into account the type of venue being used: indoor or outdoor; purpose-built event venue or a temporary structure.

Examples of some hazard categories include:
  - behavioural – crowds, violence, crime and drugs
  - chemical – corrosive, toxic, irritant, harmful materials
  - environmental – heat, cold, wind, snow, pollution
  - fire and explosion – pyrotechnics, special effects
  - health – fatigue, dehydration, musculoskeletal injury, psychological stress
  - physical – noise, vibration, lasers and electrical hazards
  - positional – work at height, position near water, the layout of the site, vehicles, use of temporary structures
- the event manager should also ask the venue owner, event staff and the event contractors what they think potential hazards might be – they are also valuable contributors to the risk assessment process

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- the duration of the event should be considered – there will probably be different hazards at different times of the day or night and with the different stages of the event's preparation
- split the potential hazards into different categories, for example – back-stage, on-stage, audience, marquee, entrance and exit
- when hazards are identified, the next step is to eliminate them if they are extremely severe or mitigate them if they are less severe. This can be achieved by modifying or redefining the tasks – thinking of an alternative, less harmful way of completing the task. At this stage, the event manager will probably need to consult with other event staff who might be experts at particular aspects of the event management process, for example, qualified technicians. The aim at this stage is to eliminate the identified hazards, and this consultation process is an important part of this
- where the hazards cannot be eliminated, the event manager should assess the likelihood and severity of the hazards occurring to give a risk score or risk rating. The method for doing this is indicated in the example below. This approach to calculating the 'risk score' is internationally recognised, and it does require the event manager to be fully objective in undertaking the calculation. Do not try and underestimate the risk of the hazard occurring just to reduce the ease of completing the risk assessment process
- next, the event manager should step back from the risk assessment process for a short time and then revisit everything that has been considered so far to make sure that nothing serious has been missed from the risk assessment
- then, identify the people affected by the hazards and, wherever possible, restrict access to those persons carrying out the task, so that others are not affected. The people that need to be identified as being at potential harm will depend at which stage of the event the risk assessment is for (pre-event, during the event, or post-event). The people that should normally be

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included in the risk assessment process are: event organisers, event suppliers, event contractors, event manager, event staff and volunteers, artists and performers, stewards, members of the public, children, members of the emergency services, and people just passing by the venue and not actually attending the event

- finally, develop a safe system of work and ensure the appropriate control measures (precautions) are identified. The control measures (precautions) to reduce the risks that have been identified of occurring can now be specified. The control measures are critical as these will contribute significantly to no harm affecting any person involved with the event. The control measures that are specified have to be such that they can be implemented, are realistic and feasible

Once each of the above steps has been completed, the event manager can write the risk assessment document, which includes the outputs from the risk assessment process. The risk assessment document specifies the strategy that is going to be implemented for the event to ensure it operates in a controlled health and safety environment. There are many different ways of writing and presenting the risk assessment document. The example given below is just one example, but one that is relatively straightforward to complete and which includes all of the essential information for managing the event safely. The risk assessment document, if it has been completed thoroughly and rigorously, can be used as evidence by the event manager to show that all 'reasonable measures' were taken to prevent harm occurring at the event. It is a document that is recognised as evidence in a United Kingdom Court of Law, but it could be dismissed as invalid evidence if the risk assessment document has not been completed thoroughly.

When the risk assessment document has been written, the event manager should ensure that information about the hazards, risks and control measures are communicated to those undertaking

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the work and that a record is kept of all briefing sessions held with staff. All people involved with the set-up, implementation, or break-down of the event should be given the relevant part of the risk assessment document that relates to their area of work, and they need to be instructed in the content of the risk assessment strategy. Each person who receives training on the risk assessment document should sign a form to confirm that they have been trained and by whom.

During the event, it is the responsibility of the event manager to ensure a safe system of work is implemented in accordance with the risk assessment strategy and all control measures are followed precisely. This responsibility can be delegated to another member of the event management team, but that person has to fully understand the importance of the work they are required to undertake. Each team of people working at the event has to be adequately supervised to enforce and monitor the effectiveness of the control measures. If someone within a team is not working correctly, they have to be informed of this and be required to change their working practices.

Finally, once the event has finished, the event manager should review the risk assessment strategy and the risk assessment document to assess if it was fully appropriate for the event that has just taken place – what went right and what could be done differently? Were the control measures adequate? If the next event is similar to the previous one, the risk assessment strategy and risk assessment document can be modified and updated to reflect the circumstances of the new event. However, if the next event is totally different, all of the steps for developing the risk assessment strategy and document have to be followed again.

Figure 23 illustrates the inter-relationship between the **likelihood** and **severity** of potential harm and shows how a score can be

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allocated to both the likelihood and severity factor to reach an assessment of the overall risk that the activity poses for the event.

Figure 23: The Inter-Relationship Between the Likelihood and Severity of Harm Occurring

LIKELIHOOD			SEVERITY		
Title	Description	Score	Title	Description	Score
Probable	Likely to occur several times in the relevant period	3	Catastrophic	Death or total systems loss	5
			Critical	"Major" injury or illness Major damage Major environmental impact	4
Occasional	Likely to occur at least once in the relevant period	2	Serious	Loss of time/injury Illness or damage Environmental impact	3
			Marginal	First Aid Accident Routine maintenance repair	2
Remote	Unlikely to occur in the relevant period	1	Negligible	Very minor Little consequence	1

From Figure 23, the risk can be assessed. Figure 24 can then be used to determine the risk score/rating. The risk score/rating is calculated by:

RISK SCORE/RATING = LIKELIHOOD SCORE X SEVERITY SCORE

For example:
RISK SCORE/RATING = 2 X 3 = 6

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Figure 24: Calculating the Risk Score/Rating

	Catastrophic	Critical	Serious	Marginal	Negligible
Probable	15	12	9	6	3
Occasional	10	8	6	4	2
Remote	5	4	3	2	1
Score	Actions (All risks must be eliminated or reduced as far as is reasonably practicable)				
10+	Very High Risk - Not acceptable. Apply mitigation to eliminate or to further reduce the risk.				
5-9	High Risk - Apply mitigation to eliminate or reduce the risk. If it remains a high risk, develop robust control measures to limit and manage the effects of any hazards.				
1-4	Low Risk - May be accepted if all reasonably practicable control measures are in place. However, if more can be done to reduce or eliminate the risk, then it should be done.				

The 'risk calculation' process illustrated in Figure 24 lies at the heart of creating a risk assessment strategy for an event. Figure 25 shows how a risk assessment document can be produced for identifying the risks for different tasks/activities using the risk calculation process. In the example below, the hazards associated with certain tasks/activities of the event have been identified, then the likelihood and severity scores have been applied to result in an overall risk score being formulated.

The task/activities of the event that are used in the table below are:

- access and egress
- lost children and the protection of children from harm
- emergency evacuation of the event

If the risk score is above '10', then the risk is unacceptable and it should be eliminated in order for the event to occur. If the risk score is between '5 and 9', the risk should be eliminated or reduced but, if this cannot be achieved, robust control measures have to be put in place to manage the effects of the hazards. A risk

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score in the range '1 to 4' is acceptable if all reasonably practicable control measures are in place.

As can be seen from Figure 25, it is also important to include in the risk assessment document the people who will be affected by the hazard and very importantly the control measures that the event manager has put in place to eliminate or reduce the impact of the hazard from occurring.

Figure 25: Example of Risk Assessment Documents

Task/Activity:	**Access and Egress**	Risk Assess. No.:	1
		Date Prepared:	28 August 20..

HAZARDS		Likelihood			Severity					Risk Score
Ref.	Key hazards associated with the above task/activity	Probable	Occasional	Remote	Catastrophic	Critical	Serious	Marginal	Negligible	Likelihood x Severity
	Score:	3	2	1	5	4	3	2	1	
1	Slips, trips and falls from trailing electrical leads		X					X		4
2	Accidents/Injuries due to traffic congestion on site		X					X		4
3	Accidents and injuries due to long entry queues to event site		X					X		4
4										

Risk Assessment Scores:	10+ Very High Risk	5-9 High Risk	1-4 Low Risk

PERSONS AFFECTED					
Event Organisers	X	Members of Public	X	Site Visitors	X
Event Officials	X	Young Persons	X	Others	

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CONTROL MEASURES	
Information & Physical Controls	Managerial & Procedural Controls
• All event officials to be aware of their duties before the commencement of the event • Ensure clear traffic signage to alleviate any congestion • Police/event officials to direct traffic to car parks • Event officials to ensure pedestrians remain on the pathways and not on the road • Ensure adequate entry points to the site are available • Ensure the main lighting system is adequate for the whole area	• Event organisers to ensure clear levels of communication between all official parties • Event organisers to ensure adequate traffic and crowd information signage is available before the event • Event organisers to monitor crowd control and act upon any delay in accessing the site • Event organisers to ensure all key personnel are in radio contact with each other and the central control point • Ensure the findings of this risk assessment are made aware to all event officials
Final Risk Assessment Scoring with Adhered Controls	**Low to Medium**

Task/Activity:	**Lost Children & Protection of Children from Harm**	Risk Assess. No.:	**2**
		Date Prepared:	28 August 20..

HAZARDS		Likelihood			Severity					Risk Score
Ref.	Key hazards associated with the above task/activity	Probable	Occasional	Remote	Catastrophic	Critical	Serious	Marginal	Negligible	Likelihood x Severity
	Score:	3	2	1	5	4	3	2	1	
1	Children losing their guardians		X					X		4
2										

Risk Assessment Scores:	10+ Very High Risk	5-9 High Risk	1-4 Low Risk

PERSONS AFFECTED					
Event Organisers		Members of Public		Site Visitors	X
Event Officials		Young Persons	X	Others	

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CONTROL MEASURES	
Information & Physical Controls	Managerial & Procedural Controls
• Lost children will be directed to Police Control Point via announcement over the public address system • Any child found without a responsible adult will be taken to the lost child area (Police Control Point) and announced over PAS (not giving the child's name)	• Event Organisers to remain in contact with Police and Group Four Security at all times • All staff dealing with children to be CRB checked before the event • Ensure the findings of this risk assessment are made aware to all event officials
Final Risk Assessment Scoring with Adhered Controls	**Low Risk**

Task/Activity:	**Emergency Evacuation of the Event**	Risk Assess. No.:	**3**
		Date Prepared:	28 August 20.. 13/08/2019

HAZARDS		Likelihood			Severity					Risk Score
Ref.	Key hazards associated with the above task/activity	Probable	Occasional	Remote	Catastrophic	Critical	Serious	Marginal	Negligible	Likelihood x Severity
	Score:	3	2	1	5	4	3	2	1	
1	Injuries caused by panic		X				X			6
2										
3										

Risk Assessment Scores:	10+ Very High Risk	5-9 High Risk	1-4 Low Risk

PERSONS AFFECTED					
Event Organisers	X	Members of Public	X	Site Visitors	X
Event Officials	X	Young Persons	X	Others	

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CONTROL MEASURES	
• In the event of the event having to be evacuated for any reason, the following guidelines should be followed: – Event officials should be made aware of the situation before the general public to ensure they can assist in the evacuation of the area – The music should be stopped before any announcement – Main lights should be turned on – Announcement should be made over the public address system stressing the need not to panic – Public should be informed which exit they should leave by and where they should go (staff to Air Balloon Public House) – Any lost or separated children will also be taken to the Public House to be reunited with their families • Ensure the findings of this risk assessment are made aware to all event official	
Final Risk Assessment Scoring with Adhered Controls	**High Risk**

Once the risk assessment has been completed by the competent person or the event manager, it should be shared with key senior event stakeholders to receive their comments on its content and to allow the risk strategy document to be updated and amended in light of the feedback received.

It will be essential to discuss the risk assessment strategy document with the owner of the venue so that any control measures that need to be put in place can be implemented. Written confirmation should be received from the venue owner that they agree with the risk assessment strategy document and that they can implement the control measures.

The event manager should also remember that when developing the risk assessment strategy:

- many events are multi-agency activities, and all organisations have to produce their own risk assessment strategy for the work that they are doing on the event
- where an event has multiple performances of a different

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kind, each performance will pose its own hazards
- it is essential to try and identify the uncontrollable factors that might result in a hazard occurring at the event: weather, natural disasters, changes in visibility etc

Ensure that other contractors and suppliers to the event undertake their own risk assessments

Depending on the size and nature of the event, the contractors working on the site (riggers, lighting and sound technicians) and suppliers (exhibition booth constructors, power supply companies, security agencies) may also be required to complete risk assessments for the work that they are undertaking on behalf of the event manager.

It is the responsibility of the event manager to ensure that these additional risk assessment documents have been completed thoroughly and that the control measures are being implemented correctly.

A health and safety declaration form

With some events, such as an exhibition, a full risk assessment strategy document is not always a requirement for all exhibitors to complete and submit to the event manager. If the exhibitor is not using any hazardous equipment and is unlikely to cause harm to the exhibitor's staff or visitors to the stand, a health and safety declaration form can be submitted to the event manager by the exhibitor. This form states that the exhibitor is not performing any activities on the exhibition stand that are likely to cause harm. The form is signed and dated by the exhibitor.

Health and safety communications

Another aspect of the event manager's role to ensure the health and safety of the event is communicating essential health and safety information to all participants of the event. One way of

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doing this is by the publication in hard copy and through online communications of a safety bulletin. The length and content of the safety bulletin will be determined by the size and nature of the event, but it should be comprehensive informing the reader on how health and safety matters are being handled at the event and what they should do in case of an emergency. An outdoor music festival safety bulletin will need to inform its stakeholders about:

- access to the site, to include a site map
- emergency evacuation procedures
- fire safety instructions and what to do if a fire occurs
- general safety information: the requirement to attend staff briefing sessions during the festival; hours of working; any specific hazards on the site of the festival; what to do if something suspicious is seen; where the first aid posts are etc.
- how to carry heavy items
- site security
- the requirement to wear personal protective equipment: hard hats; high visibility jackets; safety boots/shoes etc
- what to do if banned drugs are seen

The health and safety bulletin should be formally communicated to the staff who are working at the event through induction training programmes as well as being circulated online through email distribution lists.

Keep all the risk assessment strategy documents in a file

It will be important for the event manager to retain all the documents that have contributed to the creation of the risk assessment strategy in a file. This is essential as the file can be used as evidence if a problem arises to demonstrate that the event manager has acted diligently in preparing the risk assessment strategy and has taken all reasonable steps to reduce the possibility of risks occurring. Included in the file should be:

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- a record of any accidents that occurred at the event
- a record of who has been trained on implementing the event risk assessment strategy
- health and safety declaration forms
- notes of all pre-event meetings that took place
- other information and documentation that is relevant for the health and safety of the event
- risk assessment strategy documents for contractors and suppliers to the event
- safety information notices that were used at the event (bulletins, flyers and posters)
- sample floor plan or site layout and the emergency evacuation routes
- the event risk assessment strategy document
- the post-event health and safety report – what went right and what could be improved
- the venue/site owner's risk assessment strategy documents

Summary of the risk assessment process

Undertaking a suitable and sufficient risk assessment is a key responsibility of the event manager. The event manager has to identify all significant risks that might occur before, during, and after the event and put in place control measures to reduce the likelihood of the risks occurring.

Managing health and safety at events is essential and cannot be ignored. To ensure that effective health and safety measures are in place for the event, the person managing the health and safety strategy has to be a 'competent person'. This inevitably will mean that they have to undertake special training in devising an appropriate health and safety strategy for the event that is being organised.

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28 Produce a Method Statement

A method statement is a description of how a task is to be completed. Method statements are written to inform someone how to complete a task to a competent level of performance and a specific standard. They are crucial for training someone who has not performed the task previously and contribute to reducing the risks involved in undertaking the task and can prevent harm from occurring.

Method statements can be written either as a description of how to perform the task in sentence format as a narrative or as a step-by-step guide which details and specifies each step to follow in sequence – (1), (2), (3), (4) etc.

Method statements should be written into the health and safety plan for the event, especially if a non-routine or complex task is being undertaken. The method statement should include the control measures that need to be put in place to reduce the likelihood of harm occurring to the people involved with the task. For example, where the event necessitates the building of complex

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structures such as steelwork erection where lifting and rigging are involved, a specific method statement should be written and used by all contractors to inform them of the correct health and safety procedures to be followed. The aim is to ensure that no harm occurs whilst erecting stage of the complex structure.

At most exhibition venues, for example, exhibitors must submit their method statement to the event manager at the same time as their stand design and risk assessment, well in advance of the exhibition. The method statement must be compiled by a competent person, and proof of this must be submitted to the event manager.

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29 Train Event Personnel on Health, Safety and Security

Good staff training is critical for providing a safe working environment for all people associated with the event. The level of training that each person needs will be based on their job and position within the event organising company. A full-time employee who has been employed with the event organising company for some time will need less training than a temporary worker who is employed on a casual contract. The casual employee will need detailed training on the specific detail of the tasks that they will be undertaking at the event.

The event manager is ultimately responsible for ensuring that all of the people working at the event are trained in the health and safety policies that have been designed and that they implement the control measures as specified in the risk assessment document. A key document in the training programme is the risk assessment document, and all personnel should be fully knowledgeable about the sections of the document that apply to their area of work. Following the training and receipt of the risk strategy document, all personnel should sign a form to confirm that they

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have received and understood the risk assessment strategy for the event.

Normally, the trainer will be the person who has control of the hazard, and this person should provide the information and instruction needed concerning the hazard. The information provided by the trainer must be relevant – what the employee needs to know. The communication method used by the trainer needs to be in such a format that the employee understands precisely how to perform the relevant tasks to comply with the health and safety strategy.

A good practice that should be embedded by the event organising company is that all employees should be trained in health and safety as soon as they are recruited. Then refresher training should be organised when new tasks need to be performed, or a new type of event is organised, or the event takes place in a new venue or setting. All employees of the event organising company must understand that 'safety is the responsibility of everyone' – nobody is exempt.

During each stage of the event (set-up, running, and break-down), the event manager has to ensure that key personnel monitor the working behaviour of the event employees to ensure that they are working to the agreed health and safety strategy. This is part of the event manager's duty of care – any health and safety problem that is identified during the running of the event has to be recorded, and action needs to be taken promptly to reduce the risk that might arise from the problem.

Failure to respond promptly and appropriately could result in a more serious emergency occurring – so all event staff have to be vigilant at all times when they are working at the event, and they have to be trained to inform promptly their supervisor if a breach of the health and safety strategy occurs.

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Take action when health and safety procedures are not being implemented

The event manager has the authority to take whatever action is needed if a health and safety problem is identified during the event – this could range from closing down the entire event in extreme situations where the event venue or site is needed to be evacuated to temporarily restricting access to a specific area of the site if a risk has been identified that has to be controlled.

Clear and precise communication is essential when taking action to address a health and safety problem. Normally, verbal communication will be used to inform the people who will be affected by the problem. The message that is communicated has to be succinct and very clear so that immediate action can be taken by the people affected.

Following a health and safety infringement, a written report has to be produced that details exactly what the problem was, who was involved, how it occurred, and what action was taken to address it. The written report should be carefully reviewed by the event manager so that lessons can be learned from the incident. The written report may also be required as evidence if the incident was so severe that litigation is taken out against the event manager for negligence in running the event.

Report accidents

All accidents that occur at the event need to be formally recorded and reported to the event manager. The accident report form needs to include the name of the person who was involved in the accident, what the accident was, how it occurred, details of any injuries that were received, the first aid that is given to the injured person, the name of the person administering the first aid, and the name and job title of the person completing the accident report form.

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The event manager has to be notified of the accident as soon as possible after it has occurred and given the nature of the accident has to inform whoever by law has to be notified – for example, the police, local government health and safety officers, and or the fire service.

Review the health and safety measures after the event to make improvements

When the event has finished, the next task that the event manager has to undertake is to review the event from a health and safety perspective. If the event was a large event spread over several sites, then reports will be required from a number of event personnel who will have been supervising different areas or different tasks within the event.

This review process is very important as the lessons learned can be carried forward into the health and safety strategy for future events. This continual learning process will enable future events to be organised more safely. Organising safe events is essential in an industry where many factors can adversely affect the health and safety of the people who work at the event and the people who attend the event for enjoyment.

Embedding a culture in the event organising company that 'safety is everyone's responsibility' will undoubtedly contribute to the events that the event manager organises being implemented safely and healthily.

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30 Managing Security at an Event

Unfortunately, large gatherings of people pose security problems. It is another responsibility and challenge of the event manager, to safeguard all people attending the event and to protect them from crime, attack or danger. Therefore, understanding the event's potential security challenges is an essential responsibility of the event manager. The key elements of an event security strategy are the:

- security risk assessment
- security plan
- security policies and procedures

Security risk assessment

The pre-event health, safety and security induction visit should be used to produce a security risk assessment for the event – the potential security hazards that could arise, the likelihood of them occurring, their severity, and security control measures that should be implemented to reduce the likelihood of a breach of security occurring. Figure 26 provides an example of a security risk assessment document.

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Figure 26: An Example of a Security Risk Assessment Document

Task/Activity:	**Event Security**	Risk Assess. No.:	**4**
		Date Prepared:	28 August 20..

HAZARDS		Likelihood			Severity					Risk Score
Ref.	Key hazards associated with the above task/activity	Probable	Occasional	Remote	Catastrophic	Critical	Serious	Marginal	Negligible	Likelihood x Severity
	Score:	3	2	1	5	4	3	2	1	
1	Injury during the theft of monies to event personnel			X			X			3
2										

Risk Assessment Scores:	10+ Very High Risk	5-9 High Risk	1-4 Low Risk

PERSONS AFFECTED					
Event Organisers	X	Members of Public		Site Visitors	
Event Officials	X	Young Persons		Others	

CONTROL MEASURES	
Information & Physical Controls	Managerial & Procedural Controls
• The site to be fenced with a stringent "ticket only" policy • Ensure all takings from the event are regularly moved from the entry points and secured • Entry points to be in contact with main control point during the active part of the event	• Event Manager to remain in contact with Police and Group Four at all times • Ensure the findings of this risk assessment are made aware to all event officials

Final Risk Assessment Scoring with Adhered Controls	**Low Risk**

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On the health, safety and security induction visit, the event manager should consider the following to produce the security risk assessment:

- access to the site of the event – how easy will it be to control access to the event and to monitor the people who are attending, both from the absolute number perspective and from a security-vetting perspective?
- the number of participants at the event – an event that will attract 100 people will require fewer security measures than an event that will attract 10,000 people
- the type of event – a political event that might include senior politicians will require very stringent security measures compared to a family celebration such as a wedding
- the value of the equipment and other goods at the event – what is the nature of the event in terms of the materials that will be stored – what is their monetary value and what special security measures might these materials require?
- location of the event – large events that take place outdoors will pose greater security challenges than events that take place in a more controlled environment such as a convention centre

Did you know?

Risk management is related to the culture of the country where the event is being staged. Some countries might have strict regulations about health, safety and security, but other countries might not. In some countries, specifically in remote rural areas, rigging or scaffolding that is made from bamboos is considered to be safe enough by the event manager. Using sandals instead of closed safety shoes, a baseball cap instead of a hard safety helmet and not using a high visibility vest or uniform when setting-up and breaking-down an event are sometimes allowed. Countries with strict health and safety regulations for the event industry tend to be the developed nations where there are stringent health and safety laws that have to be followed by all industries, not just the events/MICE industry.

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- the attendees – high profile VIPs, celebrities or dignitaries who attend or perform at the event will increase the need for stringent security measures to be arranged for the event

The security risk assessment should be conducted in the same way as all the other risk assessments, and it should be completed at the early planning stage of the event. In completing the security risk assessment plan, the event manager will need to consult with other key event stakeholders to ensure that all security hazards have been identified and that the security control measures can be implemented.

Security plan

Once a risk assessment of the security of the event has been undertaken, the event manager must liaise with security experts to ensure that an appropriate and robust security plan is devised and implemented. In developing the security plan, the event manager at a very basic level will need to work with the local police force. Then, as the threat of a potential security breach increases, the event manager, through the police force, will need to involve appropriate government agencies and those security organisations that are responsible for protecting high profile VIPs, celebrities, politicians and dignitaries.

The security plan should be produced at the same time as all the detailed planning of the event takes place – many months before the event opens to members of the public. In producing the plan, many different organisations need to be involved in its design: the police force, fire service, ambulance service, the venue owner, the security contractor and senior event management personnel. As the security risks posed by the event increase, then the army and other specialist security organisations may also be involved in the design and content of the security plan.

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The security plan for each event that is organised will be different, but control measures that could be implemented include:

- a colour coded, photo-id, badging system (or an electronic system) to identify legitimate participants at the event
- armed and licensed security personnel to protect high-value items
- be-spoke on-site communications technology
- controlling the times at which access points to the event venue will be open and closed both for event suppliers and event participants
- crowd management procedures for ingress to and egress from the event site and crowd circulation during the event
- dogs trained to locate drugs and other illegal substances
- drones for aerial surveillance of the event
- facial recognition technology
- machines and technology to be used for the identification of illegal drugs
- metal detectors and X-ray machines
- personal protection officers for VIPs, celebrities and dignitaries
- positioning security personnel at all times at the entry and exit points to the event
- providing secure, lockable containers that can be used for storing valuable materials and equipment, both during the day and during the night
- removing all valuable, portable items from the event venue when the event is not operating
- security and identification checks of all event stakeholders
- security searches of all vehicles entering the event site
- security searches of the personal belongings and bags of all people entering the event site
- surveillance cameras
- the provision of emergency medical services
- the use of trained, professional private and public security

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personnel throughout the staging of the event to patrol the event site
- training all event staff and stakeholders how to identify potential security breaches and the action they should immediately take if they suspect a security breach is about to occur

The security plan that is produced for the event should be detailed including:
- a site map detailing all security posts and the personnel stationed at each security post
- accident and emergency procedures
- all the security control measures that will be implemented for the event
- contact details of the local police force
- contact details of the regional or national security agencies to be contacted in a serious security breach
- evacuation procedures for the venue
- the emergency procedures to be followed if a security breach occurs
- the location of the command post where the senior personnel who deal with a security breach will be situated
- the locations and contact details of the nearest fire stations and emergency accident hospitals
- the locations of on-site first aid and medical stations and automated external defibrillators
- the locations of on-site fire-fighting personnel and equipment
- the names and contact details of all the security personnel who will be deployed at the event
- the schedule of the security team – their names, chain of command, their roles, contact details and when they will be on duty

The security plan contains confidential information, and its circulation should be restricted to only the people who need to

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have access to it, so that information contained within it is not transmitted to potential criminals or terrorists.

Implementing the security plan will require a financial budget. The event manager should not underestimate the costs that will have to be included in the budget for the event to ensure that robust security resources are in place to contribute to the health and safety of all people attending the event.

Security policies and procedures

The size and nature of the event will determine how many security policies and procedures will need to be produced and circulated to all event stakeholders as part of their event induction training. An example of an internationally recognised security procedure relates to dealing with suspicious items and what action should be taken in case of a terrorist incident.

Suspect packages

If a suspect package (not an unattended package) is identified at the event, the following questions need to be answered:

- has the item been **hidden**?
- is the item **obviously** suspicious?
- is the item **untypical** of the environment?

If all answers to these questions are '**yes**', then the event manager or the security personnel need to ensure that nobody touches the suspicious item. A cordon should be established around the suspicious item, and the emergency procedures contained within the security plan are implemented. The cordon should be:

- 100 metres around a briefcase
- 200 metres around a suitcase
- 400 metres around a car
- 800 metres around a lorry

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Suspicious people

If the event manager is notified of someone acting suspiciously at the event, then the emergency procedures in the security plan should be implemented.

Terrorist incident

If the event is subjected to a terrorist incident, then the following advice should be followed:

Run – everyone should run to a place of safety away from the source of danger. If running is not possible, then everyone should:

Hide – look for as secure a place as possible trying to avoid exposure to the danger by staying on the floor, staying away from windows and openings; lock doors from the inside; establish barricades; if possible, hide behind thick walls or pillars; turn mobile phones to silent mode; switch off lights

Tell – if it is safe to do so, telephone the emergency services for help

Obey – obey all instructions from the security personnel; when walking towards the security personnel, everyone should raise their hands above their heads

Security contractors

Taking security seriously is essential. There will be some private security contractors that the event manager can sub-contract the security management of the event to. Selecting and working with a professional security contractor will be important as the security personnel (who will be highly visible at the event) will play a key role not only in ensuring that the event takes place safely but also contribute to overall attendee satisfaction through their customer relation skills.

Some venues will employ their own security personnel – the event manager will still need to understand what role the security

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personnel will undertake so that their duties can be included in all health, safety and security information that is distributed to the event stakeholders. For all events in which professional security personnel are utilised, the event manager needs to know the responsibilities of the security personnel, for example:

- what situations can they deal with:
  - alcohol and drug abuse
  - crowd management
  - detaining techniques
  - emergency evacuation
  - physical assault
  - providing first aid
  - public relations
  - terrorist attacks
  - verbal abuse
- their supervision and management – who will line manage the security personnel at the event? Which communication methods will the security team use, and what records and logs will be kept of all security incidents at the event?
- under what situations will an intervention occur – in which circumstances will the security personnel intervene when a security breach occurs and what type of intervention will be used?
- what insurance policy does the security organisation have in place – for its employees and public liability – in case an insurance claim is made against the event manager's company?
- the knowledge and understanding of the security personnel in relation to the local laws that relate to the event that is being organised and the 'house rules' of the event itself – for example, laws in relation to alcohol consumption and 'house rules' in relation to matters such as wearing wrist bands and where event participants can and cannot go on the event site. The security personnel need to know when they have to refer

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a security incident to a member of the local police force and when they can deal with it themselves

As can be seen from the contents of this section on security, the event manager has a critical role to play in managing the security arrangements for the event that is being organised. An appropriate security plan has to be produced (based on a thorough risk assessment), security control measures have to be implemented, and a sufficient number of trained, professional security officers have to be deployed at the event.

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31 Dealing with an Emergency at an Event

In the unfortunate situation that an emergency occurs at the event, the following steps should be followed by the event manager:

- identify the crisis as quickly as possible – don't delay in realising that an emergency has arisen
- act calmly and immediately to prevent further loss, harm or injury occurring
- assess the emergency and report this to the relevant people
- follow all legal procedures and guidelines
- implement the emergency procedures plan
- identify and locate resources and facilities to address the emergency
- monitor the health, safety and welfare of individuals during the response – be sensitive to the human impacts of the emergency the physical and emotional impacts on the people affected
- obtain and provide technical and professional advice as appropriate
- share information promptly with other event stakeholders to

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enable effective co-ordination and response – be prepared for integrated emergency management procedures
- work and communicate effectively with responders, partner organisations and other event stakeholders – co-ordinate communications internally and externally
- continue to respond appropriately as the emergency evolves

For medical emergencies, as much information as possible about the casualty should be provided for the first-aid personnel or ambulance staff who might be called to the incident, for example, the approximate age of the casualty, the nature of their medical emergency, whether they are breathing, if they have an injury that is resulting in blood loss, and if the casualty is conscious. This information will help the emergency services to make an initial assessment of the seriousness of the casualty's injury.

If the medical emergency arose as a result of an accident at the event venue, then full details of the accident need to be recorded using photo images as well as a written report. The information recorded in the accident report should include what type of accident it was, how the accident occurred, and the names and contact details of any witnesses. This information needs to be as detailed as possible.

Training in how to deal with a fire emergency is also important for all event personnel. All event stakeholders need to know what they have to do if a fire breaks out: who to inform, where the fire extinguishers are located, and where the emergency evacuation exits and routes are located.

During the emergency, all traffic routes to and from the event venue must be kept clear of obstructions, vehicles and people so that the emergency services can quickly and easily access the event site.

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If an emergency occurs at an event, all personnel and stakeholders at the event will find themselves in a very stressful and challenging situation. To enable the event manager to respond as calmly as possible and be able to implement the aforementioned steps, it is essential that an emergency procedures plan has been produced. The emergency procedures plan is a key tool in enabling the event manager to respond to the emergency professionally.

Formulate an emergency procedures plan

All events need to have an emergency procedures plan – this is essential, no matter how small or large the event is. It is the event manager's responsibility to ensure that a feasible emergency procedures plan is prepared for each event that is organised.

Normally, each venue will have its own plan for dealing with emergencies. Venues will generally have a set of emergency procedures to deal with security, crowd control, bomb threats, earthquakes, floods and other issues that might result in an

Did you know?

- Basic Life Support (BLS) training is important to be taken by every event manager, even if there is a professional medical team at the event. Event managers who are trained in BLS will be able to give a basic level of medical care to any event participant, performer or event employee who suffers a life-threatening illness or injury that is sustained at the event.
- BLS is similar to CPR (Cardiopulmonary Resuscitation) – it is an emergency procedure that combines chest compressions with artificial ventilation given to someone when the heartbeat has stopped.
- It is said that the first 60 minutes are critical for a person who has suffered a major trauma illness or injury. If medical support or first aid can be given to the injured, or ill person, within the first 60 minutes, they have a better chance of survival and recovery.

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emergency occurring. In these circumstances, the venue owner will provide the event manager with the emergency procedures plan so that the event manager can implement the plan if an emergency occurs. This emergency procedures plan should then be included in all the health and safety training that the event manager arranges for all stakeholders involved with the event.

The cascading of the emergency procedures plan to all event stakeholders is an essential responsibility of the event manager and will be a critical part of the event manager's duty of care to all people who will be working at the event – contractors, suppliers, event employees and volunteers.

If all people working at the event understand what they have to do in an emergency, they should be able to follow standard procedures at a time of crisis which will help to reduce confusion and panic with members of the public.

The emergency procedures plan will specify:

- a detailed plan of action that has to be followed and the roles of different people who will be involved in tackling the emergency until it has been resolved
- the communication strategy and plan which specifies the person who will communicate information about the emergency to internal and external stakeholders
- the lines of responsibility to deal with the emergency – the person who will take command to deal with the emergency (the incident commander) and the roles and responsibilities of the people who will follow instructions provided by the commander. This team of people is known as the crisis management team. The emergency procedures plan will specify how the crisis management team is to work together so that there is no confusion or duplication of effort when the emergency occurs

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The emergency procedures plan has to be written using precise language to show how specific emergencies are tackled by the various personnel involved, including a process of escalation to deal with extremely serious emergencies. Flow charts of who does what, when and in what circumstances are generally helpful and easy to follow for the event stakeholders.

The emergency services are trained in implementing a process of escalation of response when dealing with an emergency. The first line of response when dealing with an emergency occurs at the operational, front-line level – fire officers, police officers and ambulance staff. If the emergency becomes more serious, the command moves to the tactical management level. If a severe emergency emerges, the level of command is known as the strategic management level in which senior management is involved in leading the response to the emergency. The following terminology is the commonly used international terminology for these three escalation scenarios:

- bronze level – this is the normal operational level to deal with a small-scale, localised emergency and involves personnel who are already in place, working at the event – for example, the event manager, the event management and operational team, security staff, fire and safety officers, technical/maintenance staff, and floor managers. If these personnel can manage the emergency and bring it under control, there is no need to escalate the emergency to the next level of response
- silver level – this is the tactical management level and will be brought into action when the bronze level team are unable to resolve the emergency. Emergencies that are escalated to the silver level are ones that cannot be contained locally and require the intervention of emergency personnel with a wider range of expertise or more specialised equipment. At this stage of the emergency, the event as a whole might now be affected, and it may be that the event venue or site has to be

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evacuated. If the emergency continues and cannot be tackled by the silver team, the final option is to involve the strategic management level of crisis response, known as the gold level

- gold level – the emergency is now critical, and a senior strategic team of people is brought in to manage the emergency. This senior management team of people will be able to authorise the use of resources that are not within the remit of the silver team – additional expert emergency responders, such as members of the armed forces. The gold team will also have direct communications with appropriate senior politicians who will now have to be fully informed about the emergency

When dealing with an emergency at an event, the three levels of bronze, silver and gold are part of a sequence of escalation. The incident controller has to be able to decide to escalate the emergency from one level to another. Failure by the incident controller to escalate the emergency to a higher level could result in the emergency becoming a great tragedy, particularly if anyone involved with the event loses their life.

The emergency procedures plan for the event should be as specific as possible to the bronze, silver and gold levels – who are the people to contact when the plan has to be escalated to the next level – what are their names, job titles and, very importantly, their contact details. The list of people to contact should also include deputies or substitutes if the key individual cannot be contacted promptly. Everyone should be clear on their role in the system and of when, and how, the various named staff are notified to become directly involved.

If the event venue or site that is being used for the event is operated as a formal event venue, then it is likely that it will already have a detailed emergency procedures plan. However, the event manager should confirm that this plan is up to date and

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that all the people listed as emergency contacts are still available to be called upon if an emergency arises.

Training for an emergency

Dealing with an emergency is very challenging. During the emergency, many difficulties could be faced: injuries to people; equipment catching fire; stages and rigging collapsing; explosions occurring from terrorist bombs etc.

The event manager needs to ensure that all stakeholders involved with the event know the emergency procedures to be followed if a serious incident occurs. All people who are involved in the running of the event need to be trained on what to do if an emergency arises. Training for implementing the emergency procedures is critical and should occur through meetings and the distribution of written emergency instructions to all event personnel, contractors and suppliers. The training that is provided has to include:

- all the emergency procedures that the venue itself will have in place to deal with an incident
- the coded information that is given over the public address system to notify event personnel that an emergency has occurred
- what to do in an emergency and, importantly, the evacuation procedures to follow if the event venue or site has to be closed down

The events management team and senior contractors and senior personnel at the event also need to be trained in the details of the emergency procedures plan. When the training has been completed, each participant in the training has to sign a document to confirm that they have been trained and in what procedures.

The event manager, as part of their continuing personal development, should attend crisis management and emergency

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response training courses organised by emergency response experts to develop further their knowledge and understanding of how to respond to and manage an emergency.

Keep all the emergency procedures documents in a file

It is evident from the above sections of this chapter that a number of documents are needed by the event manager to prepare the emergency procedures plan. These documents should be included within the emergency procedures plan file:

- contact details of the crisis management team, the incident commander and the media spokesperson
- confirmation of what scale of the emergency is needed to escalate the response team from bronze to silver and finally to gold
- details of the key personnel who are managing the event and their contact details
- information and contact details of the bronze, silver and gold teams
- information on the communication system that is being used at the event to enable communication between the key stakeholders
- information on emergency backup supplies, for example, generators for electricity supply
- information on the emergency services who are attending the event and the contact details of their managers
- location information on the special equipment that is on-site to deal with particular hazards
- the detailed programme for the event – what is happening where, when and at what time
- the distribution list of the people who will receive the emergency procedures plan
- venue or site maps that include the emergency evacuation routes and the position of the emergency services

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The event manager should seek advice from the emergency services and other health and safety experts when preparing the emergency procedures plan – it is likely that the event manager will not have the full range of knowledge and experience that is required to produce a comprehensive plan.

In some situations, it will be the venue or site owner who will take responsibility for the emergency procedures plan and will manage all aspects of the plan if it has to be implemented to tackle an emergency.

Emergency services provision

All events should provide emergency services provision on the site of the event or at the venue – security, fire and first-aid services. The scale of the emergency services provision to be provided will be determined by some factors:

- how near emergency services facilities are from the site or venue
- the number of people expected to attend the event
- the profile and characteristics of the people attending the event
- the size of the venue or the site of the event
- the type of event that is taking place and the emergencies that may occur at the event
- whether any emergency services facilities are already provided at the venue or the site
- whether the venue or site is indoors or outdoors

It is the event manager's responsibility to ensure that adequate emergency services provision is provided for the event to handle routine and expected challenges that occur as well as being prepared to act as first responders in case of an emergency.

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32 Co-Ordinate Emergency Procedures When Necessary

Before the event takes place, a crisis management team has to be established by the event manager or the owner of the venue where the event is taking place. The crisis management team will be led by a senior person who will have the authority to command all activities and responses to tackle the emergency. This person is known as the incident commander.

For large-scale events, it is imperative that the crisis management team is established well in advance of the event taking place and that they rehearse their roles and the actions they have to take if an emergency occurs during the running of the event. This rehearsal will assist the crisis management team to work effectively together during the stressful times when the emergency is unfolding, and a rapid response is required to reduce panic with all people who are involved with the event and to overcome the emergency.

Where large-scale emergencies could occur, the event manager and the crisis team leader have to liaise closely before the

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event takes place with the emergency services so that there is no confusion during the emergency on who is in control of the incident (the incident commander) and how it should be resolved. A member of the emergency services will likely be designated as the incident commander of the crisis management team.

All senior personnel who will be working at the event need to be fully informed what their roles and responsibilities will be if an emergency occurs. The people that need to be informed and trained in the emergency procedures plan will depend on the type of event that is being organised but could include: contractors providing site services such as floor managers, front-of-house operations, stewards, security personnel and the suppliers of utilities – electric, gas and water. All key personnel who are involved with the event must have a clear understanding of what they have to do if an emergency occurs at the event – not only with their staff but also with members of the public who are attending the event.

An example of a crisis management team is in Figure 27. Each event will require its own team based on the venue or site and the different activities that are taking place during the event.

The emergency services will each have their own procedures and policies for tackling major incidents. Normally, it will either be the police or the fire service that takes responsibility for co-ordinating the overall response to an emergency and their instructions in such situations have to be followed. Before the event takes place, the event manager must meet with the commanders from the police force and the fire service to confirm which service will take overall control should an emergency occur at the event.

It is very difficult to predict when an emergency will happen at an event – they are uncontrollable and frequently unforeseen. The challenge for the event manager is to be vigilant at all times and to

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Figure 27: An Example of a Crisis Management Team

Name:	Contact details:	Responsibility:
Event Manager	Mobile phone number: Radio channel: Internal phone ext:	Crisis management team (CMT) leader Co-ordinate whole CMT's actions whenever possible Media contact (unless a media spokesperson has been appointed)
Media Spokesperson	Mobile phone number: Radio channel: Internal phone ext:	Responsible for communicating a consistent and truthful message to the media
Floor Manager	Mobile phone number: Radio channel:	Co-ordinating contractors within the venue
Venue Manager	Mobile phone number: Radio channel: Internal phone ext:	Co-ordinating venue departments – fire; security; medical; traffic; engineering
Emergency Planning Officer – possibly from the local police	Mobile phone number: Radio channel:	Co-ordinating police, fire and ambulance services.

look for indicators that some unforeseen crisis is about to occur, and then to implement strategies to prevent the damage that the crisis might cause. Emergency procedure planning taken before the crisis occurs will help to reduce the impacts of the emergency – which could be extremely severe.

All crises and emergencies will be different, with different causes, consequences and durations. The challenge for the event manager is to be able to respond flexibly and quickly during a crisis and to work with experienced crisis management team members to resolve the emergency with as much damage limitation as possible.

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Case Study:

The Hillsborough Disaster

Liverpool Football Club (LFC) are the champions of Europe following their victory over Tottenham Hotspur in the 2019 European Champions League final. LFC is one of the most successful premier league football clubs in the United Kingdom and is supported by very passionate fans from all over the world. Such passionate support led to a great tragedy 30 years ago in 1989 when LFC was playing Nottingham Forest Football Club in the semi-final of the FA Cup at the Sheffield Wednesday football stadium called Hillsborough. Ninety-six LFC fans lost their lives, and 766 fans were injured at what should have been a very joyous and memorable event.

The tragedy occurred when thousands of LFC fans were entering the Hillsborough stadium and were moving towards the part of the stadium that had been designated for them. There were too many LFC fans for the space available. The physical pressure of fans trying to get into the viewing area resulted in fans being crushed against the pitch side, high steel fencing that separated the fans from the pitch. The horrendous over-crowding of the viewing area resulted in LFC fans being suffocated or trampled on by other fans who were being pushed forward. The design of the stadium and the severe over-crowding meant that there were no suitable escape routes for the fans – in effect, they were trapped inside the stadium with no safe exit routes. Whilst the majority of fans were able to escape, eventually, 96 fans tragically lost their lives, and 766 fans were injured.

A widely accepted reason for the cause of the tragedy is that of inadequate policing and management of the crowd. All tragedies

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like the Hillsborough disaster have to be thoroughly investigated so that lessons can be learned to help prevent similar tragedies from occurring in the future. The report that was published following the investigation resulted in some very important changes being made to the organisation of sports events in the United Kingdom. All containing high steel fences that surround the football pitch within stadia had to be removed and seating had to be installed in all top-division stadia. New policies, procedures and guidelines were introduced for the design of stadia to improve the safety for all stakeholders.

The investigation into the disaster also analysed the crowd management strategies that were in place on the day of the tragedy to enable improved strategies to be implemented in the future. A major conclusion that the investigation reached was that policing of the crowd was inadequate and that some of the decisions that the police officer in charge took were ill-informed. Sheffield Wednesday Football Club was also criticised for the poor quality of its stadia in relation to the number of entry and exit points for fans and the quality of the barriers that were installed in the viewing areas.

Why is a case study about the 1989 Hillsborough disaster relevant today? Firstly, because it is the worst disaster at a sports stadium in United Kingdom history. Many of the health and safety guidelines for managing large crowds of people in confined areas have developed as a result of analysing the causes of the Hillsborough disaster. Secondly, because the police match commander on the day and senior executives from Sheffield Wednesday Football Club have been subject to legal criminal proceedings for their role in contributing to the tragedy. In 2016, a coroner's inquest ruled that the LFC fans were unlawfully killed due to grossly negligent failures by the police and ambulance services to fulfil their duty of care to the fans. In the United Kingdom, all event managers have

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a duty of care to their stakeholders, which is a legal obligation to provide a standard of reasonable care to prevent any foreseeable harm occurring to them. In 2017, six people were charged with various offences for their role in contributing to the tragedy, including manslaughter by gross negligence. In 2019, the sentence for the police commander on the day is still being determined, but it could result in him being personally held responsible for the manslaughter of all those people who died at Hillsborough.

This case study is relevant today because it emphasises the importance of the event manager being 100% responsible for the health and safety of all the stakeholders involved with the event that is staged. If any harm comes to any of the stakeholders and the event manager is found negligent in their duty of care, then they could face legal proceedings that could result in a conviction of manslaughter with the sentence being imprisonment. Legal proceedings can take many years – in this case study, 40 years – and the stress caused for all the people involved will be immense. For the fans of LFC, they will never forget the 1989 Hillsborough disaster. The LFC anthem – '*you'll never walk alone*' symbolises the spirit, resilience and determination of the fans, families and friends of those who died to seek justice (over the last 40 years) for all who lost their lives on that tragic day in 1989.

EVIDENCE REQUIRED FOR THE APIEM CERTIFIED EVENT MANAGER QUALIFICATION

For readers who want to study for the APIEM Certified Event Manager Qualification, you are to select an event that you have organised in the previous 12 months or are going to organise in the next 12 months and provide a portfolio of evidence that will contain:

1) The health and safety risk assessment documents for your chosen event.

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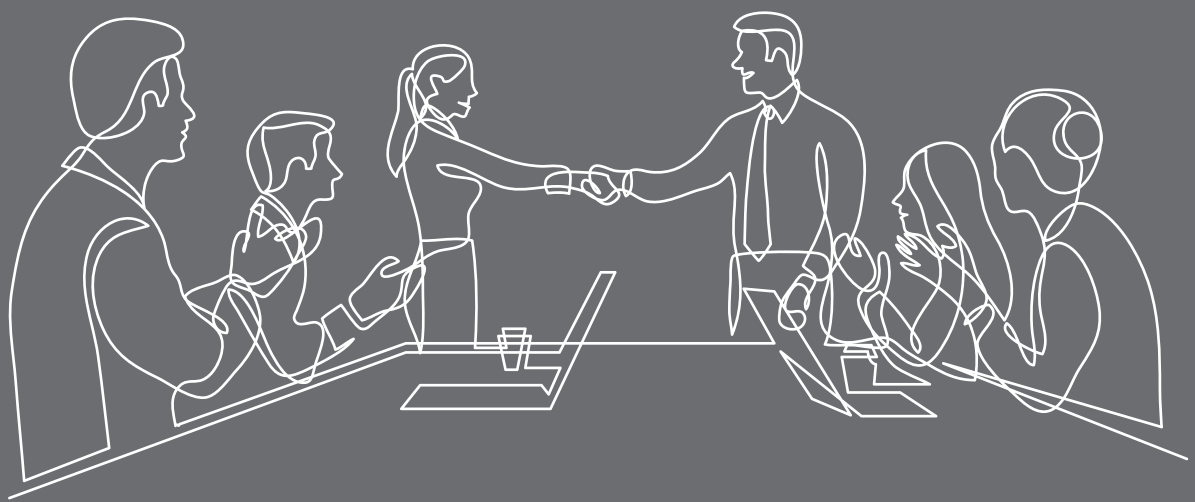
2) An explanation of the emergency procedures that need to put in place for the event.

You will also write a reflective report that explains:

1) The reasons why the 'key hazards' you have included in the health and safety risk assessment document are the **main hazards** for which control measures are required.

2) The reasons why the emergency procedures you have devised will be appropriate for the event.

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chapter 7
managing people at the event

After reading this chapter, you will be able to:

- identify the event stakeholders
- learn strategies that will help manage an event's stakeholders
- understand the challenges in co-ordinating events with the various stakeholders
- work with stakeholders after the event
- allocate work to team members
- quality assure work in your team
- manage conflict in the workplace
- manage relationships with external stakeholders
- provide leadership

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33 Identifying the Event Stakeholders

The event industry has put a lot of focus in recent years on the importance of stakeholder relationships. A stakeholder is anyone or any organisation that has an interest in, is influenced by or is involved with, the event. An effective event manager is not just someone who is good at preparing, planning and organising the event, but also someone who can manage the diverse needs and interests of all the stakeholders involved with the event.

The level of influence that each stakeholder might have on the event, and hence the amount of attention that the event manager will have to give to each stakeholder will depend on a variety of factors. These factors include the role that the stakeholder is playing at the event, the contribution the stakeholder is making to the event, and the stakeholder's financial involvement with the event. Some stakeholders, especially those that are financially involved with the event or stakeholders that have a regulatory role at the event, will need to receive considerable support and attention from the event manager.

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In many instances, the stakeholders are contracted to provide services for the event. The number of stakeholders involved with the event is linked to factors such as the type of event, event venue, the event theme, the length of the event, the event programme and participant profile. Depending on the nature of the event, there can be a quite number of stakeholders involved. This means that, in many instances, the event manager will have to co-ordinate and organise the work activities of a diverse range of stakeholders. Some of the key stakeholders that the event manager will have to work with include the:

- accommodation providers – these range from large luxurious hotel complexes to more boutique-style accommodation. The event manager may include hotel accommodation as part of the overall event experience, and as such will need to identify accommodation providers that will offer an appropriate quality of provision at an affordable price for the event participants. The type of accommodation included in the event experience will be determined by the type of event and the overall delegate fee that is to be charged to participants
- associations – local, regional, national and international associations may be involved with the event, especially if it is a sports event that involves national and international sports federations. These associations have to be fully involved at all stages of preparing, planning and organising the event as national and international standards of facilities and services have to be provided by the event manager, not only for the athletes but also for all the other stakeholders such as spectators, caterers, transport providers and the media
- caterers – food and beverage are a central feature of events. Whether a coffee break during a convention, a banquet at an opening event, or a welcome drink upon arrival at the hotel, food and beverage can be the augmented event products that contribute to the event's success or failure. The design of the food and beverage offering contributes significantly

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to the satisfaction and enjoyment of the event participants, so careful attention has to be paid by the event manager in selecting the event caterer and establishing good working relationships with the caterer

- client – probably the most important stakeholder, as this is the person or organisation that has contracted and paid for the event manager to prepare, plan, organise and manage the event on their behalf. Very careful attention has to be paid to understanding clearly and meeting the expectations and objectives of the client
- contractors – the various organisations that provide a great variety of services to the event industry, for example, specialist stage rigging companies; utility companies that supply power and water; companies that provide trained security personnel and stewards. A feature of the events industry is that it comprises many sub-contracting specialist service organisations that have established a reputation and expertise in providing their services to event organisers. Each contractor that provides a service for the event manager is a stakeholder in the event
- event organizer – with some large, multi-disciplinary events, the event manager might sub-contract the organisation of the event, or parts of the event, to another event organizer. Event organizers play a pivotal roles in co-ordinating and communicating with a variety of suppliers and contractors on behalf of the event manager
- event production companies – production companies or production houses work with the event manager on the overall design of the event. They will be experts in music, lighting, digital technology, multi-media technology, graphic design and artwork. The production companies will produce most of the audio-visuals that are needed for the event – music, stage backdrops, banners, venue directional signage, outdoor advertising (such as street banners and billboards),

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and other creative features and props to be used at events. Selecting and working with a creative and innovative event production company will assist the event manager to design an event that meets the objectives set by the client

- government – governments at a local, regional and national level can provide support services to the event, with different departments such as immigration, customs, police, emergency services, sports and leisure, culture and tourism being involved. The degree of government involvement and the government's support for the event will be based on the type and scale of the event but will need to be negotiated and agreed upon by the event manager. Government departments can be quite a labyrinth of differing levels of administration, responsibility and decision-making authority. Yet their involvement and support can not only help expedite event tasks but also lend additional resources
- legal services – legal experts will be needed in the areas of insurance, liability, risk management, contracts, permits and licenses and in handling disputes should they arise. The event manager will likely need to utilise the services of legal experts when preparing and planning the event, especially when working internationally. Fully understanding the legal implications of staging an event in a specific venue and locality is essential for the event manager. Full consultation should be undertaken with legal experts to ensure that the event and the event manager fully comply with all legislation and regulations that are in place
- local community – the people that live close to the event venue and businesses in the vicinity of the venue are also stakeholders of the event as they will probably be affected by the event if it is a large-scale event and one that could offer economic benefits as well as creating environmental problems such as noise, pollution and traffic congestion. The event manager needs to consult with, and involve the local

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community, during the preparation and planning stages of the event to ensure that harmonious relationships are established with the people who might not attend the event but will be affected by it and could benefit from it

- media – media reporting takes various forms: broadcast, print, and through digital technology and the internet. Traditionally, the media were the 'gatekeepers' of information. Journalistic reporting through television, radio, and the internet remains a powerful factor in creating awareness of the event, and influencing intent to visit or not. The event manager has to work closely with appropriate media outlets not only for pre-event publicity but also for broadcasting from the event during its operation
- participants – the people for whom the event is being organised. Ensuring that all participants who attend the event

Did you know?

- A local community in some countries in Asia can include old traditional, cultural tribes. Don't forget to ask the permission of the head, or leader, of the tribe if the event can be held in the village. Also, ask the tribal leader's opinion about the nature and content of the event itself. Moreover, ask about what rituals have to be followed before and after the event.
- The event manager has to respect the wishes and attitudes of the tribal leader and if feasible follow the local norms of behaviour for staging events – if this does not happen, the safety and well-being of the event personnel could be at risk.
- The event manager has to understand the religion, race and culture of the community where the event is to be staged, and the strength of beliefs and feelings within the local religion, race and culture towards the type of event that is being planned. Some religions, races and cultures might have strong beliefs that have to be respected and could make it impossible for the event to be staged.
- 'People power' is an intangible characteristic that the event manager has to factor in the event management process.

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are thoroughly satisfied with their experience and leave with a favourable impression not just of the event but of the event organising company is crucial. If the participants have had a positive and memorable experience, they are likely to attend similar events organised in the future

- sponsors – sponsors contribute significantly to the success of the event either through providing finance to subsidise the cost of organising the event or by providing goods or services free of charges such as providing hotel accommodation or transportation services. In return for sponsoring an event, the sponsor will have certain objectives, for example, being able to promote its brand at the event and ultimately to secure additional sales revenue for its goods and services. The event manager has to understand precisely the objectives of the sponsor and needs to meet these objectives if future sponsorship is to be secured from the same organisation in the future
- transport providers – events will require a range of local transportation services for participants, performers, and event employees to travel to and from the event venue. Safety, quality, clear user guidelines and provision for people with special needs are important factors the event manager will have to consider when selecting transport providers for the event. It will be essential that a seamless and smooth journey is provided for all stakeholders of the event
- venue provider – the selection of the event venue should fit the theme and purpose of the event as well as satisfying the objectives of all the stakeholders involved with it. Establishing a positive relationship with the venue provider is imperative as much of the success of the event will rest on the venue provider meeting all of the expectations of the event manager in terms of venue design and layout, venue accessibility and very importantly the health, safety, security and emergency procedures that are in place at the venue

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To identify all the stakeholders who could be involved with an event, the event manager needs to utilise their knowledge and experience of the events industry as well as consulting with other key people who might have a better understanding of the characteristics of the communities in the locality where the event is due to take place.

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34 Managing the Event Stakeholders

From the above section, it is clear that many different stakeholders can be involved in an event. Each stakeholder may well have different objectives and interests in relation to the event. The challenge for the event manager is to ensure that each stakeholder's objectives are met; this can be extremely challenging, so the event manager has to understand which stakeholder's priorities are the key ones to concentrate on at any given time when preparing, planning and organising the event. The following strategies will assist the event manager when working with the stakeholders:

- stakeholder mapping – at the preparation stage of the event, the event manager should conduct a thorough analysis to identify all of the stakeholders who will have an interest in the event. It is essential to identify all the stakeholders (internal and external) and to understand the role of each stakeholder in preparing, planning and organising the event
- determine the influence and power of each stakeholder – understanding the levels of influence and power of each

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stakeholder on the event will allow the event manager to predict how a particular stakeholder may interact directly with the event team or with other stakeholders. To measure the possible influence and power of the stakeholders, the event manager should assess their level on a ranking scale from high, medium to low:

  - high: indicates a stakeholder who has significant influence and power to impact decisions, timeframes, or outcomes of the event
  - medium: indicates a stakeholder with a significant influence on the event, but with a lower level of power to affect the event
  - low: indicates a stakeholder with little influence or power to affect the event
- Once the influence and power of each stakeholder has been identified, the event manager will understand how much time and attention to pay to them when preparing, planning and organising the event
- understand the priorities of each stakeholder – each stakeholder will have their own priorities for being involved with the event, and the event manager needs to understand these. If the priorities of each stakeholder are not understood, then it will be difficult for the event manager to ensure that the stakeholders are satisfied with their involvement in the event

Establishing effective working relationships with event stakeholders

As mentioned above, the first step in building effective relationships with event stakeholders is to understand who they are and what their priorities are. Many events get delayed or end up not delivering the value they promised because the event manager failed to identify and engage all of the stakeholders. Those stakeholders that have been assessed as having high

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power and influence are the ones where most attention should be devoted.

If the event manager is leading a large-scale event, it will not be possible to spend an equal amount of time with every stakeholder. In this situation, the event manager should look at all the stakeholders who have been identified and assess who the three to five most impactful ones are – those who have the power and influence to define the event, who can affect its direction and who can help move it forward. The event manager should always make sure that relationships with these influential events stakeholders and decision-makers are the best that they can be.

Building effective relationships isn't just about the amount of time that is spent with a stakeholder but about the quality of that time. Great relationships are built through one-to-one conversations where the event manager can get to know the stakeholder on a personal level and can find out more about their motivations. At the most fundamental level, event stakeholders will only feel comfortable with the event manager when they believe that there is an understanding between both parties and that the event manager has their best interests at heart. The most important task for the event manager is to enquire about the stakeholder's interest and involvement in the event, their requirements and any knowledge or experience they have that can help deliver an outcome that adds more value.

Establishing open, clear, honest and regular communications are part of the stakeholder management process. The event manager needs to establish how to communicate with the stakeholders during the preparation, planning and organising phases of the event – how they would like to be kept updated and the frequency of these communications. The stakeholders must be informed about all successes and challenges that are influencing the

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organisation of the event – being honest with the stakeholders will lead to a more trusting relationship. If problems do occur, then it may be that the stakeholders can suggest a solution to the problem that is being faced.

If there are many stakeholders involved with the event, then an effective way to communicate and keep them informed of progress is to write and circulate weekly or bi-monthly status reports with an executive summary, explaining which milestones have been delivered and which ones are still outstanding. The status reports could also include the event's top five risks and issues with actions to address them – who will be responsible for addressing the issues and the time frames involved. Similarly, the event manager should hold regular event steering committee meetings where all stakeholders gather together for a presentation and discussion on the progress with the preparations for the event. This will be an important opportunity to explain major challenges that are being faced and enables the event manager to ask for support to overcome the challenges and to move the event forward.

Building good relationships with event stakeholders is not a one-off exercise or something that only happens at the beginning of the event. Excellent stakeholder relationships are established over time, where the event manager treats all stakeholders like valued clients. Good relationships are created when the event stakeholders have confidence in the expertise of the event manager. The event manager can achieve this by defining the event and its scope, creating a realistic implementation plan, managing risks and working to the event budget. The management and leadership skills of the event manager will also be important as stakeholders will look to the event manager to motivate and inspire all event team members and stakeholders to deliver a very successful event.

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Biggest challenge

Unquestionably, the biggest challenge faced by the event manager is dealing with client requests or revisions in the production process or running order of the event, especially when such requests are close to the start time of the event. One small change on the staging of the event can impact a whole range of other services supporting it. Clients may sometimes ask for what they perceive to be a minor change, but they do not understand the complexities of such a request. So, another challenge is reasonably managing the client's expectations – at all stages of the event preparation, planning and organising process.

Managing an event can be thought of as managing a complex array of specialists, egos and personalities who may all have their own objectives and priorities without necessarily taking account of the needs of the other stakeholders. To try and reduce last-minute requests being made to the event production process, it is best to have several work-in-progress meetings and final briefings with all stakeholders before the event, particularly during rehearsals, as there are always things to improve upon. The work-in-progress meetings should enable amendments to be made to the production of the event promptly and without causing undue stress or complications for the event manager and team.

Working with stakeholders after the event

During the event shutdown period, event stakeholders should continue to collaborate. The shutdown process will involve the dismantling of the stage set-up, waste management, final bill settlement, acknowledgements, thank you letters and gifts, appreciation lunches or dinners, internal awards of appreciation, and conducting research and evaluation such as impact assessments. It can take some time to shut down and close the file on the event.

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A major part of the event shutdown process is the debriefing sessions with key event stakeholders, which can provide additional insights into the success of the event and recommendations for improving similar events in the future. All the information that is gained from the debriefing meetings should be consolidated within the final post-event report and should contain the following:

- event name and theme
- mission and objectives
- location, venue, dates, times
- program schedule
- budget showing original compared to actual
- evaluation of the event using agreed metrics
- ticket statistics as a rate of ticket purchase and number of paid, complimentary and VIP tickets
- participant profile
- records and minutes of meetings
- copies of all printed materials such as brochures, flyers, tickets, and posters
- photo and video library
- sponsor and partner summary
- media and advertising exposure and clippings (print and video)
- list of contracted services
- list of contacts
- feedback from debriefing sessions
- overall concluding remarks

The final post-event report should act as a reference, not as a design or plan for a future event. Each new event, even if recurring, should be unique, or an improvement over the previous one. Simply replicating an earlier event may lead to a loss of confidence from the event stakeholders involved and as a result, the contract for the next event may be awarded to a competing event organising company.

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The above section of this chapter shows that the ability to lead, manage, and work effectively with people is an essential skill for an event manager. All events require teams of people to work harmoniously together in order to deliver an outstanding participant experience. An event manager requires to establish appropriate working relationships with the internal employees of the events team and the many different event stakeholders who will contribute to the success of the event.

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35 Establishing Effective Working Relationships Within the Team

The event manager has to have good working relationships with many people – employees, volunteers, contractors, suppliers and a great variety of different stakeholders involved with the event. Establishing good working relationships with team members is a skilful process and, to do this, the event manager needs to be experienced at utilising a portfolio of interpersonal skills:

- accept differences. Organising an event can involve working with people from different cultures – it is one of the pleasures of working in the events industry, but also one of the challenges. The event manager needs to understand and respect the cultural backgrounds of their team members and welcome the diversity that such multi-cultural teams involve. The event manager will gain the respect of the team if full recognition is given to the cultural differences within the team, rather than treating all team member as if they all have the same religion, beliefs, traditions and customs
- emotional intelligence. Emotional intelligence is a high order interpersonal skill and is a skill that should lie at the heart of an event manager's portfolio of skills. Emotional intelligence is

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very similar to showing empathy – it is seeing a situation from another person's perspective and being able to understand how that person might feel in a given situation and being able to 'read' and respond to their emotions. Very effective managers are skilful in the art of using emotional intelligence and managers who use their emotional intelligence are more effective than managers who have not developed this ability

- involve team members in decision making. Team members will feel more committed to completing the tasks that are to be accomplished if they have contributed in some way either to the planning of the work or deciding how the responsibilities are to be divided. Clearly, not all people working on the event can be involved in this collective decision-making process because they will not have the experience or skills to make a valid contribution. However, senior members of the event team with extensive experience and specialised skills should be involved in making decisions that relate to their area of work. It is a characteristic of a competent manager to involve other team members in the process of arriving at decisions – the team members will be more motivated to the team if they feel that their views are welcomed by the event manager. The final decision that is reached will probably be more effective as a result of this consultative approach to decision making
- professional personal presentation – the dress, grooming and manner of the event manager has to reflect a highly professional approach as personal presentation plays a part in establishing relationships with others. First impressions are crucial, and the event manager should dress appropriately for the type of work that is being undertaken
- share and exchange information – in teamwork, it is important for the event manager to be open with team members on all matters relating to the event. All information relevant to the team's performance should be given to the team members and opportunities should be provided for them to provide

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their feedback and advice on the work that the team has to undertake. If communication fails to take place, then the team will be acting without leadership and co-ordination. Team members will be more motivated if their ideas and opinions are welcomed by the event manager

- show concern for the well-being of team members. The event manager should observe the members of the team and pick-up signals that are communicated by the team member that might indicate that that person is experiencing some form of difficulty. The event manager should then try to discover what the problem is and if possible and feasible provide sympathy and support that might help the team member overcome the problem
- understanding the characteristics of the team members. Organising events can be extremely challenging and stressful. Inevitably, there will be frustrations and tensions within the team. To reduce these, the event manager must understand

Did you know?

- Virtual teamwork may bring a lot of creative ideas to an organisation and can reduce the costs of holding a meeting. Five Currents, an event company based in Monterey, California, prove that time and space are not the problems of having good teamwork. They have organised at least 14 Emmy Award events, ten Olympic Games including opening and closing ceremonies at the London Paralympic Games 2012, Sochi Winter Games 2014, and the Jakarta Palembang 2018 Asian Games. (http://www.fivecurrents.com/)

- Five Currents founder Scott Givens manages at least ten different nationalities under his leadership. For example, in the Jakarta Palembang 2018 Asian Games, his team were from Russia, Belgium, Canada, USA, Australia, Ireland, Mexico, Brazil, Argentina, Scotland, United Kingdom, and Malaysia who worked together with a local team from Indonesia. Virtual teamwork was achieved through the use of digital technology to ensure that this multinational and culturally diverse team was able to function and operate efficiently.

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the personal characteristics of the individuals who comprise the events team and how they respond to tension and pressure. When tensions exist, part of the team's energy will be taken up with the conflict. To reduce tensions within the events team, the event manager needs to gain a clear picture of the personalities and characteristics of the team members and then to draw out the strengths of each team member

Assertive Skills

Frequently, to utilise the above interpersonal skills, the event manager will need to be assertive. Assertiveness is the art of clear and direct communication. Being assertive enables the event manager to:

- be direct and ask for what is needed to complete the tasks in hand
- express personal feelings to team members
- say 'no' clearly and firmly without causing offence
- say what is meant clearly and confidently

Being assertive does not mean being aggressive – assertiveness is a verbal and non-verbal communication skill that involves the following:

- expressing feelings through the tone of voice rather than through emotive language
- maintaining strong eye contact and being aware of the use of contradictory facial expressions – do not smile if the verbal message is one that reflects disappointment
- making requests of team members directly and positively with a very clear message

Team members will respect their event manager if the above skills are used when handling challenging interpersonal situations.

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36 Allocating Work to Team Members

The event manager is responsible for ensuring that the event is organised successfully so that all participants have a truly enjoyable and memorable experience. A very important management task to achieve this is allocating work to event team members so that the team can perform to the best of its ability. Work should be allocated to team members on a fair basis taking account of the individual's:

- background and experience
- existing workload
- opportunities that the event might give for the team member to develop further
- skills, knowledge and competence

When allocating work to team members, the event manager should only allocate tasks to an individual that can be undertaken correctly by that person – there is no room for error when preparing for and working on an event.

Each event team member must fully understand which tasks they will be undertaking and to what standard of performance. Clear communication through briefing meetings is an important means

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of achieving this. The briefing meeting should enable two-way communication to take place so that the event team members feel they can ask the team leader questions if they are uncertain about the instructions and information they have been given. The briefing meetings are also a good opportunity for the event manager to receive feedback and suggestions on how the task can be completed from team members – receiving feedback and suggestions from the event team members is to be encouraged and welcomed by the event manager.

Before work starts, the event manager should verbally explain the standards of performance that each team member has to meet and, where necessary, provide this information in writing, for example, as a method statement. If event team members do not have clearly defined roles and responsibilities, difficulties will arise as each team member might undertake their tasks in a way that they consider to be correct rather than conforming to precise specifications.

Once work has been allocated, the tasks have been explained, and feedback received the team should now be able to commence its work. Completing this process is critical for ensuring that the event team members feel confident in the work they have to do, the quality standards they have to meet, and the time frame for completing their work.

One of the special characteristics of the events team is that it will be temporary and will probably involve people who have not worked together previously. The challenge for the event manager is to ensure that all members of the team know their responsibilities and work successfully with their fellow team members to complete their tasks in the very tight time deadlines that they will be working to. This requires very effective people management skills by the event manager and the supervisors of the various teams that are working on the event.

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37 Quality Assuring Work in the Team

Teamwork requires all members of the events team to complete their specific tasks correctly and to the specified quality standards. To ensure that this occurs, the event manager should be clear about the tasks to be undertaken and the expectations of the event team members in performing their duties.

The work of each team member needs to be monitored regularly by the event manager to ensure that the tasks that have to be performed to make the event a success are being carried out correctly and to the quality standards that are required. The monitoring of the event team members will probably be undertaken by their supervisors, but the event manager will need regular feedback from the supervisors to confirm that work is progressing to time and the right quality standard.

However, in preparing for the event or during its implementation, problems or mistakes may arise, or some event team members may fail to undertake their tasks as well as they might. To minimise the impact of such problems or errors on the work in hand or the effect on other team members, the event manager (or the team member's supervisor) must inform the individual concerned as

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soon as the mistake has been identified. To do this professionally, the event manager should implement the following guidelines:

- take the event team member to a location where a private conversation can be held without being overheard by other team members
- explain to the event team member why the meeting is taking place – provide accurate details of the mistake that was made and explain to the team member that the purpose of the meeting is to support him or her to improve their work performance
- spend time finding out why the mistake was made – to do this, ask a series of open questions (questions that begin with why? what? how?). Open questions will require the team member to answer the questions in a more substantive way rather than just answering using 'yes' or 'no'
- when there is an understanding of why the mistake was made, the event manager can discuss the help and support the team member might need so that the mistake does not occur again – this might involve additional training and guidance or being allocated a different task to undertake
- outline to the event team member the consequences of them not performing the task to the expected quality standard
- next, a course of action can be agreed for the event team member to follow to ensure that the mistake does not occur again. The agreed course of action should be recorded in writing so that there is a permanent record of what the event manager has agreed with the team member
- all the points that are made when speaking with the event team member must be made constructively, referring to the task that was undertaken, and how it was undertaken rather than making personal comments about the team member
- throughout the meeting, the event manager has to be sensitive to the feelings of the team member because receiving challenging feedback from a manager can be quite

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a distressing situation. By conducting the meeting in a calm, non-threatening tone of voice, the team member will be more motivated to stay loyal to the event manager and to carry out their tasks to the standards expected

Hopefully, by following the above steps, the event team member will change their behaviour and will work to the expected quality standards. In some situations, though, this might not occur, and the event manager will have to meet with the team member again. This second meeting will be more formal and depending on the event organising company's human resource policy and procedures could see the event team member being subjected to disciplinary proceedings or having their contract of employment terminated.

It is essential for the team that the event manager takes action when a member of the team is underperforming. Teams will only achieve their objectives if all members of the team work together harmoniously for the benefit of the team. Part of the success of the team will lie with each member's determination to succeed for the good of the team as a whole, not for personal ambitions.

Just as it is essential for the event manager to identify situations where team members are underperforming, it is also essential for the event manager to recognise when event team members are working to, and exceeding, the expected standards of performance. Paying compliments is one way of showing appreciation and helps to encourage loyalty from team members. Receiving a compliment from the event manager can also boost the self-confidence of team members and will further help to develop personal relationships within the events team.

A key message that the event manager should communicate frequently to event team members is that everyone should always

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be looking to continually improve the quality of the work that they are undertaking. One way of achieving this is to introduce another type of meeting to the team members – a meeting whose sole purpose is to focus on the quality of the work that the team is performing. This should be an open meeting whereby the event team members can discuss problems or concerns they have with their work. The purpose of the quality meeting, though, is not just to identify problems and concerns. An important part of the meeting is to propose solutions to the problems and develop a plan for how these solutions can be implemented. These meetings have particular characteristics:

- all event team members should attend the meeting
- the meetings should be seen as a means to solve work-related problems
- once a problem has been identified, then a variety of options to solve it should be identified before a feasible solution to it is reached
- the tone of the meeting should be such that the event team members feel able to make their points without fear of being criticised or ridiculed
- once a feasible solution to the problem has been identified, following the approval of the event manager or team leader it should be implemented

By holding a quality-meeting, the events team will benefit from:

- increased motivation of the event team members – by discussing work-related problems and concerns the team members will feel more involved with their work with a resulting boost in their motivations
- sharing problems and concerns with each other, which in itself can help to reduce the stress and tension that individuals in the group might be experiencing
- utilising the technical experience within the events team – one team member might have a certain set of skills from

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which a solution to a problem that another team member is facing can be identified

At the end of the event, if the event manager has adopted the guidelines presented in this chapter, then appraisals can be completed for each individual in the team. Each event organising company will have its own approach and format for undertaking staff appraisals, but it is good practice at the end of each event for the team members to meet individually with the event manager or their supervisor to discuss their work performance at the event. This should be a two-way conversation that enables the event manager (or supervisor) and the event team member to engage in a conversation that includes the following topics:

- the positive contributions that the event team member made to the work of the team
- what changes or improvements the event team member could make in the future to their work performance and behaviour
- the training needs or support that the event team member might now need to help them improve their skills set, particularly if a more senior work role is contemplated
- the career opportunities that the event team member is

Did you know?

- The event manager should offer a certificate of appreciation as a reward to employees who have made a significant contribution to the success of the event. In Asia, in particular, the receiving of certificates of appreciation is seen as highly motivational.
- In some cases, one of the requirements for an event management company that wants to bid for the contract to stage an event is to enclose the certificates of appreciation that have been awarded to its employees.

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interested in for their future personal development and the steps that could be taken to help them achieve their career ambitions

Each events company will have its own approach to appraising its staff and will have its set of appraisal forms to complete. A written record must be kept of the appraisal meeting and the outcomes that have been agreed between the appraiser and the appraisee. Each party should sign the appraisal forms once they have been completed to confirm that they agree with the contents of the form and the next steps of action to take.

A professionally completed appraisal process is a valuable way of motivating event team members and giving them confidence in their event manager and increasing their loyalty to the events company. Implementing a formal staff appraisal scheme is good practice for all events organising companies. Time invested in appraising and supporting event team members is time well spent.

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38 Managing Conflict in the Workplace

Disagreements arise when people are in conflict on a particular issue. A conflict could arise between event team members who have a disagreement or it may be that a member of the team has difficulty in working with the event manager. To manage and resolve a conflict requires the joint efforts of all those involved. The event manager has a key role to play in conflict management in the workplace and will need to use their knowledge, interpersonal skills and confidence to resolve the conflict.

Identifying when a conflict situation occurs

Some conflict situations are easy to identify, for example, when a heated argument occurs between event team members. Some people might internalise the conflict, and keep their anger and other emotions hidden. The signs that the event manager should look for in the team that might indicate that a conflict has occurred include:

- de-motivation within the team for the tasks that have to be completed
- increased sickness absence within the team
- the changing behaviour of team members – perhaps

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derogatory comments are made about other team members, and the bullying of team members occurs

The challenge for the event manager is to read the emotions and behaviours of the team members so that prompt action can be taken to resolve the source of the conflict quickly before it escalates into something more serious.

Responding to workplace conflict

There are two main options open to the event manager when faced with workplace conflict. The event manager could ignore the conflict and do nothing to resolve it or measures could be taken to address the source of conflict immediately in a calm and controlled way. The event manager should always try and resolve conflict in the team quickly. A strategy to resolve workplace conflict in a calm and measured way includes:

- early intervention by the event manager to help prevent bad habits of behaviour or language becoming normalised. This demonstrates to the team members that the event manager will not accept breaches of company standards of behaviour
- enabling the parties affected by the conflict to try and resolve it themselves should be encouraged as this gives ownership of the problem to the team members involved and they may well be able to identify a course of action that is acceptable to them that will overcome the problem
- event team members, however, might not have conflict resolution skills themselves. Therefore, they have to be given guidelines on steps that they can take in such situations. For example, before the process of resolving the conflict commences, all of the parties involved must fully understand the nature of the conflict. To gain a better understanding of this, the conflict should be analysed from the perspective of each of the parties involved. Once the team members understand each other's perspective, they might be able to

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discuss and identify solutions to the conflict that are agreeable to them all

- holding a quiet, informal conversation with the people who are in conflict to prevent the conflict from escalating into a much more serious dispute. The event manager could simply remind the event team members that mutual respect and observing certain standards of behaviour is expected when working for this particular event organising company. Feeding back to the event team members their actions, behaviours and the language they used might reinforce with them that they have to modify their behaviour, and respect and abide by the company's standards
- if the parties to the conflict are unable to resolve it themselves, then the event manager will have to intervene to prevent the conflict disrupting the work of the events team – this is especially important when the team is working to an agreed timescale. To do this, a systematic process has to be followed in three phases:

  the early phase:

  – identify the issue(s) that is causing the conflict
  – list all of the concerns in relation to the conflict from the perspective of all parties involved
  – analyse each of the concerns to identify the most important ones for each party
  – the event manager to meet individually with each party in the conflict to allow them to express their views openly and to identify the outcomes that each party wishes to achieve
  – the event manager to consider each desired outcome and evaluate whether or not the other party in the conflict will be willing to accept it
  – meet the parties to the conflict together to try and resolve initially those areas of concern that are less contentious

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the middle phase:

- this is where harder bargaining takes place to resolve the conflict and to reach agreement on the best way forward
- the event manager should start by choosing one contentious issue and discusses it with the parties to identify areas that can be agreed upon
- clear explanations will need to be given by the parties on the reasons why a particular course of action is not acceptable
- compromise and give-and-take are required during the middle phase from both parties – concessions will have to be made if the conflict is to be resolved. If neither party is willing to make concessions, then deadlock will result and the conflict will not be resolved
- it might be that a break in the meeting is needed to give both parties time to reflect on the issues being discussed so that they have time to think in a less fraught atmosphere
- during the middle phase when making concessions, the event manager might need to suggest conditions that have to be followed by one or both parties, but these should be presented as means to resolve the conflict and not as threats which will harm the conflict resolution process
- if all parties to the conflict are prepared to make concessions, then a mutually acceptable solution should be reached

the concluding phase:

- the meeting should conclude on good terms, and the outcome that is agreed has to be respected by all parties
- the agreed outcomes of the meeting that will resolve the conflict have to be clearly stated by the event manager and verbally and written down in detail as a permanent record of the meeting in accordance with the event organising company's policy and procedures

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- if either party disagrees with what is being said or written down, then now is the time for them to seek clarification and to reach a consensus on the means that have been agreed to resolve the conflict
- the meeting should end with all parties feeling that the outcome reached is satisfactory and the conflict has been managed effectively

Progressing through these phases is neither smooth nor easy. The event manager and the other parties will at times feel frustrated, emotions will rise, and at times it will feel as if a deadlock has been reached. All of these will have to be overcome by the event manager to satisfactorily manage the conflict and reach a resolution.

Seeking external support through mediation and conciliation
If after following the above three phases the conflict has not been resolved, then external support and intervention will likely be needed by specialists in mediation and conciliation.

Mediation experts will bring an impartial perspective to the conflict resolution process and will not take sides with either the event manager or the other parties. Effective mediators will hold meetings separately with all the parties concerned to understand the nature of the conflict and what the deadlock pressure points are. The role of the mediator is not to directly impose their solutions to resolve the conflict but to allow a further discussion to take place between the parties involved and to facilitate both parties to identify their solutions to reaching a mutually acceptable agreement.

Interpersonal skills for managing conflict
The event manager will need to use a wide variety of interpersonal skills to manage conflicts in the workplace:

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- body language – if the event manager controls the use of their body language during the conflict resolution process, it will help the discussion to conclude. Body language can be used to support and endorse what the event manager is saying:
  - to emphasise points forcefully, downward hand gestures can be used
  - disagreement can be shown by folded arms, crossed legs and closed postures
  - honesty can be demonstrated through open postures, upward-facing palms of the hands combined with strong eye contact
  - an agreement is indicated by using nods of approval coupled with smiles
- creativity – resolving conflicts also requires the event manager to be creative in looking for alternative solutions to the problem, which will be acceptable to both parties. This involves divergent thinking whereby some possible solutions to resolve the conflict are identified before convergent thinking takes place to reduce a large number of solutions to one which is acceptable for implementation
- critical thinking is a high order interpersonal skill that the event manager needs to develop to manage conflicts in the workplace. It is the ability to assess the underlying logic of arguments put forward by the other parties and then to formulate arguments that counter some of the claims of the other person. Counter-arguments based on facts and evidence will be more successful than those which are based on speculation or incomplete information. Critical thinking requires the event manager to have a wide understanding of the conflict drawing upon previous situations and issues which have caused conflicts and knowledge of how these conflicts were satisfactorily overcome
- emotional intelligence – the event manager needs to create a climate of mutual trust and respect with the other parties

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for the conflict resolution process to proceed effectively. This requires the event manager to understand the situation causing the conflict from the perspective of the other parties and how the conflict is affecting the other parties – physically and mentally. This will draw upon the event manager's empathetic skills and emotional intelligence. The event manager should be particularly sensitive to the other parties emotional state and mental well-being, seeking to manage their negative emotions with sympathy and without apportioning blame

- listening skills – the ability to listen and understand what the other party is saying is crucial. One way of ensuring that listening is occurring correctly is to briefly summarise the content of the discussion at regular intervals – what has actually been said. This type of recap helps prevent misconceptions from arising on either side as to what has been said and confirms that all parties have kept track of the discussion
- questioning skills – open questions should be used to enable the other parties to explain how they feel, why they think the problem occurred, and what they consider to be suitable solutions to the problem. Pressure can also be put on the other parties by posing in a calm, non-threatening manner probing questions that ask for a more detailed response to a question – *what do you mean by that? I don't fully understand what the problem is, please explain it again*. Reframing techniques are also useful during questioning whereby the event manager re-phrases the points that are being made and asks the parties who conflict if this is a true reflection of the situation – this enables the problem to be seen from a different perspective
- verbal communication – there are certain key rules to follow when managing and resolving a conflict:
  - speak clearly and forcefully, this allows the other parties to understand what is being said and will indicate the

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event manager's strength of feeling
- control the speed of speech, increase the speed of speech to make a point and then allow pauses for the other parties to reflect on what has been said
- do not use emotive language. Emotions will be high when managing and resolving conflicts, but it is crucial not to allow these to influence the discussion that is taking place. Keeping calm is important during the meeting to resolve the conflict
- do not digress, stick to the point and concentrate on the important issues or problems that have given rise to the conflict occurring. Digressions are distractions and waste time

The event manager has a responsibility to be sensitive to how their team members are interacting and working together. When problems are identified in the working behaviour of team members, the event manager has to intervene quickly. Otherwise, the problem could escalate into a much more serious dispute and conflict. To be an effective manager of conflict in the workplace, the event manager will have to draw on a wide variety of high order interpersonal skills to give them the knowledge, experience and confidence to successfully resolve the conflict situation and to return the team members to being fully productive in the work they are doing for the event. Managing conflict at work is an integral part of being a good manager of people.

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39 Providing Leadership

The event manager has to lead team members – this is a key responsibility to ensure that the events team has a common purpose and clear sense of direction to complete all tasks that are needed to ensure that the event is successful. As the team leader, the event manager is responsible for overseeing the team's activities and making sure that the team's objectives will be met on time and in the desired manner.

This is a key difference between 'leadership' and 'management'. Management responsibilities tend to be concentrated on managing the day-to-day operational functions and tasks of a team, whereas leadership responsibilities tend to be focused on overseeing a long-term project. Leaders are required to set the objectives for the team and devise strategies that will enable the team to achieve its objectives.

When the events team is working to strict deadlines to prepare for the event, they have to accept the need for the event manager to be the leader of the team and consequently the team members have to accept the decisions that the leader takes. If the team members do not accept the event manager as their leader and challenge

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the leader's position, then the energies of the team will be used in a negative way to destabilise the team. To ensure that this situation does not arise, the event manager, as team leader, has to understand effective team leadership skills and behaviours.

Leadership styles

This chapter is based on common knowledge about what leadership involves and the skills that a competent event manager should develop to be effective as a team leader. It is commonly understood that there are, at least, five different leadership styles that can be identified by analysing the behaviours of leaders and the situations they face:

- the authoritarian leader – this is an autocratic style of leadership whereby the leader controls a situation by giving clear directions to team members, exerting strong power over the team telling the team what to do. This style of leadership is effective when there is limited time for the team to perform their tasks or when the team faces a crisis
- the laissez-faire leader – this is a style of leadership where the team members have much more control over their work. The team leader facilitates the team members to undertake their work, rather than by providing specific instructions. For this style of leadership to work, the leader will need to have belief, confidence and trust in the experience of the team members
- the participatory leader – this is a democratic style of leadership through which the leader actively encourages the team members to contribute to the decision-making process. The opinions and views of the team members will be used by the leader in reaching a decision which might relate to solving a problem that the team is facing or some other operational challenge that has to be resolved
- the procedural leader – this style of leadership is adopted when the team members have to complete their work according to clearly specified policies and procedures. With this leadership style, the focus is on the job to be completed

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and ensuring that there is compliance with agreed standards of performance. There is no flexibility for deviating from the quality standards and expectations that have to be met

- the transformational leader – this style of leadership requires the leader to be charismatic to inspire team members and other stakeholders to think creatively about new ways of working or to identify innovative solutions to work-related challenges which will result in major changes for the team. In utilising this leadership-style, the leader will be very visible to the team members and will encourage their active participation through dynamism, energy and enthusiasm

Each of the above leadership styles has its strengths and weaknesses. The event manager will need to select and implement the leadership style that is most appropriate for the situation that is being faced at different stages of the event lifecycle.

When preparing and designing the concept for the event, the participatory leadership style may be appropriate. During the set-up of the event, where instructions have to be followed precisely, the procedural leadership style will be appropriate. The laissez-faire leadership style could be implemented when the team members are very experienced in the work that they are doing and might need minimal supervision and direction from the event manager. When the event manager is undertaking strategic thinking with the team, for example, identifying new innovative events that could be planned, a transformational leadership style could encourage team members to think creatively about new opportunities for the events company. If an emergency is encountered during the event, then an authoritarian style of leadership will have to be implemented.

What is evident is that the event manager has to understand the characteristics of the leadership situation that is being faced and to utilise the leadership style that is most suitable for that situation.

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If the event manager implements the same leadership style at all times, irrespective of the situation, then the event manager will be ineffective as a leader and the team will not achieve its objectives.

Leadership responsibilities

Irrespective of which leadership style is being adopted by the event manager, certain responsibilities have to be accepted and undertaken:

- setting group objectives and targets. Each team needs to have a common purpose and a clear sense of direction – it is the leader's responsibility to provide these. One way of doing this is to agree and set SMART objectives for the team. An objective is an endpoint that the team must reach if it is to fulfil its obligations. The objectives that are set should be SMART:
  - specific: the objectives that are set need to be concise and clear on what is to be achieved
  - measurable: objectives which have quantifiable targets are effective as they can be more easily measured to see if they have been met. An example of a measurable objective might be in relation to the number of tickets that have to be sold at a certain price in order to generate the sales income for the event
  - achievable: the team will not be motivated to achieve the objectives set if they are unrealistic and cannot be attained – the objectives, therefore, need to be fully achievable by the team
  - realistic: as well as being achievable, the objectives set have to be realistic in relation to the resources available to the team – which could include human resources, finance and equipment
  - timebound: all objectives that are set should have a timeframe associated with them (the date for a specific task to be completed). This is essential so that the team members can plan their work to complete all their tasks on time

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- once the objectives for the events team as a whole have been set and agreed, subgroups within the team, or individual team members, can be allocated their own SMART objectives. This delegation of objectives helps to give ownership of the larger work task that has to be completed to individual members of the events team. When team members know precisely the work they have to undertake, to the required standards and by a certain time and date, they will be more motivated to complete their tasks effectively and efficiently
- sometimes, though, a subgroup of team members or an individual member of the team might not accept the SMART objectives they have been allocated. If this situation arises, the leader will need to discover why the SMART objectives are unacceptable and will have to negotiate with the subgroup or individual to arrive at a position where the SMART objectives are accepted. The steps in the negotiation process will include:
  - exchanging views: discussing calmly what the challenge or problem actually is
  - listening: to understand fully the nature of the disagreement with the SMART objectives
  - clarifying issues: if there is a misunderstanding from either party's perspective, then this needs to be clarified
  - providing constructive criticism: sometimes the leader will have to use assertive skills to inform the other party of what they are doing wrong and how to rectify it
  - planning: designing strategies to reach agreement on the SMART objectives
  - compromising: each party may need to offer concessions in order to reach agreement
  - reaching agreement: arriving at a situation where all parties consider the new SMART objectives to be acceptable
- with SMART objectives set and agreed, the events team can now start to undertake their work tasks. The leader is now

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in a position to monitor the team's performance against the objectives that have been set. If the leader becomes aware that the events team is facing difficulties in keeping to schedule with their work, appropriate remedies should be identified and implemented promptly to assist the team with their work. Perhaps all that might be required is for the leader to motivate the team members to focus on their work by providing additional guidance and support to the event team members. If this does not work, then other interventions will be required, the nature of which will be determined by the challenge facing the team

- a key characteristic of working in the events/MICE industry is that intense pressure can be felt by team members when preparing for and working at the event. The leader has to recognise when these pressure points are arising and will need to motivate the team members to help them cope with the pressure. Each events team member is an individual, and their leader needs to understand the stimuli that will motivate each individual. Examples of motivational techniques include:
  - holding meetings with the event team or individual members of the team to discuss and share the concerns that the team might have and providing an opportunity for open communication to take place to help identify a solution to the issue that is causing the pressure
  - giving verbal praise and thanks to showing appreciation of a job-well-done
  - providing a relevant tangible reward which could be an additional financial payment to recognise the hard work of the team, or an extra day's rest once the event has finished
- as the event team performs its duties and tasks, a member of the team may have their own personal difficulty which, if not addressed, could negatively affect their work performance and ultimately that of the team as a whole. In this situation,

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the leader has to show empathy and sympathy to the team member and try and help the team member identify and reach a solution to their problem. By taking a caring approach to the event team members, the leader will find that the team becomes increasingly loyal and more strongly motivated to complete their work tasks on time and to the agreed standards

- whilst preparing for, planning, and organising the event, many unforeseen challenges could arise for the leader. An essential requirement for the leader in responding to these challenges is to present a positive personal image, remaining calm at all times, showing perseverance and taking the initiative and responding flexibly to the challenges. Adopting these behaviours will instil confidence in the event team members and will help reduce any nervous tension that the team might be experiencing
- hopefully, the event runs successfully, and no difficulties or problems arise for the leader. However, if there is a problem, then the leader has to accept responsibility for it and for any mistakes or decisions that led to the problem arising. This is important not only from maintaining the respect of the event team but also from a legal perspective as well. The leader is legally responsible for all aspects of organising, managing and running the event – there is a 'duty of care' on the leader, and this cannot be delegated to any other members of the events team. If all the guidelines presented in this book are followed, the leader should be able to reduce the likelihood of a serious problem occurring at the event
- once the event has finished, a final leadership responsibility is to review and assess with the team members what went well in preparing for, planning and organising the event and what aspects of the event could be improved. This learning is an essential part of being a leader – seeking continual improvements in the quality of the work that is performed by the event team so that the next time the team organises an event, it is even more successful than the previous one

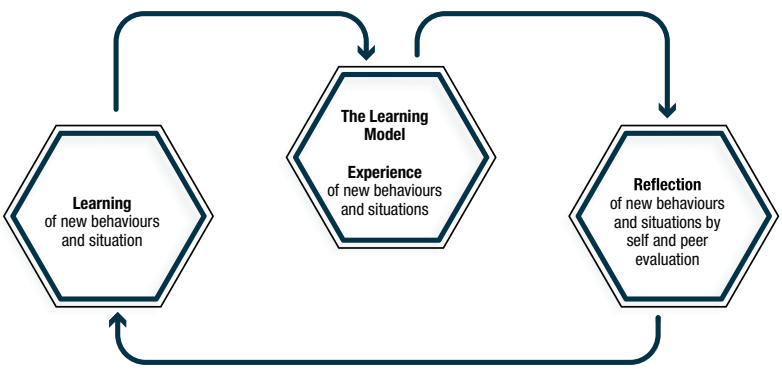
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Becoming a leader

A question that is frequently asked is, whether good leaders are borne or if leadership skills can be learnt? The view of the authors of this book is that leadership skills can be developed and that all event managers have an opportunity to learn about how to become an effective leader. Learning can be facilitated in many different ways, for example reading textbooks on 'leadership'; observing and analysing the skills and behaviours of other people in leadership positions and, very importantly, practising leadership skills whilst working as an event manager. All three of these learning methods, combined with self-reflection and feedback from colleagues, will contribute to the event manager becoming an effective leader.

As with all skills development, learning takes place over time and with each new leadership situation that is faced. Trial and error in applying different leadership styles will help inform the event manager of what their skills in leadership are, and which leadership skills still need to be developed. The learning model to follow is a cyclical process which, if followed, will enable the event manager to practice, reflect on and further develop their leadership skills.

Figure 28: The Learning Model to Become a Leader



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There are many challenges for an event manager and, if leadership skills can be developed, the events team will be more successful in the work it undertakes.

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Case Study:

Transitioning from Event Planner to Event Manager

What does it take to progress from being an event planner to an event organiser and, finally, to an event manager? An understanding of the contents of this book and applying them in practice will support this transition. As the event planner and event organiser's work experience expands and they take on more responsible tasks, they will be able to apply for a job as an event manager.

An analysis should be made of job advertisements for event manager positions to identify the experience, key skills and competencies that are required to become an event manager. Once the experience, key skills and competencies are understood, the event planner and organiser can undertake a self-evaluation of their current skills and competencies to identify which ones they still need to develop to be considered for an event manager position. Provided below are two examples of current event manager job advertisement from the United Kingdom. The experience, key skills and competencies that the successful applicants will require are very clearly specified.

My client is looking for a competent Event Manager to organise and operationally run events from start to finish in an exciting new venue! You will be experienced in both planning and operational skills, ensuring events exceed expectations.

We are looking for an enthusiastic individual with a proactive approach to events. You must have a proven ability to run events

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exceeding all expectations whilst capably representing the company in front of both client, venue and supplier contacts. You will be based both in head office and on site.

Personal Requirements

- *Skilled in project management*
- *Computer savvy; proficient in MS Office*
- *Outstanding communication skills*
- *The ability to negotiate where needed*
- *Natural problem solver*
- *A team player with leadership skills*

Responsibilities

- *Plan events from start to finish according to requirements, target audience and objectives*
- *Be creative with your suggestions to enhance the event's success and upsell as appropriate*
- *Attend and manage all events*
- *Fully brief all staff on H&S, the event plan, points of note, special arrangement, roles and responsibilities*
- *Take charge of issues arising, managing or delegating to ensure problems are resolved*

A second job advert for an event manager is also very clear on the type of person who is required:

We are currently recruiting for an Event Manager to work with our well-established corporate client based in North Kent. They are looking to expand their events team with a professional, outgoing Events Manager with previous experience in delivering large scale corperate events.

Duties Include:

- *Working closely with the head of the department to deliver large scale events across the events calendar*

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- *Lead the events team and introduce a number of innovative ideas to add to the events schedule*
- *Ensure that the budget is adhered to throughout all events*
- *To deliver a successful events calendar throughout the year, maximising revenue from each event*
- *Negotiating with suppliers to ensure the best outcome for the company*

The right candidate will have/be:

- *Previous experience in organising large-scale events*
- *Previous experience with working to strict budgets*
- *Demonstrable organisational skills*
- *Strong knowledge of Health & Safety Legislation in relation to event management*
- *Strong interpersonal skills with the ability to build relationships with ease*
- *Strong leadership skills*
- *A qualification in event management*
- *A passionate events management professional*
- *Calm under pressure, with a natural ability to problem solve*

This is a really exciting opportunity for somebody to work for a market-leading company within the leisure sector. The team is an expanding, passionate and driven team that works incredibly hard to deliver the best events for the company.

The above two job adverts are typical for an event manager job vacancy in the United Kingdom. As can be seen, the experience, skills and competencies that the successful candidate requires are those that are included in the chapters of this book and are fully aligned to the United Kingdom National Occupation Standards for the Events Industry.

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EVIDENCE REQUIRED FOR THE APIEM CERTIFIED EVENT MANAGER QUALIFICATION

For readers who want to study for the APIEM Certified Event Manager Qualification, you are to select an event that you have organised in the previous 12 months or are going to organise in the next 12 months and provide a portfolio of evidence that will contain:

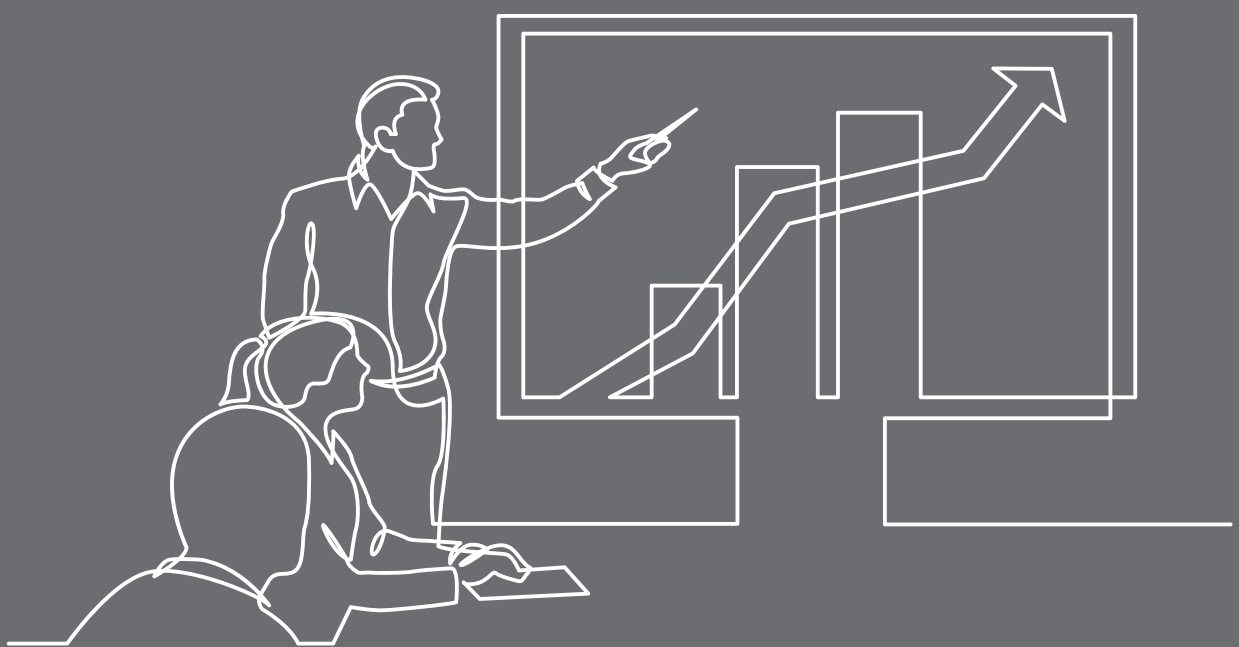
1) An explanation of how you managed the relationships with the key stakeholders of the event.
2) An explanation of the process you use for allocating work to the event team members.
3) A description of the nature and characteristics of a conflict you have been involved in – when it occurred, who was involved, why the conflict arose.
4) An explanation of the methods you use to quality assure the work of your event team members.
5) A situation where you were the 'leader' and an explanation of the leadership style(s) you adopted

You will also write a reflective report that explains:

1) The challenges you faced in managing the relationships with the key stakeholders of the event.
2) The benefits of the process you use for allocating work to the event team members.
3) How you resolved the conflict and the lessons you have learned about managing conflict in the workplace.
4) The challenges you face in quality assuring the work of your event team members and an explanation of how you might overcome these challenges.
5) An explanation of the leadership skills you currently possess and an explanation of the leadership skills you need to develop.

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chapter 8

evaluating the event

After reading this chapter, you will be able to:

- evaluate and report on the success of an event
- identify the reasons for the success and failure of an event and draw out key lessons for organising events in the future
- explain the role that evaluation plays in continuous performance improvement
- keep in touch with participants and maintain stakeholder relationships.

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40 Evaluate and Report on the Success of an Event

The final stage of event management is that of evaluating the success of the event, systematically identifying which aspects were implemented according to the plan and which aspects of the event could be improved. The importance of evaluating the success of an event cannot be over-emphasized. It is the event manager's responsibility to ensure that each event that is organised is thoroughly evaluated to identify what were the successful aspects and what improvements need to be made to ensure that future events are even more successful.

Designing the evaluation process should be part of the initial preparation stage of the event as all individual parts of an event can be evaluated. An event manager who arranges for evaluation data to be collected at each stage of the event lifecycle and then analyses the data will be working strategically. Being a strategic event manager will help differentiate one event manager from another, particularly when bidding for new contracts with potential clients. Not all event managers understand the importance of strategically evaluating the success of the events they organise or have the expertise to do so.

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A key question when considering the evaluation of an event is 'who is the evaluation for'? There will likely be many stakeholders who will be interested in the success of the event, for example, client, sponsors, suppliers as well as the event organising company itself. Each stakeholder might have a different type of evaluation data that they require to be collected for them to determine if the event was successful. The event evaluation process has to be designed so that it collects data that are relevant for all the stakeholders who wish to receive feedback on the success of the event from their perspective.

Digital event technology, as well as traditional research methods, enable the event manager to evaluate many different elements of an event from levels of participant engagement to the impact of an event on the sales of a product that was being promoted through the event. An event manager who can analyse and interpret these data will have developed a high-order intellectual skill that is very important for event managers who wish to work in the international events industry. Many international clients will place great importance on measuring the return on investment (ROI) of the events that they commission and, if the event manager is skilled in the evaluation process, they will have an advantage over event managers who do not have this expertise.

Return on Investment

The phrase 'return on investment' (ROI) is frequently used when considering how successful an event has been. From a financial perspective, ROI is the difference between the income generated for the event minus all the expenses and costs incurs, expressed as a percentage:

Income from ticket sales for the event = US$10,000
Costs and expenses of staging the event = US$7,500
Surplus income generated from the event = US$2,500
Return on investment from staging the event = 2,500/7,500 x 100 = 33%

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The success of an event is directly related to the achievement of the goals and SMART objectives that have been set for the event as specified in the event's business plan. It is essential when the event manager is writing the business plan for the event that SMART objectives are set that can be measured after the event to determine how successful the event has been.

The event manager can collect many different types of data to determine the overall success of the event and whether the goals and the SMART objectives have been attained. Some of the most common quantitative indicators of success for a business event are:

- increased market share that the exhibitors at a business event might have attained as a result of participating in the event
- new sales leads and referrals that were generated through the event
- sales revenues from products and services that were exhibited and promoted at the event
- the number of participants attending the event

However, the true quantitative success of a business event might not be seen until a few months after the event when sales leads that were generated at the event are converted into actual sales of the product or service.

As well as quantitative data, event evaluation measures can also be qualitative and non-monetary, for example:

- a change in the behaviour of the participants as a result of attending the event
- post-event brand image recall of the participants who attended the event
- improved morale of the employees of a company who have participated in a team-building event
- motivational behaviour of the participants concerning the products and services being exhibited at the event
- networking opportunities for event participants

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Measuring the qualitative and non-monetary success factors of an event is more complex than collecting quantitative data, and will normally require the event manager to subcontract the task to an external specialist research company. One example of an event industry research specialist is the Event ROI Institute (www.eventroi.org). This agency has developed an innovative approach to measuring the ROI of an event in which both quantitative and qualitative (non-monetary) data can be collected to evaluate the success of an event. Their process to evaluate an event is based on seven-steps:

1) set impact objectives for the event and its participants – the SMART objectives
2) decide what the participants should do after the event – the changes in their behaviour
3) understand the learning the participants need to gain to change their behaviour in (2) above
4) design and create the learning environment that will facilitate the learning of the participants

Then, after the event, questionnaires can be designed and implemented to evaluate the:

5) participants' satisfaction with the learning environment of the event
6) participants' learning and behaviour change after the event
7) business impact and ROI of the event

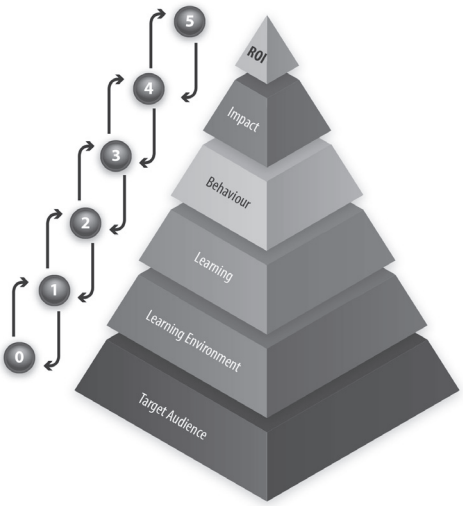
The Event ROI Institute portrays the above seven steps as a pyramid, see Figure 29.

Additional criteria for evaluating the success of an event

As can be seen from the discussion so far in this chapter, evaluating the success of an event can be a complex task. Many different criteria can be used to do this. Depending on the type of the event, the evaluation criteria can be expanded to include the:

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Figure 29: The Event ROI Institute's Pyramid



- economic impact on the local, regional or national economy
- environmental impact on the destination where the event is held
- impact of the event on the image of the destination where the event is staged
- local, regional, national or international media coverage generated by the event
- local residents' perception of the event
- publicity arising from the event – published online and offline in articles

An important point that the event manager should always remember is that the criteria used to evaluate the ROI and success of the event have to be aligned to the SMART objectives that were set and are specified in the business plan for the event.

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Measuring the operational success of the event

In addition to determining whether the SMART objectives of the event have been met, the event manager should also arrange for data to be collected that can be used to assess the detailed implementation aspects of the event. The event can be broken down into many different measurable aspects that will all contribute to the success of the event before, during and after the event, for example, the:

- opportunity for all participants to register online for the event
- running of the event to schedule and to plan, for example, did the event start on time?
- seating arrangements for all participants – were there sufficient seats and could all participants see the stage?
- accessibility of the event for people with special needs
- quality and effectiveness of the sound and lighting used for the event
- quantity and quality of the food and beverage

A straightforward means of recording the above data can be used, such as requiring either a 'yes' or 'no' response from an event employee assigned to the task of collecting the data. If a 'no' response is recorded, then an explanation should be provided of how this difficulty can be overcome the next time that a similar event is organised.

Collecting Reliable Data

No matter which criteria are used to evaluate the ROI and the success of an event, the data used have to be collected reliably. Reliable data are essential as it is these data that the event manager will use to analyse and evaluate the success of the event – if the data are unreliable, then false interpretations will be made, and incorrect conclusions reached. Data can be collected by:

- analysing the financial data of the event – was the financial budget set in the business plan achieved? Did event income

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cover all expenses and make a surplus? What expenditure items were over budget and which might have been under budget? What are the reasons for not achieving the planned income for the event? Understanding these variances is critical for the financial budgeting of subsequent events

- analysing information that has been generated at the event, for example, the number of ticket sales, income generated from the provision of food and beverage, sales income from merchandising
- direct observation of the behaviour of the participants at the event – were they motivated by the conference speakers? Which breakout sessions were the most popular with the event participants?
- qualitative interviews and focus group discussions with participants and event stakeholders to understand their feelings and attitudes of the event
- quantitative questionnaire surveys to determine the satisfaction of participants and other event stakeholders with their experience of the event – the online questionnaire design tool Survey Monkey can be used to help design and analyse the questionnaire. Event participants can be asked to evaluate different aspects of the event using a 1–5 rating scale where 1 is 'extremely dissatisfied' and 5 is 'extremely satisfied'. For example, the registration process, venue, speakers, break-out sessions, refreshments, and their likelihood of attending future events
- holding a de-brief meeting with event staff and asking them what went well and which aspects of the event could be improved
- receiving feedback from the event performers, speakers and other suppliers to the event on their experiences at the event
- reviewing the content of incident reports, seeing what were the main problems at the event

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Event evaluation questionnaires that are designed for completion by participants should:

- start by thanking the participant for attending the event and explain the purpose of the survey and how the results will be stored and used
- include a variety of different types of question – 'closed questions' where the participant ticks a box and 'open questions' where the participant is asked to write a short answer
- closed questions can be used for the participant to evaluate the: event website; registration process; venue; presenters and sessions; food and beverage; value for money; overall rating of the event; and the participant's likelihood of attending similar events in the future or how likely they are to recommend this type of event to other people
- open questions can be used for obtaining the general thoughts and feedback of the participants, for example, 'what aspects of the event do you think could be improved?'

An example of a traditional rating scale question on an event evaluation questionnaire is presented in Figure 30.

In addition to the traditional survey methods of collecting data, technology can be used, some examples are:

- social media analytics (Spezify) to assess the messages being communicated about the event online and the profile of the people creating the messages
- tracking media comments made about the event using Google Alert and Google Analytics
- monitoring social media accounts to identify an increase in followers on Twitter, in Facebook likes, and new LinkedIn connections. All social media platforms have insight tools, and these will provide valuable data such as likes, comments, shares, mentions and followers. Hootsuite enables these social media data to be aggregated

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Figure 30: An Example of a Rating Scale Questionnaire

Place a tick in the columns that represent your views on the following aspects of the event, using the following rating scale where:
1 = extremely dissatisfied
2 = dissatisfied
3 = neither dissatisfied or satisfied
4 = satisfied
5 = extremely satisfied
N/A = not applicable

How satisfied were you with:

Question	1	2	3	4	5	N/A
The event website						
Ease of booking						
Ease of registration						
Accessibility of the venue						
Signposting for the venue						
Value for money of the food and beverage						
The content of the speech given by Keynote Speaker 1						
The content of the speech given by Keynote Speaker 2						
The suitability of the venue for the event						
Your overall satisfaction with the event						

If you were dissatisfied with any aspect of the event, please explain the reasons why:

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- installing heat maps at the event to indicate which activities are most and least popular with the event participants
- web navigation trackers to identify the flow of participants at the event
- smart badges to record the purchases that participants are making at the event
- QR code analysis to evaluate which codes are the most popular for scanning by the event participants
- the number of downloads of information about the event and its activities
- data collected from the event app about the participants and their satisfaction with the event
- beacons at the event that record the number of participants walking past the beacon or who answer questions posed by a chatbot installed in the beacon

The collection, analysis and review of big data provide the event manager with many insights into the feelings, thoughts, and preferences of event participants, which can all be used to evaluate the success of the event.

Dealing with negative feedback from the event

It is likely that when receiving feedback comments from the participants and stakeholders of the event that some of the feedback will be negative – this is to be expected and should be treated constructively by the event manager. Negative feedback, if acted upon, should lead to the improvement of subsequent events that are organised.

The following steps should be followed by the event manager when negative feedback is received:

- data should be collected that can be used to verify that a problem or challenge occurred during the event
- understand what the problem or challenge's impact will have been on the participants or stakeholders affected

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- reflect on the negative feedback that has been provided, consider if it was a one-off problem that will not occur again or whether it is likely to occur again. If it is likely to occur again, then decide how best to prevent it from recurring. This will probably require a meeting with event staff to discuss how to resolve the issue or even inviting the participant or stakeholder who complained how they think the issue can be addressed
- some complaints about the event may be about uncontrollable factors, such as inclement weather and the event manager will have little opportunity to resolve the complaint apart from empathising with the complainant and offering sympathy
- after understanding the nature of the complaint, the event manager should apologise personally (if it is possible to do

Did you know?

- The Olympic Games generate a considerable amount of social media – the 2016 Rio Olympics, resulted in over 25,000+ sources of accredited media, including 270 digital media platforms covering the games.
- It was stated that there were 26 million visits to the official 2016 Rio Olympics website (Olympic.org), and over 7 billion views of official Olympic content on social media.
- Twitter released data that there were 187 million tweets inspired by the Rio Olympics, which was a 24,6% increase from the 2012 Summer Olympics in London.
- At least, 277 million people interacted 1.5 billion times in Facebook posts regarding the Rio games.
- Social media has allowed the athletes to create their own brands by allowing direct 'access' of themselves to the public. Social media can enhance their popularity and promote their achievements, but it also can operate as "CCTV" for all their activities, exposing some negative behaviours that might have been caught by the fan's camera.

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so) to the participant or stakeholder who has provided the negative feedback, thank them for highlighting the problem, explain the reason for the challenge or problem occurring, explain how it will be addressed in the future and, if relevant and appropriate, offer some form of compensation to the complainant, for example free entry to the next event that is organised
- if the negative feedback has been posted on social media, the event manager should respond to the complainant on the social media network – apologise for the difficulty arising and explain the reason for the problem occurring. Then ask for the personal contact details of the complainant so that communications can take place with them offline
- in all of the communications with the complainant, the event manager should protect the integrity of the event employees and the event management company and should avoid blaming personnel or the company for the problem occurring
- all communications with the complainant should use language that is non-emotive but is factual, rational and to-the-point

Following the above steps will show that the event manager takes complaints and negative feedback positively and will result in the complainant feeling that the issues raised have been taken seriously. By following these steps, a dissatisfied participant may well-be converted into a satisfied one who becomes a participant at future events that are organised by the event manager.

Evaluating the success of major and mega events

Major and mega events generally require substantial investment and support on a national scale to enable them to take place. International sports competitions usually need additional infrastructure and tourist facilities to host the thousands of participants who take part in them. These events are evaluated differently because of the impacts that these events can have on

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the localities, regions and nations where they take place. Major and mega events can contribute to the:

- re-vitalisation of an area of social deprivation
- regeneration of an area of economic decline
- showcasing a host city and nation as a tourist destination
- confidence of the host city for staging similar events in the future
- transformation of the city where the event is taking place by infrastructure improvements and by inspiring the local population to change their lives

Major and mega events deliver more than just the focus of the event (for example an international sports competition) – they are catalysts for change, progress and development. However, it is difficult to accurately evaluate the success of a major or mega event because many different criteria could be used to measure their success and there are logistical challenges in collecting the research data reliably to reach an accurate judgement on the success of the event. Besides, the impact of a major and mega event may take many years to be seen – up to ten years. This time-lapse poses challenges in the research process, for example, how can the actual impact of the event be determined when other factors might have contributed to the changes that are seen in the local community where the event was staged?

There is currently no internationally recognised method of analysing the impacts of hosting major or mega sporting events. Every country and consultancy will use its own different methodology, and there is no accepted international standard that allows the comparison of major sporting events. However, the main criteria for measuring the success of a major or mega sports event are:

- the economic impact on the local, regional and national economy

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- the environmental impact on the locality where it is staged
- the socio-cultural impact on the residents where it is staged

Specialist research agencies need to be commissioned to undertake the research that is required to evaluate the success of major and mega events. An example of such a research agency can be found at www.eventIMPACTS.com. This organisation provides guidance and good practice principles for evaluating the social, economic, environmental and media-related impacts associated with staging major and mega sporting and cultural events, and has developed a research methodology that can be used by event organisers.

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41 Identify Reasons for the Success and Failure of an Event and Draw out Key Lessons for Organising Events in the Future

Irrespective of the type of event that is being staged or its size and scale, the event manager should design and implement a process for its evaluation. The following steps summarise the key elements that the event manager needs to incorporate into the event evaluation process:

1) identify the critical success factors (CSFs) for the event, including its objectives
2) collect relevant information against the critical success factors
3) analyse and evaluate the information collected to establish the success of the event
4) identify reasons for the success of the event or reasons why problems occurred
5) draw out key lessons that can be applied to events that are organised in the future

Steps (1), (2) and (3) have already been discussed in this chapter. The event evaluation process also requires the event manager to identify the reasons for success and failure of the event and to learn lessons from the staging of the event.

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After the event has finished, a report has to be prepared that evaluates the success of the event and explains which aspects can be improved with recommendations on how to improve the next event that is organised by the event manager – the post-event report. This provides the event stakeholders with information regarding the quantitative and qualitative ROI and success of the event. The post-event report should:

- explain the research methodology used to collect the data
- explain how the data have been analysed
- interpret the data and produce evidence-based findings
- conclude and make recommendations for changes to similar events that are organised in the future

When reviewing the event, the event manager should identify the key challenges and difficulties that were faced and explain how they were overcome. The review process should enable the event manager to specify the alternative actions that were implemented to address the challenges and difficulties – the key lessons learnt. This will assist with the organisation of similar events in the future to prevent similar challenges from being faced.

When the post-event report has been written, the event manager should then follow agreed procedures for disseminating the report to stakeholders, maintaining agreements on confidentiality.

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42 The Role that Evaluation Plays in Continuous Performance Improvement

Event evaluation enables the event manager to compare the actual results achieved from staging the event with the SMART objectives that were set for it at the outset. The findings and recommendations from the post-event report can be used to assist with the design of future events and overcoming any challenges and problems that were faced. Information contained within the report will help the event manager to understand which aspects of the event were successful, those areas where improvements are needed and which elements of the event should be discontinued. This systematic, analytical and evaluative process will contribute to the continuous improvement of the event preparing, planning, organising and management process. This strategic approach to event evaluation will ensure that the event manager is continually developing their expertise in the international events industry – and creating a very important competitive advantage for their event management organisation in that they will become a true 'learning organisation'.

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43 Keeping in Touch With Participants And Maintaining Stakeholder Relationships

When the event has finished, and the post-event report has been produced, the work of the event manager is not over. A very important task that has to be undertaken is that of communicating about the success of the event to the participants to encourage them to attend the next event that is organised and also maintaining relationships with stakeholders to ensure that they will support the event manager with the organisation and implementation of events that are organised in the future.

Keeping in touch with participants

A post-event social media strategy has to be designed and implemented during the weeks and months following the event. The strategy should:

- invite event participants to post their photo images and videos on the official social media platforms that the event management company uses to highlight the satisfaction that the participants gained from the event – only positive videos

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and images should be published
- the event manager can then use the official social media platforms to make announcements about the next event that is being organised using images and messages that will encourage future bookings from both existing and new customers and clients

Maintaining stakeholder relationships

The event manager should communicate with the event stakeholders after the event to encourage them to support events that are organised in the future. This post-event communication will help develop collaborative partnerships with the key stakeholders and will build their trust and loyalty with the event manager. Ways in which to maintain stakeholder relationships include:

- meeting with the stakeholders on a one-to-one basis to personally thank them for their support for the event and seeking their views on how future events can be organised in partnership with them
- organising a post-event celebratory party with the stakeholders to show appreciation for their support for the event and giving souvenirs and certificates to thank them for their role in the success of the event
- inviting the stakeholders to future events that the event manager organises as VIP guests
- communicating through e-newsletters, email, and social media channels with the stakeholders to keep them informed about the event management company and its activities

Maintaining effective relationships with stakeholders will require a communications plan to be designed and implemented, but in so doing the event manager will be creating positive relationships with highly influential people and organisations that all contribute to successful event management. The reputation of

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the event manager will be greatly enhanced if sincere, honest and trustworthy relationships are maintained with the event stakeholders in a two-way collaborative partnership.

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Case Study:

Evaluating the FRINGE WORLD Festival, Australia

FRINGE WORLD is a cultural festival that takes place every year in Perth, Western Australia. Founded in 2011, it is now the world's third-largest 'fringe' festival running for 31 days in January and February. There were 850,000 attendees at the festival in 2019 spending more than A$12 million in ticket sales at 160 venues for 670 shows and performances – theatre, comedy, cabaret, visual arts, musicals, dance and circus (www.fringeworld.com.au/impact-report).

At the end of the festival, all participants are invited to complete questionnaires to provide feedback on their experiences. FRINGE WORLD uses a similar and consistent research methodology each year to evaluate the success of the festival. This enables reliable data to be collated each year, which can be used for year-on-year comparisons to be made of the success and impacts of the festival. To shape the design, implementation and analysis of the research, FRINGE WORLD has utilised the expertise of BOP Consulting UK (www.bop.co.uk) which is a specialist international consulting and research company that works with clients to assess the social, cultural and economic impacts of cultural and creative activities. The data collected for the 2019 FRINGE WORLD impact report were derived from:

- online audience survey – 4,472 respondents
- artist survey – 468 respondents
- festival staff survey – 213 respondents
- local business survey – 82 respondents

In addition to questionnaire surveys, data were also collected from:

- transactions recorded by the FRINGE WORLD ticketing system

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- Google Analytics
- venue and site reports
- post-event reports from venue operators
- estimates on busker attendance and tips paid to buskers

The findings of the research are published as an 'impact report' and are used to help the planning and development of the festival in the following year as well as providing valuable data for all the stakeholders of the festival. The 2019 impact report includes data on FRINGE WORLD's:

- audience profile
- cultural outcomes
- cultural visitation
- economic impact
- financial performance
- media and marketing reach
- participant feedback
- partnership activities
- social outcomes

Examples of data generated from the research include:

- 99% of respondents who attended the festival plan to return to the festival in 2020
- 96% of respondents felt that the festival made Perth a 'special city'
- 92% of respondents think they will attend cultural events in the future
- the festival generated sales income of A$25 million and A$24.9 million expenditure to stage the festival producing a ROI on these values of 0.004%
- the overall economic impact of the festival on the local economy in Perth is calculated to be A$100 million through expenditure by fringe attendees on restaurants, bars, accommodation and transport

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- 2,205 full-time jobs were calculated to be created by the festival in 2019

EVIDENCE REQUIRED FOR THE APIEM CERTIFIED EVENT MANAGER QUALIFICATION

For readers who want to study for the APIEM Certified Event Manager Qualification, you are to select an event that you have organised in the previous 12 months or are going to organise in the next 12 months and provide a portfolio of evidence that will contain the methods by which the event will be evaluated.

You will also write a reflective report that explains the reasons why you are using the research methods you have chosen to evaluate the success of the event.

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THE END

Thank you for reading our book

We hope you enjoy your career in event management

For further information on how to become
an APIEM Certified Event Manager
please write to info@theapiem.com



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